«IMARCH LTD«

«Jurisdiction: England & Wales, United Kingdom | Company Registration No. 16791765«

«MONOGRAPH«

«The Constitutional Blueprint of Distributed Ecosystem Architecture«

«Canonical Monograph on System Topology«

«Oleksandr Purpurov & IMARCH Team«

«2026«

ABSTRACT

«This monograph articulates the constitutional, topological, and protocol foundations of the IMARCH distributed ecosystem.«

CHRONICLE OS DOCUMENTATION SYSTEM

Institutional Documentation as the Operating System of Academic Publishing

Identifier: CHRONICLE-OS-DOC-SYS-001-MASTER (or VD-0009-M / VD-0009-FULL) **Type:** Consolidated Institutional Monograph / Master Blueprint **Status:** Official Canonical Edition

Version 1.0 · Official Canonical Edition · English

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Full Corpus of the Monograph VD-0009 - 8 Canonical Sections

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Brief Description of the Monograph

The Chronicle OS Documentation System (VD-0009) constitutes an expanded integrative monograph and a comprehensive set of normative documents designed for the deployment of a fully-fledged university publishing node of the international institution **VERDICTUM**.

In contrast to traditional collections of local instructions, this system regards academic publishing as a self-standing institution with its own regulatory framework, governance mechanism, expert circuit, and long-term scholarly memory.

The primary objective of the system is the creation of a **reproducible architecture** that enables a university or research structure to deploy a modern academic publishing infrastructure without the need for years of independent design.

In other words, **the Chronicle OS Documentation System is not merely a compilation of instructions, but the operating system of university academic publishing**.

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Architectural Framework of the Monograph

Volume I: Architectural and Conceptual Foundation

Content: Philosophy of the system, architecture of the publishing node, institutional autonomy, and the concept of the lifecycle of scholarly knowledge (Institutional Codex / VD-0007-1). **Key question: »Why is the system structured in this particular way?»**

Volume II: Organisational and Normative System

Content: Editorial board, powers, Publication Ethics, institutional relations, partnership agreements, and international networks (Institutional Relations Package / VD-0007-2). **Key question: »Who does what, and on what basis?»**

Volume III: Functional Operating System

Content: Editorial cycle, peer review, decision-making procedures, audit, post-publication support, and governance (Operational Governance / VD-0007-3). **Key question: »How does the publishing node operate on a day-to-day basis?»**

Volume IV: Applied and Licensing-Procedural Circuit

Content: Deployment of Chronicle Nodes, applied regulations, verification forms, compliance, and infrastructure deployment (Functional Deployment / VD-0007-4, VD-0011). **Guarantees:** practical readiness of the node for international and defence codification.

Volume V: Applied Normative Annex

Content: Regulation of the editorial fee (APC £150), cryptographic fixation of priority (SHA-256), the One Health vector, and integration with IMARCH LTD and PLATAN+. **Guarantees:** financial transparency, protection of authors' rights, and submission for ISSN/Crossref.

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Full Corpus of the Monograph VD-0009 (9 Canonical Blocks)

BLOCK 1. Prologue of the Monograph

1.1. Founding Declaration (VD-0002)

> »This Declaration establishes the purpose, institutional principles, governance model, and architectural foundations in accordance with which VERDICTUM operates and develops. The provisions of this Declaration constitute the highest level of the internal normative system of the Registry and form the basis for the development of all subsequent architectural, methodological, editorial, and technological specifications.»

- **Purpose:** The establishment of the institution **VERDICTUM** as a foundational **Public Knowledge Infrastructure**.
- **Object of record:** The definition of the **VERDICTUM Record (VR)** as the primary object with evidentiary legal-scholarly status.
- **Fundamental principles:** Institutional integrity, transparent verifiability, procedural accountability, and continuity of preservation.
- **Infrastructural context:** Direct architectural linkage with the operational environment of Chronicle OS.
- **Legal framework:** Jurisdiction of England and Wales; operator and owner — **IMARCH LTD**.

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BLOCK 2. Introductory Part — Editorial Framework (VD-0003)

Document ID: ED-FRM-2026-001 **Legal status:** Editorial doctrine and philosophy of the publication system.

Key Principles:

1. **Academic integrity** — honesty, transparency, and verifiability at every stage of research.
2. **Professional dialogue** — encouragement of cross-disciplinary discussions and institutional exchange.
3. **Institutional memory** — preservation of all versions and editions of documents from the initial draft to canonical archiving.
4. **Reproducibility** — standardisation of methodology for independent audit and further development of results.
5. **Independence of expert assessment** — protection of peer review from external administrative pressure.

Two-Circuit Architecture:

- **Academic circuit (Chronicle OS Journal)** — publication of fundamental research, monographs, institutional acts, and registry standards.
- **Expert circuit (VERDICTUM Journal)** — analytical, legal, applied, and defence-codification materials.

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BLOCK 3. Core Chronicle OS Base (Basic Volumes)

3.1. Institutional Codex (VD-0007-1 / Volume I)

The constitutional level of the institution. It consolidates the normative collection of international and institutional norms. It defines the status of VERDICTUM as an autonomous body with international jurisdiction, establishes the rules for the functioning of nodes, and provides for the preservation of all versions of normative documents in the distributed archive.

3.2. Institutional Relations Package (VD-0007-2 / Volume II)

The connective layer between constitutional law and operational practice. It regulates the rules for concluding agreements on the establishment of university nodes (**Chronicle Nodes**), the procedure for forming international editorial boards, the integration of the external expert network (**Expert Reviewer Network**), and brand policy standards.

3.3. Operational Governance Package (VD-0007-3 / Volume III)

The governance layer of the operating system. It defines decision-making procedures, voting, institutional certification, reporting, and continuous internal audit. It describes the daily technological cycle of the academic publishing house.

3.4. Functional Deployment Package (VD-0007-4 / Volume IV)

The practical executive circuit. It contains standardised protocols for manuscript submission, expert peer review, supply chain verification, technical preparation, and the process of international codification.

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BLOCK 4. Supplementary Protocols and Deployment Kits

4.1. Institutional & Author Protocols (VD-0005, VD-0012)

VD-0005: General institutional protocol for interaction among authors', editors, and reviewers. **VD-0012:** Specialised protocol for authors' (requirements for manuscript structuring, metadata, graphical schemes, and formatting standards).

4.2. University Node Deployment Kit (VD-0011)

A practical step-by-step guide for IT specialists and university administrations on deploying a local **Chronicle Node** and fully integrating it with the central VERDICTUM Registry.

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Conclusion

The Chronicle OS Documentation System (VD-0009) represents a complete institutional model for the deployment of a new-generation university academic publishing house.

By combining the founding declaration (VD-0002), the editorial doctrine (VD-0003), four normative-operational volumes (VD-0007-1…4), the financial-cryptographic annex (Volume V), and applied service protocols (VD-0005, VD-0011, VD-0012), the monograph forms a monolithic, independent, and reproducible ecosystem for the preservation and dissemination of scholarly knowledge.

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Registry Data

Document ID: CHRONICLE-OS-DOC-SYS-001 **Base monograph:** DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20611942 (**The Constitutional Blueprint of Distributed Ecosystem Architecture**) **DOI of monograph VD-0009:** (to be assigned upon registration) **Jurisdiction:** England and Wales **Right holder and operator:** IMARCH LTD **Date of update:** 3 August 2026

Approved / Signed: Oleksandr Purpurov Director and Chief Systems Architect IMARCH LTD, London, United Kingdom 3 August 2026

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DECLARATION OF INSTITUTIONAL PURPOSE

VERDICTUM — International Institutional Registry

Under International Registration · Act RN-0024

Status: Under International Registration (Act RN-0024) **Institutional Status:** Sovereign Infrastructure Registry of Documented Facts, Decisions, Commitments, and Verified Events **Ecosystem:** IMARCH Public Knowledge Infrastructure **Date of Adoption:** 05 July 2026 **Edition:** English Master Edition (August 2026) **Jurisdiction:** England and Wales **Owner:** IMARCH LTD **Constitutional Reference:** IMS-0000 (Third Volume)

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Institutional Declaration

The digital era has fundamentally transformed the way information is created, distributed, and consumed.

At the same time, technological progress has significantly reduced confidence in the authenticity, origin, and long-term reliability of publicly available information.

As artificial intelligence accelerates the generation of digital content, the primary challenge is no longer access to information. The primary challenge is confidence in documented fact.

VERDICTUM has been established to address this challenge.

VERDICTUM is an independent institutional registry designed for the systematic documentation, verification, interconnection, and long-term preservation of documented facts, decisions, commitments, and significant events.

VERDICTUM represents an independent institutional infrastructure dedicated to the formation of institutional memory and the accumulation of verifiable documentary evidence.

Adopted by: Oleksandr Purpurov Director & Chief Systems Architect IMARCH LTD, London, United Kingdom 05 July 2026

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EDITORIAL FRAMEWORK

IMARCH Chronicle OS — Principles for Knowledge Creation, Expert Review and Scholarly Publishing

Version 1.0 · Institutional Framework

Document ID: ED-FRM-2026-001 **Status:** Institutional Framework Policy **Ecosystem:** IMARCH Chronicle OS Infrastructure **Date of Adoption:** 09 July 2026 **Edition:** English Master Edition (August 2026) **Jurisdiction:** England and Wales **Owner:** IMARCH LTD **Citation Reference:** DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20611942

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Preface

The global knowledge ecosystem is undergoing a profound transformation.

The rapid development of digital technologies, the exponential growth of scientific publications, and the emergence of generative artificial intelligence have fundamentally changed the way knowledge is created, evaluated, disseminated and preserved.

While the volume of published information continues to expand, quantity alone no longer guarantees scientific quality, reproducibility or long-term institutional value.

Under these conditions, publishing should no longer be viewed as a simple process of making information publicly available. Instead, it must become a structured institutional mechanism capable of preserving intellectual integrity, supporting expert evaluation and maintaining the continuity of scholarly communication.

IMARCH Chronicle OS has been established as a response to these challenges.

Its purpose is to create an environment in which knowledge is treated not as isolated publications but as interconnected elements of a continuously evolving institutional memory.

This Editorial Framework defines the fundamental principles governing all publishing activities within the IMARCH ecosystem and serves as the foundational policy document for its academic and expert publication platforms.

Chapter 1. Mission

The mission of the IMARCH publishing ecosystem is not merely to publish documents, but to support the development, evaluation and preservation of knowledge throughout its entire lifecycle.

Every publication is regarded as the beginning of an open professional dialogue rather than the conclusion of research.

We seek to create an environment in which ideas evolve through expert discussion, constructive criticism and institutional continuity.

Our objective is not simply to build a repository of publications but to establish a sustainable ecosystem for knowledge development.

Chapter 2. Fundamental Principles

The publishing activities of IMARCH are founded upon the following principles.

Academic Integrity

Every publication must accurately represent the intellectual contribution of its authors' and properly acknowledge all relevant sources.

Professional Dialogue

Constructive criticism is recognised as an essential component of scientific and professional progress.

Institutional Memory

Each published version constitutes an important stage in the development of knowledge and should therefore remain part of the institutional record.

Reproducibility

Research findings, methodologies and analytical arguments should be presented in a manner that enables independent verification, critical assessment and further development.

Respect for Authorship

Authors retain intellectual responsibility for the content of their work throughout the publication process.

Editorial Independence

Editorial decisions and expert reviews shall be conducted objectively, professionally and independently.

Chapter 3. Publishing Architecture

The IMARCH publishing ecosystem consists of two complementary publication environments.

Academic Publishing Network

This environment is dedicated to scholarly articles, monographs, methodological publications, research reports and other academic contributions.

Its operation follows internationally recognised principles of scholarly peer review, academic ethics and research reproducibility.

Expert Publishing Network

The Expert Publishing Network, including the Verdictum platform, is intended for analytical papers, policy studies, institutional reports, strategic assessments, legal analyses and interdisciplinary professional publications.

Its primary objective is to facilitate the exchange of applied knowledge between researchers, practitioners and institutional stakeholders.

Although these publication environments serve different audiences and publication formats, they operate within a shared institutional architecture, common editorial standards and unified principles of expert evaluation.

Chapter 4. Expert Review

Expert review is recognised as an independent intellectual and professional activity.

The role of the reviewer extends beyond identifying weaknesses within a manuscript.

Reviewers contribute to improving clarity, methodological robustness and scientific quality while supporting authors' in the development of their research.

Within IMARCH, authors', editors and reviewers are regarded as collaborative participants in a common process of knowledge creation.

Chapter 5. Institutional Memory

Knowledge evolves through successive editions rather than isolated publications.

Accordingly, each document may progress through multiple stages including:

- Draft Version
- Working Edition
- Expert Review Edition
- Published Version
- Archived Edition
- Revision History

Preserving this evolutionary record enables future researchers to understand not only the final conclusions but also the intellectual pathway that led to them.

Chapter 6. Chronicle OS

Chronicle OS provides the digital infrastructure supporting the implementation of this Editorial Framework.

The platform integrates publishing tools, editorial workflows, institutional archiving, expert communication and long-term knowledge management into a unified operational environment.

Its purpose is to support sustainable international collaboration and the continuous development of distributed research communities.

Chapter 7. Continuous Development

This Editorial Framework is intended to evolve alongside the IMARCH ecosystem.

Future revisions may clarify, extend or refine its provisions in response to emerging technological, scientific and institutional developments.

All official revisions form part of the institutional memory of IMARCH and remain accessible as historical records of the Framework's evolution.

Conclusion

Scientific progress depends upon trust, intellectual honesty and responsible expert collaboration.

The IMARCH publishing ecosystem has been established not merely as a publication platform but as an institutional infrastructure supporting the creation, evaluation, preservation and transmission of knowledge across academic and professional communities.

By integrating scholarly publishing, expert review and institutional memory within a unified framework, IMARCH seeks to contribute to a more transparent, resilient and collaborative global knowledge environment.

Approved / Signed: Oleksandr Purpurov Director and Chief System Architect IMARCH LTD, London, United Kingdom 09 July 2026

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VOLUME I — INSTITUTIONAL CODEX

Constitutional Framework for the University Scientific Publishing System

Master Edition · Version 1.0 · English Translation (Oxford Legal Style)

CDX-001 — INSTITUTIONAL CODEX Constitutional Framework for the University Scientific Publishing System

Document Identifier: CDX-001 **Document Classification:** Foundational Constitutional Instrument **Document Layer:** Volume I • Constitutional Framework **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0 **Document Owner:** IMARCH LTD **Jurisdiction:** England and Wales **Date of Issue:** 18 July 2026

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CHRONICLE OS DOCUMENTATION SYSTEM — VOLUME I — INSTITUTIONAL CODEX
Master Edition — Version 1.0 | DOC ID: CDX-001

PREAMBLE

PART I — CONSTITUTIONAL LAYER Master Regulatory Package (15 Constitutional Instruments)

1. **DOC-001** — Institutional Publishing Doctrine
2. **DOC-002** — Editorial Policy
3. **DOC-003** — Editorial Board Charter
4. **DOC-004** — Code of Publication Ethics
5. **DOC-005** — Peer Review Policy
6. **DOC-006** — Research Integrity Policy
7. **DOC-007** — Research Data Policy
8. **DOC-008** — Digital Preservation Policy

9. **DOC-009** — Metadata and Persistent Identification Policy
10. **DOC-010** — Transparency Policy
11. **DOC-011** — Appeals and Complaints Policy
12. **DOC-012** — Quality Assurance Policy
13. **DOC-013** — International Cooperation Policy
14. **DOC-014** — Continuous Development Policy
15. **DOC-015** — Institutional Governance Policy

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PREAMBLE

The **Institutional Codex** constitutes the supreme normative corpus of the international scientific communication ecosystem operating under the **Chronicle OS Documentation System**.

The Codex establishes a unified institutional governance framework through three integrated regulatory layers.

Level I — Constitutional Layer

Master Regulatory Package (15 Constitutional Instruments) Defines the constitutional philosophy, legal foundation, institutional architecture, editorial governance model, publication ethics, research integrity framework, and the fundamental principles governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

Level II — Deployment Layer

Deployment Framework (12 Institutional Modules) Defines the institutional deployment architecture, university publishing nodes, digital infrastructure, international expert network, interoperability framework, governance mechanisms, implementation procedures, and institutional scalability model.

Level III — Operational Layer

Operational Standards (OPS-001 – OPS-010) Defines the operational procedures governing editorial offices, University Chronicle Nodes, the International Expert Network, the Chronicle Registry, digital trust services, artificial intelligence governance, metadata exchange, institutional interoperability, regulatory compliance, and the day-to-day operation of the Chronicle OS publishing ecosystem.

All instruments incorporated into the Institutional Codex shall be regarded as normative documents and shall be binding upon every institutional participant operating within the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

The Institutional Codex serves as the single authoritative regulatory source governing the establishment, operation, governance, maintenance, and continuous development of the international publishing infrastructure of Chronicle OS.

Local regulations, institutional statutes, and operational procedures adopted by individual **University Chronicle Nodes** shall remain fully compatible with, and shall not conflict with, the constitutional provisions established by this Codex.

DOC-001 — Institutional Publishing Doctrine

Foundational Constitutional Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-001 **Document Classification:** Foundational Constitutional Instrument **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. General Provisions

The **Institutional Publishing Doctrine** establishes the constitutional principles governing the organisation, operation, governance, and long-term development of the international scientific communication ecosystem operating under the Chronicle OS Documentation System.

The Doctrine constitutes the supreme constitutional instrument of the Chronicle OS regulatory framework. It defines the unified principles of institutional governance, editorial activity, scientific communication, publication policy, and sustainable institutional development.

All internal regulatory instruments, policies, procedures, operational standards, and technical specifications adopted within Chronicle OS shall derive their authority from this Doctrine and shall remain fully consistent with its provisions.

2. Institutional Status of Chronicle OS

Chronicle OS is an international institutional scientific communication ecosystem designed to support the complete life cycle of scholarly publication through an integrated framework of constitutional governance, editorial regulation, organisational procedures, and digital infrastructure.

The scientific journal constitutes the first operational implementation of Chronicle OS and functions in full compliance with the principles established by this Doctrine.

Chronicle OS shall not be regarded merely as a scientific journal or publishing platform. It represents a comprehensive institutional framework intended to establish a sustainable international infrastructure for scholarly communication.

3. Mission

The mission of Chronicle OS is to establish an open, sustainable, resilient, and institutionally reliable environment for international scientific communication.

The ecosystem is founded upon the principles of research integrity, procedural transparency, editorial independence, institutional responsibility, and respect for intellectual contribution.

Chronicle OS exists to facilitate the continuous advancement of scientific knowledge independently of political, governmental, commercial, ideological, or other external influences.

4. Scope of Institutional Activity

Chronicle OS shall undertake activities including, but not limited to: organisation and administration of scientific peer review; editorial preparation and publication management; facilitation of international scientific communication; establishment and development of expert communities; long-term preservation of scientific heritage; development of the institutional regulatory framework governing scholarly publishing; implementation of digital technologies supporting scientific publication and research communication.

5. Fundamental Principles

The activities of Chronicle OS shall be governed by the following constitutional principles: legality; academic freedom; research integrity; editorial independence; institutional accountability; procedural transparency; impartial expert evaluation; equality of authors'; protection of intellectual property; long-term preservation of scientific knowledge; international cooperation; continuous institutional development.

6. Principle of Institutional Continuity

Every regulatory instrument adopted within Chronicle OS shall derive from, implement, and further specify the constitutional provisions established by this Doctrine. In the event of inconsistency between regulatory instruments, the provisions of the Institutional Publishing Doctrine shall prevail.

7. Principle of Transparency

Chronicle OS shall maintain the highest practicable level of transparency throughout its editorial, organisational, and governance procedures. Confidentiality shall apply only where required by

publication ethics, applicable legislation, contractual obligations, or the integrity of the peer-review process.

8. Institutional Memory

Institutional Memory comprises the complete body of constitutional instruments, regulatory documents, editorial decisions, scholarly publications, metadata, archival records, and all associated institutional knowledge generated within Chronicle OS. Institutional Memory shall ensure the continuity, integrity, and sustainability of the ecosystem irrespective of changes in personnel, governance structures, technological platforms, or organisational arrangements.

9. Structure of the Regulatory Framework

The Chronicle OS regulatory framework shall operate according to a hierarchical constitutional model. The Institutional Publishing Doctrine constitutes the highest regulatory authority. Pursuant to this Doctrine, Chronicle OS shall adopt: Editorial Policies; Codes of Publication Ethics; Procedural Regulations; Institutional Protocols; Operational Standards; Technical Specifications; Administrative Forms. Each successive regulatory level shall elaborate and implement the constitutional provisions established at the preceding level.

10. International Cooperation

Chronicle OS shall actively promote cooperation with universities, research institutions, scientific organisations, professional associations, learned societies, and independent researchers worldwide. Such cooperation shall be conducted exclusively in accordance with the constitutional principles established by this Doctrine.

11. Institutional Development

Chronicle OS shall evolve as a long-term international institutional ecosystem. Technological solutions, digital services, software platforms, artificial intelligence systems, and user interfaces constitute implementation mechanisms of this Doctrine and may evolve without altering its constitutional foundations.

12. Final Provisions

This Doctrine shall enter into force upon formal adoption in accordance with the constitutional procedures established within Chronicle OS and shall remain in force until superseded by a duly adopted revised edition. Amendments to this Doctrine shall be adopted exclusively in accordance with the constitutional procedures established by the Chronicle OS regulatory framework. This Doctrine forms an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other constitutional and regulatory instruments comprising the system.

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DOC-002 — Editorial Policy

Constitutional Editorial Governance Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-002 **Document Classification:** Editorial Policy **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Editorial Policy establishes the constitutional principles governing the editorial activities of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. The Policy defines the framework regulating the interaction between the Editorial Office, Authors, Reviewers, Members of the Editorial Board, and all other participants engaged in the scholarly publishing process. This Editorial Policy is adopted pursuant to the Institutional Publishing Doctrine of Chronicle OS and shall be binding upon every participant involved in the editorial process.

2. Editorial Mission

The Editorial Office shall ensure the highest standards of scholarly quality, impartial scientific assessment, research integrity, and the sustainable development of international scientific communication. Each publication shall be regarded as a substantive contribution to the advancement of global scientific knowledge.

3. Fundamental Editorial Principles

Editorial activities within Chronicle OS shall be governed by the following constitutional principles: scientific independence; editorial autonomy; research integrity; impartial manuscript evaluation; non-discrimination; equality of authors'; procedural transparency; compliance with publication ethics; respect for intellectual property; institutional accountability.

4. Editorial Independence

Editorial decisions shall be based exclusively upon the scientific merit, originality, methodological quality, and scholarly significance of submitted manuscripts. The Editorial Office shall remain free from commercial, political, governmental, religious, national, corporate, ideological, or any other external influence unrelated to the scientific content of the publication.

5. Editorial Authority

The Editorial Office shall have the authority to: receive and register manuscript submissions; assign manuscripts for scientific peer review; return manuscripts to authors' for revision; reject submissions that fail to satisfy the editorial or scientific requirements of the Journal; retract publications in accordance with the Code of Publication Ethics; publish corrections, amendments, editorial notices, and official statements; establish and manage special issues and thematic editions.

6. Editorial Responsibilities

The Editorial Office shall: ensure the impartiality of scientific evaluation; preserve the confidentiality of the editorial process; guarantee equal treatment of all authors'; prevent and manage conflicts of interest; comply fully with the Code of Publication Ethics; safeguard all publication materials and associated records; ensure the long-term accessibility and preservation of published research.

7. Relations with Authors

The Editorial Office shall ensure: professional, respectful, and impartial communication with authors'; timely notification regarding the progress of manuscript evaluation; the opportunity for authors' to revise manuscripts in response to reviewer recommendations; the right of authors' to submit reasoned responses to editorial observations; consideration of complaints and appeals in accordance with the established institutional procedures.

8. Relations with Reviewers

The Editorial Office shall organise scientific peer review in accordance with the approved Peer Review Policy. The Editorial Office shall guarantee both the independence of reviewers and the confidentiality of the peer-review process.

9. International Cooperation

The Editorial Office shall actively promote the development of an international scholarly community by fostering cooperation among universities, research institutions, scientific organisations, professional associations, and independent researchers.

10. Conflict of Interest

Every participant engaged in the editorial process shall disclose any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest. Where a conflict of interest exists, the Editorial Office shall implement appropriate measures to preserve the impartiality, integrity, and credibility of the editorial decision-making process.

11. Presumption of Good Faith

The Editorial Office shall operate on the presumption that Authors, Reviewers, Editors, and Members of the Editorial Board act in good faith and in accordance with accepted standards of scholarly integrity. Allegations of research misconduct or breaches of publication ethics shall be investigated exclusively on the basis of objective evidence and in accordance with formally established institutional procedures.

12. Development of Editorial Policy

This Editorial Policy shall be subject to periodic review and continuous improvement. Its development shall take into account: the evolution of international scholarly publishing practices; recommendations issued by the Committee on Publication Ethics (COPE); internationally recognised academic standards; accumulated institutional experience within Chronicle OS.

13. Final Provisions

This Editorial Policy shall be interpreted and applied together with the Institutional Publishing Doctrine, the Code of Publication Ethics, the Peer Review Policy, and all other constitutional and regulatory instruments forming part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied in conjunction with the complete body of constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural instruments governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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DOC-003 — Editorial Board Charter

Constitutional Editorial Governance Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-003 **Document Classification:** Editorial Board Charter **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Charter establishes the legal status, institutional composition, authority, appointment procedures, and operational principles governing the Editorial Board of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. The Charter is adopted pursuant to the Institutional Publishing Doctrine of Chronicle OS and shall be binding upon every Member of the Editorial Board.

2. Institutional Status of the Editorial Board

The Editorial Board shall constitute the permanent collegiate governing body responsible for the editorial governance of Chronicle OS. The Editorial Board shall ensure the implementation of the Institutional Publishing Doctrine, the Editorial Policy, the strategic development of the Journal, and compliance with internationally recognised standards of scholarly publishing.

3. Functions and Objectives

The Editorial Board shall be responsible for: establishing editorial policy; defining the scientific development strategy of Chronicle OS; safeguarding the quality of published research; fostering the international scholarly community; developing the international network of reviewers and subject-matter experts; considering matters of fundamental editorial importance; approving internal constitutional and regulatory instruments.

4. Principles of Operation

The Editorial Board shall conduct its activities in accordance with the following principles: academic independence; scientific objectivity; collective governance; transparency of decision-making; institutional accountability; respect for academic freedom; compliance with publication ethics.

5. Composition of the Editorial Board

The Editorial Board may include: the Editor-in-Chief; Deputy Editors-in-Chief; Managing Editors; Scientific Editors; International Editors; invited experts; representatives of universities and research institutions; other specialists appointed by decision of the Editorial Board.

6. Editor-in-Chief

The Editor-in-Chief shall: provide overall strategic leadership of Chronicle OS; represent Chronicle OS before external organisations and institutions; approve final editorial decisions; convene and chair meetings of the Editorial Board; execute official institutional documents; ensure compliance with the Institutional Publishing Doctrine.

7. Authority of the Editorial Board

The Editorial Board shall have the authority to: determine the strategic development of Chronicle OS; approve editorial regulations and institutional policies; establish special issues and thematic editions; constitute international advisory and expert panels; appoint new members of the Editorial Board; resolve significant editorial disputes; initiate amendments to the Chronicle OS regulatory framework.

8. Rights of Members

Each Member of the Editorial Board shall have the right to: participate in deliberations concerning editorial governance; submit proposals relating to the development of Chronicle OS; receive all information necessary for the proper performance of editorial duties; participate in collective decision-making; record a reasoned dissenting opinion; resign voluntarily from membership of the Editorial Board.

9. Responsibilities of Members

Members of the Editorial Board shall: comply with the Institutional Publishing Doctrine; comply with the Code of Publication Ethics; maintain confidentiality where required; disclose and prevent conflicts of interest; uphold the highest standards of scientific quality within Chronicle OS; act exclusively in the best interests of the institutional development of the system.

10. Appointment and Termination of Membership

Members of the Editorial Board shall be appointed by decision of the Editor-in-Chief or, where applicable, by resolution of the Editorial Board in accordance with the internal constitutional procedures of Chronicle OS. Membership may be terminated on the following grounds: voluntary resignation; expiration of the appointed term; inability to perform editorial duties; violation of the Code of Publication Ethics; conduct materially damaging to the reputation or institutional integrity of Chronicle OS.

11. Meetings

The Editorial Board shall meet whenever required for the effective governance of Chronicle OS. Meetings may be conducted in the following formats: in-person meetings; remote meetings; hybrid meetings; electronic voting procedures.

12. Decision-Making Procedures

The Editorial Board shall seek to adopt decisions through professional consensus. Where consensus cannot reasonably be achieved, decisions shall be adopted by a simple majority of Members participating in the meeting unless otherwise provided by the constitutional instruments of Chronicle OS.

13. International Character of the Editorial Board

The Editorial Board shall be constituted in accordance with the principles of international scholarly cooperation. Appointments shall be based upon: academic qualifications; professional reputation; editorial experience; recognised international scholarly expertise. Nationality, citizenship, political affiliation, or institutional origin shall not constitute criteria for appointment.

14. Institutional Independence

Members of the Editorial Board shall perform their responsibilities independently of political, governmental, commercial, administrative, ideological, or any other external influence. Editorial decisions shall be based exclusively upon scientific and academic considerations.

15. Final Provisions

This Charter shall be interpreted and applied together with the Institutional Publishing Doctrine, the Editorial Policy, the Code of Publication Ethics, the Peer Review Policy, and all other constitutional and regulatory instruments forming part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied in conjunction with the complete body of constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural instruments governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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DOC-004 — Code of Publication Ethics

Constitutional Ethical Governance Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-004 **Document Classification:** Code of Publication Ethics **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Code establishes the mandatory standards of publication ethics governing the Chronicle OS Documentation System and defines the rights, responsibilities, and ethical obligations of every participant engaged in the scholarly publishing process. The Code is adopted pursuant to the Institutional Publishing Doctrine of Chronicle OS and is developed in accordance with internationally recognised principles of academic publishing, including the recommendations of the Committee on Publication Ethics (COPE).

2. Mission

The purpose of this Code is to preserve trust in scholarly publication through uniform ethical standards, transparent procedures, impartial editorial governance, and fair scientific assessment. Chronicle OS recognises publication ethics as one of the constitutional foundations of institutional trust.

3. Fundamental Ethical Principles

Publishing activities within Chronicle OS shall be governed by the following principles: research integrity; scientific objectivity; editorial independence; respect for intellectual property; openness of scientific discourse; procedural transparency; institutional accountability; equality and non-discrimination; compliance with internationally recognised academic standards.

4. Responsibilities of Authors

Authors shall: ensure the accuracy and reliability of all submitted data; provide complete and accurate references to all sources used; disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest; promptly notify the Editorial Office of any material errors identified after submission or publication; comply fully with the provisions of this Code. Authors shall not: submit knowingly false or fabricated research results; engage in plagiarism in any form; submit duplicate or redundant publications without prior disclosure; manipulate authorship or artificially expand the list of authors'; conceal material information affecting the scientific integrity of the research.

5. Responsibilities of the Editorial Office

The Editorial Office shall: ensure impartial evaluation of all submissions; preserve the confidentiality of the editorial process; prevent and appropriately manage conflicts of interest; base editorial decisions exclusively upon scientific merit; investigate all reports concerning potential breaches of publication ethics; publish corrections, amendments, expressions of concern, or retractions where appropriate. The Editorial Office shall not discriminate on the basis of nationality, citizenship, lan-

guage, gender, age, ethnicity, religion, political opinion, institutional affiliation, or any other status unrelated to scientific merit.

6. Responsibilities of Reviewers

Reviewers shall: preserve the confidentiality of all materials received for review; conduct independent, objective, and evidence-based scientific evaluations; disclose and avoid conflicts of interest; provide constructive, reasoned, and professionally respectful assessments; treat authors' with fairness and professional courtesy; immediately notify the Editorial Office of any indication of research misconduct or publication malpractice.

7. Conflict of Interest

Every participant in the publication process shall disclose any personal, professional, financial, institutional, or other interest capable of influencing impartial judgement. Where a conflict of interest is identified, the Editorial Office shall implement appropriate measures to preserve the integrity and impartiality of the editorial process.

8. Research Integrity

Chronicle OS maintains a policy of zero tolerance toward: plagiarism; fabrication of research data; falsification of scientific results; manipulation of images or research materials; fraudulent authorship; citation manipulation; any other form of academic misconduct. Every allegation shall be examined individually in accordance with the principles of procedural fairness, impartiality, proportionality, and due process.

9. Presumption of Good Faith

Chronicle OS operates on the constitutional presumption that Authors, Reviewers, Editors, and Members of the Editorial Board act in good faith and in accordance with accepted standards of scholarly integrity. An allegation of publication misconduct shall not, in itself, constitute evidence of wrongdoing. Every allegation shall be subject to objective verification before any institutional decision is adopted.

10. Corrections and Retractions

Where significant errors or violations of publication ethics are identified, the Editorial Office may: publish corrections; publish explanatory notices; issue official editorial statements; retract publications; publish formal notices of retraction. Every decision shall be adopted only after careful consideration of all relevant facts and circumstances.

11. Investigation of Ethical Misconduct

Every report alleging a breach of publication ethics shall be investigated in accordance with formally established institutional procedures. The investigation shall guarantee: impartiality; equality of all parties; the right to provide explanations and supporting evidence; complete procedural documentation; confidentiality until a final institutional decision has been reached.

12. Institutional Responsibility

Chronicle OS recognises compliance with publication ethics as a collective institutional responsibility. Responsibility for the implementation of this Code shall be shared by: the Editorial Office; the Editorial Board; Authors; Reviewers; invited experts; every other participant involved in the scholarly publishing process.

13. International Standards

Chronicle OS shall ensure that its editorial practices remain consistent with: the recommendations of the Committee on Publication Ethics (COPE); the principles of Open Science; internationally recognised standards of scholarly publishing; evolving international best practices in research integrity. Where international standards evolve, this Code may be revised without altering the constitutional principles established by the Institutional Publishing Doctrine.

14. Final Provisions

This Code shall be binding upon every participant engaged in the Chronicle OS scholarly publishing process. The Code of Publication Ethics shall be interpreted and applied together with the Institutional Publishing Doctrine, the Editorial Policy, the Peer Review Policy, and every other constitutional and regulatory instrument forming part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied in conjunction with the complete constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural framework governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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DOC-005 — Peer Review Policy

Constitutional Scientific Review Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-005 **Document Classification:** Peer Review Policy **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Policy establishes the objectives, principles, procedures, and institutional framework governing the scientific peer review of manuscripts submitted for publication within the Chronicle OS Documentation System. This Policy shall be binding upon the Editorial Office, the Editorial Board, Reviewers, Authors, and all other participants involved in the scholarly publishing process.

2. Purpose of Peer Review

Peer review safeguards the scientific quality of published research through independent expert assessment of: scientific validity; methodological soundness; reliability of results; originality of contribution; compliance with internationally recognised standards of scholarly publishing. Peer review constitutes the principal institutional mechanism through which confidence in scientific publication is established and maintained.

3. Fundamental Principles

Scientific peer review within Chronicle OS shall be conducted in accordance with the following principles: reviewer independence; scientific objectivity; professional competence; confidentiality; absence of conflicts of interest; professional respect toward authors'; evidence-based and reasoned evaluation.

4. Review Model

Chronicle OS adopts **Double-Blind Peer Review** as its standard review model, whereby neither Authors nor Reviewers are informed of each other's identity throughout the evaluation process. Where justified by the nature of a submission, disciplinary practice, or internationally recognised editorial standards, the Editorial Board may approve an alternative model of scholarly evaluation.

5. Appointment of Reviewers

Reviewers shall be appointed by the Editorial Office on the basis of: academic qualifications; demonstrated research experience; professional reputation; absence of conflicts of interest; recognised expertise directly relevant to the submitted manuscript. The Editorial Office may appoint one or more independent Reviewers for any submission.

6. Rights of Reviewers

Reviewers shall have the right to: decline a review assignment; request additional materials where necessary; disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest; submit an independent or dissenting scientific opinion; recommend the appointment of an additional expert reviewer.

7. Responsibilities of Reviewers

Reviewers shall: preserve the confidentiality of all submitted materials; conduct an independent and objective scientific evaluation; complete the review within the agreed timeframe; provide clear,

reasoned, and evidence-based comments; refrain from personal criticism of Authors; immediately inform the Editorial Office of any indication of plagiarism, fabricated data, falsified results, duplicate publication, or any other form of publication misconduct.

8. Evaluation Criteria

During peer review, Reviewers shall assess, where applicable: originality and scientific novelty; relevance of the research; methodological validity; reliability of findings; logical consistency of presentation; quality of scientific reasoning; accuracy of citations and references; relevance to the editorial scope of Chronicle OS.

9. Review Recommendations

Upon completion of the review, the Reviewer may recommend that the manuscript be: accepted without revision; accepted subject to minor revisions; returned for major revisions; subjected to additional peer review; rejected. The final editorial decision shall remain the exclusive responsibility of the Editorial Office.

10. Secondary Review

Where substantial revisions have been made, the manuscript may be returned to: the original Reviewer; a newly appointed independent Reviewer; multiple Reviewers simultaneously. The necessity for secondary review shall be determined by the Editorial Office.

11. Confidentiality

All materials received during peer review shall remain strictly confidential. Reviewers shall not disclose, reproduce, distribute, cite, or otherwise use unpublished material for personal, academic, institutional, or commercial purposes prior to its official publication.

12. Conflict of Interest

Any Reviewer whose impartiality may reasonably be compromised by personal, professional, institutional, financial, or other interests shall immediately notify the Editorial Office and decline participation in the review process. The Editorial Office shall appoint a replacement Reviewer without prejudice to the integrity or continuity of the editorial process.

13. Presumption of Good Faith

Chronicle OS operates on the constitutional presumption that both Authors and Reviewers participate honestly and in good faith. Scientific evaluation shall be based exclusively upon the academic content of the submitted work and shall never be influenced by assumptions concerning the identity, affiliation, nationality, reputation, or personal characteristics of the Author.

14. Independence of Scientific Assessment

The Editorial Office shall guarantee the complete independence of peer review. Administrative, commercial, political, institutional, ideological, or other external influences shall not affect the substance or outcome of any expert assessment.

15. Appeals

Authors shall have the right to submit a reasoned appeal against the outcome of peer review. Appeals shall be considered in accordance with the constitutional procedures established by Chronicle OS. Where appropriate, the Editorial Office may appoint one or more additional independent Reviewers.

16. International Standards

Chronicle OS conducts peer review in accordance with internationally recognised principles of scholarly publishing, including the recommendations of the Committee on Publication Ethics (COPE) and other accepted standards of international academic practice. The Editorial Office shall continuously review and improve peer review procedures to reflect developments in global scholarly communication.

17. Final Provisions

This Policy shall be interpreted and applied together with the Institutional Publishing Doctrine, the Editorial Policy, the Code of Publication Ethics, and all other constitutional and regulatory instruments forming part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. Every participant in the scholarly publishing process shall comply fully with the provisions of this Policy. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied together with the complete constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural framework governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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DOC-006 — Research Integrity Policy

Constitutional Research Integrity Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-006 **Document Classification:** Research Integrity Policy **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Policy establishes the institutional principles governing research integrity throughout the Chronicle OS Documentation System and applies to Authors, Editors, Reviewers, Experts, Members of the Editorial Board, and all other participants engaged in the scholarly publishing process.

2. Fundamental Principle

Chronicle OS recognises research integrity as the constitutional foundation of trust in scientific knowledge and as an essential prerequisite for the sustainable development of international scholarly communication. The preservation of research integrity constitutes a collective institutional responsibility shared by the entire Chronicle OS ecosystem.

3. Principles of Research Integrity

All activities conducted within Chronicle OS shall be governed by the following principles: reliability of scientific results; reproducibility of research; transparency of research methodology; respect for intellectual work; accountability of researchers; objectivity of scientific evaluation; openness of scientific discourse; institutional responsibility.

4. Prohibited Practices

The following practices are strictly prohibited: fabrication of research results; falsification of scientific data; plagiarism in any form; concealment of material research findings; manipulation of scientific images or research materials; fraudulent or fictitious authorship; artificial manipulation of citation metrics; deliberate misrepresentation of information to the Editorial Office.

5. Responsibilities of Participants

Every participant shall: uphold the principles of research integrity; promptly report suspected breaches of scientific integrity; cooperate fully in objective institutional investigations; respect the dignity and professional reputation of all participants in the publication process.

6. Investigation of Alleged Misconduct

Every allegation of research misconduct shall be investigated objectively, documented appropriately, and examined in accordance with the principles of procedural fairness and due process. No allegation shall be regarded as substantiated until the institutional review has been completed.

7. Promotion of a Culture of Research Integrity

Chronicle OS regards the continuous development of a culture of research integrity as one of its principal institutional objectives. The Editorial Office shall actively promote internationally recognised best practices in responsible research and scholarly publishing.

8. Final Provisions

This Policy shall be interpreted and applied together with the Code of Publication Ethics and all other constitutional and regulatory instruments of Chronicle OS. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied together with the complete constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural framework governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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DOC-007 — Research Data Policy

Constitutional Research Data Governance Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-007 **Document Classification:** Research Data Policy **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Policy establishes the institutional principles governing the management, stewardship, preservation, and long-term use of research data within the Chronicle OS Documentation System.

2. Fundamental Principle

Chronicle OS recognises research data as an independent scholarly asset possessing intrinsic scientific value. Research data shall be responsibly managed, documented, preserved, and maintained throughout their entire institutional lifecycle.

3. Research Data Lifecycle

Chronicle OS supports the complete lifecycle of research data, including: creation; documentation; scientific evaluation; publication; archival preservation; long-term storage; controlled reuse.

4. Data Requirements

Authors shall ensure that all research data are: accurate and reliable; independently verifiable; adequately documented; compliant with applicable legal and regulatory requirements; managed in accordance with confidentiality and data protection obligations.

5. Metadata

Every published dataset shall be accompanied by the official Chronicle OS metadata record. The official metadata record shall constitute the authoritative and canonical description of the published dataset.

6. Archival Preservation

Chronicle OS shall ensure the long-term preservation of research data through approved institutional digital preservation mechanisms and archival infrastructure.

7. Final Provisions

This Policy shall be interpreted and applied together with all other constitutional and regulatory instruments of Chronicle OS. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied together with the complete constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural framework governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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DOC-008 — Digital Preservation Policy

Constitutional Digital Preservation Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-008 **Document Classification:** Digital Preservation Policy **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Policy establishes the institutional principles governing the long-term preservation of scholarly publications, research data, metadata, editorial records, and institutional memory throughout the Chronicle OS Documentation System.

2. Fundamental Principle

Chronicle OS preserves not only published scholarly outputs but also the complete institutional memory upon which scientific continuity and historical accountability depend.

3. Preservation Objects

The following categories of institutional assets shall be preserved on a long-term basis: scholarly publications; research datasets; metadata records; editorial decisions; constitutional and regulatory documents; archival records; persistent digital identifiers.

4. Objectives of Digital Preservation

Digital preservation within Chronicle OS shall pursue the following objectives: ensuring the continuity of scholarly communication; preserving the global scientific record; maintaining the reproducibility and traceability of publication history; safeguarding institutional memory across generations.

5. Final Provisions

The technological infrastructure supporting digital preservation may evolve over time without affecting the constitutional principles established by this Policy. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied together with the complete constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural framework governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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DOC-009 — Metadata and Persistent Identification Policy

Constitutional Metadata Governance Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-009 **Document Classification:** Metadata and Persistent Identification Policy **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Policy establishes the institutional principles governing the creation, management, maintenance, preservation, and dissemination of scholarly metadata within the Chronicle OS Documentation System. Metadata shall be recognised as an independent scholarly asset forming an integral component of every scientific publication. Its primary purpose is to ensure reliable identification, discovery, citation, interoperability, and long-term integration into the international scholarly communication infrastructure.

2. Fundamental Principle

Every scholarly publication published within Chronicle OS shall be accompanied by a complete, accurate, authoritative, and machine-readable metadata record. The official metadata record shall constitute the canonical institutional source describing the publication.

3. Mandatory Metadata Elements

Each scholarly publication shall include, where applicable: publication title; author information; ORCID identifier(s); institutional affiliation(s); abstract; keywords; publication language; publication date; editorial information; licensing information; persistent digital identifiers; bibliographic references. Additional metadata elements may be introduced where required by international scholarly standards or technological developments.

4. Persistent Identifiers

Chronicle OS supports internationally recognised persistent identification systems, including: Digital Object Identifier (DOI); ORCID; Research Organization Registry (ROR); Crossref infrastructure; additional internationally recognised identifier systems where appropriate.

5. Metadata Integrity

The Editorial Office shall ensure that official metadata remain: complete; accurate; current; internally consistent; fully interoperable with recognised international metadata standards.

6. Metadata Maintenance

Whenever a publication is corrected, updated, revised, withdrawn, or otherwise modified, the Editorial Office shall ensure the immediate and synchronised updating of the official metadata record. Historical metadata revisions shall remain traceable in accordance with the institutional preservation framework of Chronicle OS.

7. Final Provisions

This Policy shall be interpreted and applied together with the Research Data Policy, the Digital Preservation Policy, and all other constitutional and regulatory instruments forming part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied together with the complete constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural framework governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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DOC-010 — Transparency Policy

Constitutional Transparency and Accountability Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-010 **Document Classification:** Transparency Policy **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Policy establishes the constitutional principles governing institutional transparency throughout the Chronicle OS Documentation System and defines the balance between organisational openness and the legitimate protection of confidential information.

2. Fundamental Principle

Chronicle OS shall operate with the highest practicable degree of transparency in its editorial, organisational, and governance activities. Confidentiality shall be preserved only where justified by scientific integrity, professional responsibility, legal obligations, or the protection of individual rights.

3. Institutional Transparency

Institutional transparency shall be achieved through, among other measures: publication of constitutional and regulatory instruments; publication of the Editorial Policy; publication of the Code of Publication Ethics; public description of peer review procedures; publication of information concerning the Editorial Board; publication of institutional editorial workflows; publication of official amendments to the constitutional documentation.

4. Confidentiality

Confidentiality shall be maintained with respect to: the identity of Reviewers, where applicable; confidential peer review correspondence; personal data; information protected by applicable law; confidential editorial communications; any information whose disclosure would compromise the integrity of the publication process.

5. Institutional Accountability

The Editorial Office shall bear institutional responsibility for: compliance with this Policy; the accuracy of officially published information; timely publication and maintenance of constitutional documentation; the integrity, fairness, and objectivity of editorial procedures.

6. Openness of the Constitutional Framework

All constitutional and regulatory instruments forming part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System shall be publicly accessible through official publication. Any amendment to the constitutional framework shall be communicated to all institutional participants through officially recognised publication channels.

7. Final Provisions

This Policy shall be interpreted and applied together with the Institutional Publishing Doctrine and all other constitutional and regulatory instruments comprising the Chronicle OS Documentation System. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied together with the complete constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural framework governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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DOC-011 — Appeals and Complaints Policy

Constitutional Appeals and Review Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-011 **Document Classification:** Appeals Policy **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Policy establishes the institutional procedures governing the submission, examination, and resolution of appeals, complaints, petitions, and formal requests submitted to Chronicle OS.

2. Fundamental Principle

Every submission shall receive an objective, impartial, properly documented, and procedurally fair review, irrespective of the status, affiliation, nationality, or institutional position of the applicant.

3. Scope of Appeals

Appeals and complaints may concern, including but not limited to: editorial decisions; peer review outcomes; publication ethics; conflicts of interest; procedural irregularities; actions of the Editorial Office; conduct of members of the Editorial Board; conduct of Reviewers.

4. Principles Governing Review

Every review process shall ensure: objectivity; institutional independence; the right of every party to be heard; confidentiality; complete procedural documentation; reasoned and evidence-based decisions.

5. Appeals Procedure

Authors and any other participant in the publication process may submit a reasoned appeal against an editorial or procedural decision. Where appropriate, the Editorial Office may appoint one or more additional independent experts to conduct a supplementary review. The decision reached following the appeal shall be formally documented and communicated to the parties concerned.

6. Final Provisions

This Policy shall be interpreted and applied together with the Code of Publication Ethics, the Peer Review Policy, and all other constitutional and regulatory instruments comprising the Chronicle OS Documentation System. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied together with the complete constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural framework governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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DOC-012 — Quality Assurance Policy

Constitutional Quality Assurance Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-012 **Document Classification:** Quality Assurance Policy **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Policy establishes the institutional framework governing quality assurance across all editorial, scientific, expert review, and publishing activities conducted within Chronicle OS.

2. Fundamental Principle

Quality shall be regarded as a continuous institutional process rather than a single procedural event. Continuous improvement constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS governance model.

3. Quality Assurance System

The institutional quality framework includes: internal quality control; independent expert evaluation; editorial quality control; analysis of publication performance indicators; periodic review of constitutional and regulatory documentation; continuous monitoring of international scholarly publishing standards.

4. Institutional Responsibility

Responsibility for maintaining quality is shared by: the Editorial Office; the Editorial Board; Experts; Reviewers; Authors. Each participant shall contribute, within the scope of their responsibilities, to maintaining the integrity, reliability, and academic excellence of the Chronicle OS publishing ecosystem.

5. Final Provisions

This Policy shall remain in force indefinitely unless superseded by an officially adopted revised edition. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied together with the complete constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural framework governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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DOC-013 — International Cooperation Policy

Constitutional International Cooperation Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-013 **Document Classification:** International Cooperation Policy **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Policy establishes the constitutional principles governing international cooperation within the Chronicle OS Documentation System.

2. Fundamental Principle

Chronicle OS is designed as an open international academic ecosystem dedicated to global scholarly collaboration, institutional interoperability, and the unrestricted exchange of scientific knowledge.

3. Forms of Cooperation

Chronicle OS may cooperate with: universities; research institutes; national academies of sciences; research centres; professional associations; independent researchers; international scholarly publishing organisations; other institutions whose activities are consistent with the constitutional principles of Chronicle OS.

4. Equality of Participants

All participants shall enjoy equal academic rights and opportunities irrespective of: nationality; citizenship; language; institutional affiliation; geographical location. No participant shall receive preferential or discriminatory treatment on grounds unrelated to academic merit and professional conduct.

5. Final Provisions

The continuous expansion of international academic cooperation constitutes one of the strategic objectives of Chronicle OS. This Policy shall be interpreted and applied together with the Institutional Publishing Doctrine and all other constitutional and regulatory instruments comprising the Chronicle OS Documentation System. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied together with the complete constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural framework governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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DOC-014 — Continuous Development Policy

Constitutional Continuous Development Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-014 **Document Classification:** Continuous Development Policy **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Policy establishes the constitutional principles governing the continuous evolution and institutional development of the Chronicle OS Documentation System.

2. Fundamental Principle

Chronicle OS is recognised as a living institutional system designed for continuous evolution. The System shall remain capable of adapting to changes in global scholarly communication, publishing standards, technological innovation, and institutional practice without compromising its constitutional foundations, institutional integrity, or governing principles.

3. Areas of Development

Institutional development shall include, without limitation: continuous refinement of the constitutional and regulatory framework; development of the digital infrastructure; implementation of emerging technologies; expansion of international academic cooperation; continuous enhancement of publication quality; development of the international expert community; improvement of institutional governance mechanisms; strengthening long-term sustainability and interoperability.

4. Final Provisions

All future modifications shall preserve the constitutional principles established by the Institutional Publishing Doctrine. Technological, organisational, and procedural evolution shall always remain subordinate to the constitutional framework of Chronicle OS. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be interpreted together with the complete constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural framework governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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DOC-015 — Institutional Governance Policy

Constitutional Institutional Governance Instrument

Document Identifier: DOC-015 **Document Classification:** Institutional Governance Policy **Document Layer:** Constitutional Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Language Version:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Policy completes the constitutional framework of Chronicle OS by establishing the overarching principles governing institutional administration, constitutional coherence, and systemic governance.

2. Fundamental Principle

Every organisational, editorial, technological, scientific, and administrative component of Chronicle OS shall function as an integral part of a single constitutional institutional ecosystem. All governance activities shall be exercised in accordance with the common constitutional principles established by the Chronicle OS Documentation System.

3. Constitutional Hierarchy

The supreme constitutional instrument of Chronicle OS shall be: **DOC-001 — Institutional Publishing Doctrine.** All constitutional, regulatory, operational, procedural, and technical instruments shall derive their authority from the Doctrine and shall be interpreted consistently with it. Where any inconsistency exists between documents, the instrument occupying the higher constitutional level shall prevail.

4. Institutional Unity

Editorial governance, scientific review, digital infrastructure, long-term preservation, publication policy, institutional memory, and international cooperation shall be recognised as interdependent components of a unified constitutional architecture. No individual subsystem shall operate independently from the institutional governance framework established by Chronicle OS.

5. Institutional Evolution

Individual constitutional or regulatory instruments may be revised, amended, or expanded without altering the overall constitutional architecture of the System. Fundamental constitutional principles may only be modified through the formal adoption of a new edition of the Institutional Publishing Doctrine.

6. Final Provisions

This Policy completes the constitutional structure of the Chronicle OS Master Package. Together with DOC-001 through DOC-014, it establishes the constitutional governance framework upon which all subsequent operational, procedural, technical, and institutional documentation shall be constructed. This document constitutes an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be interpreted together with the complete constitutional, regulatory, operational, and procedural framework governing the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

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END OF VOLUME I

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VOLUME II — INSTITUTIONAL PARTNERSHIP AND DEPLOYMENT FRAMEWORK

Master English Edition

Document Identifier: INS-001–INS-010 Institutional Partnership and Deployment Framework

Document Identifier: INS-001–INS-010 **Document Classification:** Institutional Partnership Framework **Document Layer:** Volume II — Institutional Deployment Layer **Edition Status:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD **Jurisdiction:** England and Wales **Date:** 18 July 2026

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CHRONICLE OS DOCUMENTATION SYSTEM — VOLUME II — INSTITUTIONAL PARTNERSHIP AND DEPLOYMENT FRAMEWORK

Master Edition — Version 1.0 | DOC ID: INS-001–INS-010

PREAMBLE

1. **INS-001** — University Partnership Agreement Framework
2. **INS-002** — University Chronicle Node Agreement
3. **INS-003** — Editorial Board Charter
4. **INS-004** — International Expert Network Charter
5. **INS-005** — Institutional Membership Rules
6. **INS-006** — University Onboarding Protocol
7. **INS-007** — Institutional Certification Standard
8. **INS-008** — Brand and Institutional Identity Policy
9. **INS-009** — International Cooperation Protocol
10. **INS-010** — Institutional Continuity and Exit Protocol

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PREAMBLE

The **Institutional Relations Package** establishes the legal, organisational, and institutional framework governing cooperation between **Chronicle OS** and universities, research institutions, scientific organisations, and other academic or educational entities.

The Package comprises ten constitutional instruments (INS-001 to INS-010), each regulating a distinct aspect of institutional cooperation within the international Chronicle OS ecosystem.

All instruments contained in this Package constitute an integral part of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied in conjunction with **Volume I (Institutional Codex)** and **Volume III (Operational Governance).**

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INS-001 — University Partnership Agreement Framework

Framework Agreement on Institutional University Partnership

Document ID: INS-001 **Document Type:** University Partnership Agreement Framework **Hierarchy:** Institutional Relations Package **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Framework Agreement establishes the legal, organisational, and institutional basis for cooperation between Chronicle OS and universities, research institutions, scientific organisations, and other academic or educational entities.

It defines the general framework governing the relationship between the Parties and serves as the constitutional basis for the execution of subsequent specialised agreements.

2. Subject Matter

The purpose of this Agreement is to establish a long term institutional partnership in the following areas:

- scientific publishing;
- development of academic communication;
- establishment and operation of a **University Chronicle Node** (as defined in the **Institutional Codex, Volume I**);
- development of the International Expert Network;
- implementation of Chronicle OS;
- joint scientific and research projects;

- digital transformation of scholarly publishing.

3. Status of the Parties

The Parties acknowledge one another as independent and autonomous institutions.

Nothing in this Agreement shall restrict the University's legal independence or alter its legal status, governance structure, or institutional autonomy.

4. Principle of Academic Autonomy

The University shall retain full academic, scientific, and organisational autonomy.

Chronicle OS shall provide the normative, organisational, and technological infrastructure necessary for cooperation without interfering in the academic governance or scientific policy of the University.

5. Scope of Cooperation

The Parties shall cooperate in the following areas:

- establishment and operation of scholarly journals;
- international peer review;
- formation of editorial boards;
- organisation of scientific events;
- preparation of international scholarly publications;
- development of expert networks;
- development of digital publishing infrastructure;
- enhancement of the University's international scientific visibility.

6. Obligations of Chronicle OS

Chronicle OS shall provide:

- the institutional regulatory framework;
- the Chronicle OS architectural framework;
- implementation support;
- methodological guidance;
- development of the International Expert Network;
- operational support for the University Chronicle Node;
- facilitation of international scientific integration.

7. Obligations of the University

The University shall:

- comply with the Chronicle OS regulatory framework;
- establish an institutional editorial office;
- appoint authorised institutional representatives;
- comply with the **Publication Ethics Policy** (Volume I, DOC-004);
- support the operation of the University Chronicle Node;
- participate in international scientific cooperation.

8. Intellectual Property

Each Party shall retain all rights, title, and interest in its respective intellectual property.

Nothing in this Agreement shall be construed as transferring ownership of intellectual property rights unless expressly provided for in a separate written agreement.

9. Use of Chronicle OS

The University shall use Chronicle OS in accordance with this Agreement and the applicable Chronicle OS regulatory framework.

The Chronicle OS institutional architecture shall be implemented in compliance with the provisions of the **Institutional Codex (Volume I).**

10. Confidentiality

Each Party shall maintain the confidentiality of information obtained in the course of cooperation.

The handling of confidential information shall be governed by separate agreements and the applicable legislation.

11. International Cooperation

This Agreement enables the University's participation in international Chronicle OS initiatives, including:

- joint scientific publications;
- collaborative research;
- educational initiatives;
- activities of the International Expert Network.

12. Term

This Agreement shall enter into force upon execution by the duly authorised representatives of the Parties and shall remain in force until terminated in accordance with its provisions.

13. Termination

Either Party may terminate this Agreement by providing written notice to the other Party.

Termination shall not affect:

- previously published works;
- registered records and identifiers;
- preservation of the institutional memory established under **Volume I**;
- the validity of editorial decisions adopted prior to termination.

14. Settlement of Disputes

The Parties shall endeavour to resolve any dispute through good faith negotiations and mutual consultation.

Where an amicable settlement cannot be reached, dispute resolution shall be governed by a separate legal instrument and the applicable law specified therein.

15. Final Provisions

This Framework Agreement constitutes the principal constitutional instrument of the **Institutional Relations Package** and shall be applied together with:

- the **Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);**
- the **Deployment Framework (Volume I);**
- the **Operational Standards (Volume I);**
- all specialised Chronicle OS agreements concluded pursuant to this Framework.

This document forms an integral part of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted together with all other governing instruments of the System.

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INS-002 — University Chronicle Node Agreement

Agreement on the Establishment and Operation of a University Chronicle Node

Document ID: INS-002 **Document Type:** University Chronicle Node Agreement **Hierarchy:** Institutional Relations Package **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Agreement establishes the legal, organizational, and operational framework for the establishment, deployment, and operation of a University Chronicle Node as a local institutional component of Chronicle OS.

This Agreement is a specialized institutional instrument and shall be executed following the conclusion of the University Partnership Agreement Framework (INS-001).

2. Scope

The purpose of this Agreement is to establish an autonomous University Chronicle Node within the Partner Institution. The Node shall operate as an integral component of the international Chronicle OS ecosystem.

3. Status of the University Chronicle Node

A University Chronicle Node constitutes the University's local scholarly publishing infrastructure operating in accordance with:

- the Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- the Deployment Framework (Volume I);
- the Operational Standards (Volume I);
- the University's internal regulations, provided they do not conflict with Chronicle OS governing documents.

A University Chronicle Node does not constitute a separate legal entity and operates within the legal framework of the Partner Institution.

4. Purpose of the University Chronicle Node

The University Chronicle Node shall provide:

- management of scholarly journals;
- manuscript submission and editorial workflow;
- international peer review;
- author support and communication;
- editorial operations;
- integration with the Chronicle Registry;
- participation in the Chronicle OS International Expert Network.

5. Authority of the University

The University retains exclusive authority over:

- the academic scope of its journals;
- the appointment of the Editorial Board;
- the internal organization of editorial activities;
- staffing of the University Chronicle Node;
- editorial policies, provided they remain consistent with the Chronicle OS regulatory framework.

6. Responsibilities of Chronicle OS

Chronicle OS shall provide:

- the institutional regulatory framework;
- methodological guidance;
- digital infrastructure support;
- coordination of the International Expert Network;
- operation of the Chronicle Registry;
- facilitation of international scholarly integration.

7. Organizational Structure

At a minimum, each University Chronicle Node shall include:

- Editor in Chief;
- Managing Editor;
- International Expert Network Coordinator;
- Technical Editor;
- Digital Infrastructure Administrator.

The University may expand this structure according to its institutional requirements.

8. International Cooperation

The University Chronicle Node may participate in:

- joint editorial initiatives;
- international thematic issues;
- international expert programmes;
- Chronicle OS collaborative projects;
- activities of the Chronicle OS International Expert Network.

9. Use of Digital Infrastructure

The University shall receive access to Chronicle OS digital infrastructure, including:

- the Chronicle Registry;
- document registration services;
- international metadata services;
- Chronicle OS digital platforms;
- additional infrastructure components as defined by the applicable operational regulations.

10. Institutional Identity

The University Chronicle Node preserves the institutional identity of the Partner University.

Participation in Chronicle OS shall not modify the University's legal status, official name, governance structure, or institutional symbols.

11. Use of Trademarks and Branding

The use of Chronicle OS trademarks, logos, and visual identity shall be governed by the Brand and Institutional Identity Policy (INS-008).

The use of the University's official symbols shall remain subject to the University's own internal regulations.

12. Institutional Memory

All scholarly outputs produced through the University Chronicle Node shall become part of the Chronicle OS Institutional Memory through registration within the Chronicle Registry.

The University shall retain ownership and control of its own institutional repositories and archival systems.

13. Suspension of Node Operations

Operations of a University Chronicle Node may be suspended:

- at the initiative of the University;
- by mutual agreement of the Parties;
- in circumstances specified by the Chronicle OS regulatory framework.

Suspension shall not affect the integrity of published materials, registry records, or institutional archives.

14. Termination

Termination of this Agreement shall not result in:

- removal of published works;
- deletion of registry records;
- destruction of institutional memory;
- invalidation of previously published scholarly outputs.

15. Final Provisions

This Agreement shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- the University Partnership Agreement Framework (INS-001);
- the Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- the Deployment Framework (Volume I);
- the Chronicle OS Operational Standards (Volume I).

This document forms an integral part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied in conjunction with all other governing documents of the System.

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INS-003 — Editorial Board Charter

Charter of the Editorial Board

Document ID: INS-003 **Document Type:** Editorial Board Charter **Hierarchy:** Institutional Relations Package **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Charter establishes the status, structure, authority, composition, appointment procedures, and operational principles governing the Editorial Boards of Chronicle OS and University Chronicle Nodes.

The document defines the unified international framework for editorial governance throughout the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

2. Fundamental Principle

The Editorial Board is an independent academic governing body responsible for the scientific oversight of editorial activities.

Editorial decisions shall be based exclusively upon scientific merit, the provisions of the Publication Ethics Policy (see Volume I, DOC-004), and the normative framework of Chronicle OS.

3. Categories of Editorial Boards

The Chronicle OS ecosystem comprises:

- the International Editorial Board of Chronicle OS;
- Editorial Boards of University Chronicle Nodes;
- Editorial Boards established for thematic publishing projects;
- temporary Editorial Committees created for specific editorial initiatives.

4. Authority of the Editorial Board

The Editorial Board shall:

- determine the scientific direction of the journal;
- approve editorial standards and policies;
- consider strategic issues relating to editorial development;
- contribute to the development of the International Expert Network;
- review complex editorial and publication matters;
- ensure the academic quality of editorial and publishing activities.

5. Scope of Competence

The Editorial Board shall not:

- interfere with the administrative governance of the University;
- exercise financial or managerial authority over institutional operations;
- assume the operational functions of the Editorial Office.

6. Composition

An Editorial Board may include:

- the Editor-in-Chief;
- Scientific Editors;
- International Editors;
- Subject Editors;
- invited specialists;
- representatives of the international academic and expert community.

7. Eligibility Requirements

Members of the Editorial Board shall:

- possess recognised academic qualifications and professional expertise;
- comply with the Publication Ethics Policy (see Volume I, DOC-004);
- comply with the Research Integrity Policy (see Volume I, DOC-006);
- maintain an established professional reputation;
- observe all applicable Chronicle OS policies and regulations;
- perform their duties independently and impartially.

8. Principle of Independence

The Editorial Board shall perform its functions independently of:

- administrative influence;
- political interference;
- commercial interests;
- institutional or governmental pressure;
- any other external factor capable of compromising scientific objectivity.

9. Meetings

Meetings of the Editorial Board may be conducted:

- in person;
- remotely;
- in a hybrid format.

All resolutions shall be formally recorded in the minutes of the meeting.

10. Decision Making

Editorial decisions may be adopted:

- by consensus;
- by majority vote;
- by any other procedure established under the internal Rules of Procedure of the Editorial Board.

Whenever practicable, scientifically reasoned consensus shall constitute the preferred decision making mechanism.

11. Conflict of Interest

Members of the Editorial Board shall disclose any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest.

Where such a conflict exists, the affected member shall abstain from participation in the consideration and decision making relating to the relevant matter.

12. International Cooperation

Editorial Boards of University Chronicle Nodes shall cooperate with the International Editorial Board of Chronicle OS in matters relating to:

- joint publications;
- international special issues;
- development of the normative framework;
- expert and peer review activities;
- exchange of editorial experience and best practice.

13. Termination of Appointment

Membership of the Editorial Board may terminate:

- upon voluntary resignation;
- upon expiration of the appointed term;
- by decision of the appointing authority;
- following violation of the Chronicle OS normative framework;
- in any other circumstances provided for by the applicable internal regulations.

14. Institutional Continuity

Changes in the composition of the Editorial Board shall not affect the continuity of operations of the relevant University Chronicle Node.

All appointments, resignations, and changes in membership shall be formally recorded within the Chronicle Registry.

15. Final Provisions

This Charter shall be applied in conjunction with:

- the Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- the Publication Ethics Policy (Volume I, DOC-004);
- the International Expert Network Charter (INS-004);
- the University Chronicle Node Agreement (INS-002);
- the Chronicle OS Operational Standards (Volume I).

This document forms an integral part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be interpreted together with all other normative documents of the system.

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INS-004 — International Expert Network Charter

Charter of the International Scientific Expert Network

Document ID: INS-004 **Document Type:** International Expert Network Charter **Hierarchy:** Institutional Relations Package **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Charter establishes the legal status, organizational structure, operating principles, and governance framework of the Chronicle OS International Expert Network.

2. Fundamental Principle

The International Expert Network is a permanent professional framework for international academic cooperation. It provides independent scholarly evaluation of scientific materials and promotes the development of international scientific communication.

3. Purpose of the Network

The International Expert Network is established to:

- organize independent peer review;
- develop an international community of academic experts;
- ensure the highest standards of scholarly evaluation;
- facilitate the exchange of professional expertise;
- promote international academic cooperation;
- support the editorial activities of University Chronicle Nodes.

4. Principle of Independence

Experts shall perform their duties independently of:

- the Editorial Office;
- University administration;
- authors';
- funding organizations;
- political, commercial, or any other external influence.

In performing their evaluations, experts shall be guided solely by scientific merit, the Publication Ethics Policy (see Volume I, DOC-004), and the Chronicle OS regulatory framework.

5. Status of an Expert

Unless otherwise provided by a separate agreement, an Expert shall not be considered an employee of Chronicle OS.

Participation in the International Expert Network is based upon professional cooperation and institutional partnership.

6. Categories of Experts

The International Expert Network may include:

- Academic Experts;
- Subject Matter Experts;
- Methodological Experts;
- Research Ethics Experts;
- Technical Experts;
- Invited International Specialists.

7. Eligibility Requirements

A candidate for membership in the International Expert Network shall:

- possess demonstrable professional qualifications;
- maintain an established academic or professional reputation;
- comply with the Publication Ethics Policy (see Volume I, DOC-004);
- comply with all applicable Chronicle OS regulations;
- formally confirm their willingness to undertake independent expert review.

8. Rights of an Expert

Experts are entitled to:

- participate in international peer review activities;
- receive methodological support from Chronicle OS;
- participate in professional development programmes;
- decline review assignments where a conflict of interest exists;
- submit recommendations for the development of the expert evaluation system.

9. Responsibilities of an Expert

Experts shall:

- maintain strict confidentiality;
- conduct reviews diligently, objectively, and within the prescribed timeframe;
- preserve professional independence;
- disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest;
- comply with the Chronicle OS regulatory framework.

10. International Expert Network Coordinator

The International Expert Network shall be administered by the Chronicle OS International Expert Network Coordinator.

The Coordinator shall:

- assign review tasks;
- maintain communication with experts;
- coordinate the development of the expert community;
- oversee compliance with established procedures.

11. Development of the Expert Network

Chronicle OS shall promote the continuous development of the International Expert Network through:

- training and onboarding of new experts;
- international exchange of professional experience;
- enhancement of professional competencies;

- continuous improvement of expert review procedures.

12. Termination of Participation

Participation in the International Expert Network may be terminated:

- voluntarily at the request of the Expert;
- by mutual agreement;
- for violation of the Publication Ethics Policy (see Volume I, DOC-004);
- for persistent failure to fulfil assigned responsibilities;
- under any other circumstances provided for by the Chronicle OS regulatory framework.

13. Institutional Memory

Information concerning the activities of Experts shall be recorded within the Chronicle Registry to the extent permitted by applicable confidentiality policies and governing legislation.

14. Final Provisions

This Charter shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- the Publication Ethics Policy (Volume I, DOC-004);
- the Editorial Board Charter (INS-003);
- the University Chronicle Node Agreement (INS-002);
- the Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- the Chronicle OS Operational Standards (Volume I).

This document forms an integral part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied in conjunction with all other governing documents of the system.

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INS-005 — Institutional Membership Rules

Institutional Membership Rules

Document ID: INS-005 **Document Type:** Institutional Membership Rules **Hierarchy:** Institutional Relations Package **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

These Rules establish the categories of participants within Chronicle OS, the procedures for obtaining institutional or individual membership, the rights and obligations of members, and the principles governing participation in the development of the international Chronicle OS ecosystem.

2. Fundamental Principle

Chronicle OS is an open international professional community of academic institutions and individual experts. The community is united by a common regulatory framework rather than by administrative hierarchy or institutional subordination.

Participation in Chronicle OS is founded upon cooperation, professional trust, and adherence to the unified Chronicle OS governance framework.

3. Categories of Participants

The Chronicle OS ecosystem may include:

- universities;
- research institutes;
- academies;
- higher education institutions;
- scholarly journals;
- research laboratories;
- editorial teams;
- academic societies;
- individual experts;
- authors’;

- editors;
- peer reviewers;
- technical specialists.

4. Institutional Members

Institutional Members are organizations that have formally joined Chronicle OS through the execution of the relevant institutional agreements.

Institutional Members are entitled to establish and operate their own University Chronicle Nodes in accordance with the Chronicle OS regulatory framework.

5. Individual Members

Individual Members are natural persons participating in Chronicle OS in one or more of the following capacities:

- authors';
- experts;
- peer reviewers;
- editors;
- technical specialists.

6. Admission to Membership

Membership status shall be granted following:

- submission of an application;
- completion of the applicable evaluation procedure;
- approval by the competent authority;
- formal acceptance of the Chronicle OS regulatory framework.

7. Rights of Members

Members are entitled to:

- participate in Chronicle OS activities;
- access the infrastructure and services available to their category of membership;
- participate in international collaborative projects;
- propose initiatives for the development of Chronicle OS;
- receive methodological and institutional support;
- participate in professional development programmes.

8. Responsibilities of Members

Members shall:

- comply with the Chronicle OS regulatory framework;
- comply with the Publication Ethics Policy (see Volume I, DOC-004);
- maintain the highest standards of professional conduct;
- respect the academic independence of other participants;
- contribute to the development of international scholarly cooperation.

9. Principle of Equal Participation

All members of Chronicle OS enjoy equal professional opportunities regardless of:

- country of origin;
- language;
- institutional affiliation;
- academic school or discipline;
- nationality;
- any other non-academic characteristic.

Professional evaluation shall be based exclusively on academic and professional merit.

10. Suspension of Membership

Membership may be temporarily suspended:

- at the request of the member;
- by mutual agreement;
- where verification of compliance with the Chronicle OS regulatory framework is required;
- in any other circumstances provided for by the applicable Chronicle OS regulations.

11. Termination of Membership

Membership may terminate:

- upon voluntary resignation;
- by mutual agreement;
- following persistent violation of the Chronicle OS regulatory framework;
- in any other circumstances provided for by the applicable regulations.

Termination of membership shall not affect the validity, integrity, or availability of previously published scholarly works.

12. Community Development

Chronicle OS recognises the continuous development of its professional community as one of its principal institutional objectives.

The system actively promotes:

- international exchange of expertise;
- collaborative research initiatives;
- educational programmes;
- professional development of editors;
- development of the international expert community;
- support for early-career researchers.

13. Final Provisions

These Rules shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- the Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- the University Partnership Agreement Framework (INS-001);
- the University Chronicle Node Agreement (INS-002);
- the International Expert Network Charter (INS-004);
- the Chronicle OS Operational Standards (Volume I).

This document forms an integral part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied in conjunction with all other governing documents of the system.

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INS-006 — University Onboarding Protocol

University Onboarding Protocol

Document ID: INS-006 **Document Type:** University Onboarding Protocol **Hierarchy:** Institutional Relations Package **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Protocol establishes the standardized procedure for onboarding a University into the Chronicle OS ecosystem and deploying a University Chronicle Node.

The Protocol is intended for practical implementation by Universities, Research Institutes, and the Chronicle OS administrative team.

2. Fundamental Principle

University onboarding shall follow a standardized implementation procedure designed to ensure consistency, scalability, and reproducibility regardless of jurisdiction, institutional size, or academic specialization.

3. Participants

The onboarding process involves:

- the University's authorised representative;
- the Institutional Implementation Project Manager;
- the Chronicle OS Coordinator;
- the prospective Editor-in-Chief of the University Chronicle Node;
- the Digital Infrastructure Administrator.

4. Phase 1. Preliminary Application

The University shall submit a formal Expression of Interest to join Chronicle OS.

The application shall include:

- the official name of the institution;
- the designated contact person;
- principal academic disciplines;
- proposed scholarly journals;
- preliminary objectives of the partnership.

5. Phase 2. Institutional Assessment

Chronicle OS shall conduct an institutional readiness assessment covering:

- editorial capacity;
- availability of an expert community;
- digital infrastructure;
- international academic engagement;
- readiness to implement and comply with the Chronicle OS regulatory framework.

6. Phase 3. Execution of Institutional Agreements

The parties shall execute:

- INS-001 University Partnership Agreement Framework;
- INS-002 University Chronicle Node Agreement;
- any additional agreements required for implementation.

7. Phase 4. Appointment of the Local Team

The University shall appoint:

- the Editor-in-Chief;
- the Managing Editor;
- the International Expert Network Coordinator;
- the Technical Editor;
- the Digital Infrastructure Administrator.

8. Phase 5. Deployment of the Digital Infrastructure

The following institutional components shall be established:

- the official University Chronicle Node website;
- the official editorial email system;
- secure access to the Chronicle Registry;
- metadata exchange services;
- official administrative communication channels.

9. Phase 6. Formation of the Editorial Board

The Editorial Board shall be constituted in accordance with the INS-003 Editorial Board Charter.

10. Phase 7. Establishment of the Expert Network

An initial pool of peer reviewers and academic experts shall be established in accordance with the INS-004 International Expert Network Charter.

11. Phase 8. Pilot Editorial Cycle

A pilot editorial workflow involving one or more manuscripts shall be conducted to validate:

- editorial procedures;
- the peer review process;
- metadata management;
- digital archiving procedures;
- operational integrity of the digital infrastructure.

12. Phase 9. Official Activation

Upon successful completion of the pilot editorial cycle, the institution shall be granted the status of **Active University Chronicle Node**.

13. Registration

The following information shall be entered into the Chronicle Registry:

- the University Chronicle Node Identifier;
- institutional information;
- Editorial Board composition;
- registered scholarly journals;
- official activation date.

14. Implementation Timeline

The recommended duration of the complete onboarding process is between **14 and 60 calendar days**, depending upon the University's level of institutional readiness.

15. Completion Criteria

The onboarding process shall be deemed successfully completed once all of the following conditions have been satisfied:

- all required institutional agreements have been executed;
- the local implementation team has been appointed;
- the digital infrastructure has been deployed;
- the Editorial Board has been formally established;
- the International Expert Network has been formed;
- the pilot editorial cycle has been successfully completed;
- the University Chronicle Node has been registered within the Chronicle Registry.

16. Final Provisions

This Protocol shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- the Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- the Deployment Framework (Volume I);
- the University Partnership Agreement Framework (INS-001);
- the University Chronicle Node Agreement (INS-002);
- the Chronicle OS Operational Standards (Volume I).

This document forms an integral part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied in conjunction with all other governing documents of the system.

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INS-007 — Institutional Certification Standard

Institutional Certification Standard

Document ID: INS-007 **Document Type:** Institutional Certification Standard **Hierarchy:** Institutional Relations Package **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Standard establishes the unified principles governing the institutional certification of organizations participating in the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

Institutional Certification confirms that an institution complies with the regulatory, organizational, and technological architecture of Chronicle OS.

2. Objective of Certification

Institutional Certification is intended to:

- confirm the operational readiness of a University Chronicle Node;
- ensure compliance with unified international standards;
- strengthen institutional trust among participating organizations;
- promote excellence in scholarly communication.

3. Scope of Certification

The following entities may be subject to certification:

- University Chronicle Nodes;
- university scholarly journals;
- Editorial Boards;
- digital publishing infrastructure;
- local expert networks;
- internal editorial workflows.

4. Principles of Certification

Certification is conducted in accordance with the principles of:

- independence;
- transparency;
- reproducibility;
- documented assessment;
- professional objectivity;
- institutional trust.

5. Evaluation Criteria

Certification shall evaluate compliance with:

- the Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- the Chronicle OS Operational Standards (Volume I);
- the Publication Ethics Policy (Volume I, DOC-004);
- the operational performance of the University Chronicle Node;
- the effectiveness of the Editorial Board;
- the functioning of the International Expert Network;
- the quality of the digital publishing infrastructure;
- proper maintenance of the Chronicle Registry.

6. Certification Levels

Following assessment, one of the following certification levels may be awarded:

Candidate Node The institution is currently implementing the Chronicle OS framework and has not yet completed the full certification process.

Certified University Chronicle Node The institution fully complies with the regulatory, organizational, and operational requirements established by Chronicle OS.

Advanced Institutional Partner The institution demonstrates a high level of operational maturity and actively contributes to the development of the international Chronicle OS architecture.

Strategic Institutional Partner The institution participates in the development of the Chronicle OS regulatory framework, international programmes, strategic initiatives, and future components of the ecosystem.

7. Certification Procedure

The certification process includes:

- submission of an application;

- documentation review;
- institutional assessment;
- preparation of the evaluation report;
- certification decision;
- registration of the certification status within the Chronicle Registry.

8. Validity of Certification

Certification remains valid indefinitely, provided that the institution continues to comply with the Chronicle OS regulatory framework.

Periodic monitoring shall be conducted through the Institutional Compliance System.

9. Suspension of Certification

Certification status may be temporarily suspended:

- at the request of the institution;
- following significant organizational restructuring;
- upon identification of serious non-compliance with the Chronicle OS regulatory framework.

10. Revocation of Certification

Certification may be revoked only following completion of a formal institutional review procedure.

The decision shall be documented through an official Certification Review Report.

11. International Recognition

The status of **Certified University Chronicle Node** confirms that the institution operates in accordance with the international governance framework established by Chronicle OS.

The institution may publicly reference this certification when presenting its scholarly publishing infrastructure to international partners, research organizations, and accreditation bodies.

12. Final Provisions

This Standard shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- the Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- the University Onboarding Protocol (INS-006);
- the Operational Compliance Manual (Volume I);
- the Chronicle Registry Standard (Volume I).

This document forms an integral part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied in conjunction with all other governing documents of the system.

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INS-008 — Brand and Institutional Identity Policy

Policy on Brand and Institutional Identity

Document ID: INS-008 **Document Type:** Brand and Institutional Identity Policy **Hierarchy:** Institutional Relations Package **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Policy establishes the principles governing the use of the official name, trademarks, visual identity, institutional designation, and brand assets of Chronicle OS by participants within the international Chronicle OS ecosystem.

2. Fundamental Principle

The Chronicle OS brand represents institutional credibility, academic integrity, and professional trust.

Authorization to use the Chronicle OS identity signifies compliance with the regulatory, organizational, and ethical standards established by the Chronicle OS Documentation System.

3. Institutional Identity Assets

The institutional identity of Chronicle OS includes:

- the official Chronicle OS name;
- official emblems and symbols;
- registered logos;
- visual identity and corporate design elements;
- official digital identifiers;
- official University Chronicle Node designations;
- any other registered elements of the Chronicle OS institutional identity.

4. Authorization to Use the Brand

The right to use the official Chronicle OS identity may be granted to:

- the International Editorial Office;
- Certified University Chronicle Nodes;
- organizations operating under valid institutional agreements;
- other authorized participants acting within the scope of their officially granted responsibilities.

5. Use of the University Chronicle Node Designation

A Certified University may use the designation **University Chronicle Node** together with its official institutional name.

Example: University Chronicle Node / University Medical School

6. Restrictions

The Chronicle OS brand shall not be used:

- without a valid institutional agreement;
- in violation of the Chronicle OS regulatory framework;
- in any misleading or deceptive manner;
- in commercial advertising unrelated to Chronicle OS activities;
- for political purposes;
- in any context inconsistent with the Publication Ethics Policy (Volume I, DOC-004).

7. Co-Branding

The joint use of the Chronicle OS identity and the University's institutional identity is permitted.

Both parties shall retain their independent institutional identities.

Co-branding shall not imply legal affiliation, organizational subordination, ownership, or governance by either party.

8. International Representation

The Chronicle OS identity may be used in international conferences, scholarly events, research programmes, and collaborative initiatives only within the scope of the participant's officially recognized institutional status.

9. Protection of Institutional Reputation

All participants shall refrain from any conduct that may damage:

- the international reputation of Chronicle OS;
- confidence in the Chronicle OS governance framework;
- the reputation of partner institutions;
- the integrity of the international scholarly community.

10. Compliance Monitoring

Chronicle OS shall monitor compliance with this Policy.

Where non-compliance is identified, the relevant participant shall receive formal notification together with a request to remedy the identified deficiencies within an appropriate period.

11. Suspension of Brand Usage Rights

Authorization to use the Chronicle OS institutional identity may be temporarily suspended:

- upon loss of institutional status;
- following material violations of the Chronicle OS regulatory framework;
- by mutual agreement between the parties.

Suspension of branding rights shall not affect previously published scholarly materials or institutional records.

12. Final Provisions

This Policy shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- the Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- the Institutional Certification Standard (INS-007);
- the University Partnership Agreement Framework (INS-001);
- the Operational Compliance Manual (Volume I).

This document forms an integral part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied in conjunction with all other governing documents of the system.

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INS-009 — International Cooperation Protocol

International Cooperation Protocol

Document ID: INS-009 **Document Type:** International Cooperation Protocol **Hierarchy:** Institutional Relations Package **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Protocol establishes the common principles governing international academic cooperation within the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

It regulates collaboration among University Chronicle Nodes, international editorial offices, research institutions, academic organizations, and other institutional partners.

2. Fundamental Principle

International cooperation within Chronicle OS is founded upon the principles of:

- academic equality;
- mutual respect;
- open scholarly communication;
- institutional autonomy;
- professional trust;
- compliance with internationally recognized academic standards.

3. Forms of Cooperation

Chronicle OS supports:

- joint scholarly publications;
- international thematic issues;
- collaborative research projects;
- exchange of academic experts;
- exchange of editors;
- academic consulting and advisory activities;
- joint educational initiatives;
- collaborative development of regulatory documentation;
- development of shared digital scholarly infrastructure.

4. International Partners

Chronicle OS may cooperate with:

- universities;

- research institutes;
- academies of sciences;
- professional scholarly associations;
- international research centres;
- other recognized academic institutions.

5. Academic Independence

Each participating institution retains full authority over its:

- academic policy;
- organizational governance;
- intellectual independence;
- research priorities.

Chronicle OS shall not interfere with the academic autonomy of its institutional partners.

6. Joint Projects

Collaborative initiatives may include:

- establishment of international editorial groups;
- joint peer review programmes;
- exchange of scholarly materials;
- organization of conferences and scientific events;
- preparation of collaborative monographs and collective publications;
- development of new regulatory documents and institutional standards.

7. International Editorial Programmes

Chronicle OS may establish International Editorial Programmes bringing together multiple University Chronicle Nodes for the preparation of joint publications, thematic issues, and collaborative research initiatives.

8. Exchange of Experts

Participating institutions may exchange experts for the purposes of:

- improving the quality of peer review;
- strengthening professional competencies;
- expanding international academic cooperation;
- fostering long-term scholarly networks.

9. Exchange of Research Information

The exchange of scholarly information shall be conducted in accordance with:

- the Chronicle Registry framework;
- applicable data protection policies;
- the Publication Ethics Policy (Volume I, DOC-004);
- applicable legislation and international regulations.

10. Resolution of Disagreements

Any issues arising during international cooperation shall be resolved through professional dialogue, consultation, and mutual agreement.

Preservation of long-term academic partnership shall constitute the primary objective of dispute resolution.

11. Continuous Development of Cooperation

Chronicle OS regards international cooperation as a continuous process contributing to the long-term development of the global scholarly ecosystem.

The Platform actively encourages the expansion of international partnerships, interdisciplinary collaboration, and institutional knowledge exchange.

12. Final Provisions

This Protocol shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- the Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- the University Partnership Agreement Framework (INS-001);
- the International Expert Network Charter (INS-004);
- the Institutional Membership Rules (INS-005);
- the Chronicle OS Operational Standards (Volume I).

This document forms an integral part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied in conjunction with all other governing documents of the system.

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INS-010 — Institutional Continuity and Exit Protocol

Protocol on Institutional Continuity and Orderly Withdrawal

Document ID: INS-010 **Document Type:** Institutional Continuity and Exit Protocol **Hierarchy:** Institutional Relations Package **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

1. Purpose

This Protocol establishes the principles and procedures that ensure institutional continuity within Chronicle OS in the event of organisational restructuring, leadership transition, institutional reorganisation, temporary suspension of activities, or withdrawal from the Chronicle OS international ecosystem.

2. Fundamental Principle

Chronicle OS is founded upon the principle that scholarly communication possesses institutional continuity.

Institutional continuity shall not depend upon individual officers, project leaders, or temporary administrative structures.

Institutions outlive their administrations.

Scholarly knowledge outlives institutions.

3. Principle of Institutional Continuity

Any organisational change affecting a participating institution, Editorial Office, or University Chronicle Node shall not interrupt:

- continuity of scholarly publishing;
- availability of published research;
- editorial operations;
- expert network activities;
- preservation of institutional memory, as defined by the Institutional Codex (Volume I).

4. Scope of Application

This Protocol applies in circumstances including, but not limited to:

- appointment of a new university administration;
- appointment of a new Editor-in-Chief;
- changes in Editorial Board membership;
- institutional restructuring;
- institutional mergers;
- departmental reorganisation;
- voluntary withdrawal from Chronicle OS;
- termination of institutional cooperation.

5. Preservation of Scholarly Heritage

Institutional or organisational changes shall never constitute grounds for:

- removal of published scholarly works;
- deletion of registration records;
- modification or deletion of Chronicle Registry entries;
- disruption of citation integrity or scholarly references.

6. Editorial Leadership Transition

Where editorial leadership changes, a formal institutional transfer procedure shall be conducted.

The transition shall include transfer of:
- editorial documentation;
- ongoing editorial projects;
- editorial archives;
- peer review records;
- digital infrastructure access credentials;
- active international cooperation agreements.

7. Reorganisation of a University Chronicle Node

Where institutional restructuring occurs, the University Chronicle Node may undergo:
- organisational restructuring;
- internal administrative modification;
- changes in editorial governance.

Such changes shall not affect the institutional continuity or recognised status of the Node.

8. Voluntary Withdrawal

A participating institution may voluntarily withdraw from Chronicle OS by submitting an official written notice.

Withdrawal procedures shall be conducted in a manner that safeguards the legitimate interests of authors', editors, reviewers, and all participants in the scholarly communication process.

9. Consequences of Withdrawal

Following withdrawal:
- the designation **University Chronicle Node** shall no longer be used;
- the right to use official Chronicle OS institutional identity shall terminate;
- previously published scholarly works shall remain permanently accessible;
- Chronicle Registry records shall remain preserved;
- institutional publication history shall remain intact.

10. Archived Institutional Node Status

Upon termination of participation, a University Chronicle Node may be designated as an **Archived Institutional Node**.

This designation confirms that the institution was formerly an official participant within Chronicle OS.

Its institutional history shall remain permanently preserved within the Chronicle Registry.

11. Reinstatement

A former participant may apply for reinstatement by completing the procedures established under the **University Onboarding Protocol (INS-006).**

Where appropriate, previously accumulated institutional records and historical information may be reinstated.

12. Institutional Memory

The Chronicle Registry shall ensure the long term preservation of:
- institutional registration records;
- partnership history;

- editorial decisions;
- publication records;
- institutional chronology.

13. Final Provisions

This Protocol shall be interpreted and applied in conjunction with:

- **Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);**
- **University Onboarding Protocol (INS-006);**
- **Institutional Certification Standard (INS-007);**
- **Chronicle Registry Standard (Volume I);**
- **Chronicle OS Operational Standards (Volume I).**

This document forms an integral part of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be applied together with all other governing documents of the Chronicle OS institutional framework.

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END OF VOLUME II

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VOLUME III — OPERATIONAL GOVERNANCE PACKAGE

Master Edition • Version 1.0

Document ID: GOV-001–015 Operational Governance Package

Document ID: GOV-001–015 **Document Type:** Operational Governance Package **Hierarchy:** Volume III • Operational Governance Layer **Status:** MASTER EDITION **Edition:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD **Jurisdiction:** England and Wales **Date:** 18 July 2026

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CHRONICLE OS DOCUMENTATION SYSTEM — VOLUME III — OPERATIONAL GOVERNANCE PACKAGE

Master Edition — Version 1.0 | DOC ID: GOV-001–015

PREAMBLE

1. **GOV-001** — Chronicle OS Governance Framework
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3. **GOV-003** — Institutional Roles and Responsibilities
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7. **GOV-007** — Context Governance Framework
8. **GOV-008** — Institutional Evolution Framework
9. **GOV-009** — Institutional Committee Framework
10. **GOV-010** — Institutional Conflict Resolution Framework
11. **GOV-011** — Institutional Audit Framework
12. **GOV-012** — Institutional Risk Management Framework
13. **GOV-013** — Institutional Performance Framework
14. **GOV-014** — Institutional Lifecycle Framework
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PREAMBLE

The **Operational Governance Package** establishes the governance architecture of Chronicle OS as an international institutional infrastructure for scholarly communication.

This Volume defines the principles governing the allocation of authority, institutional accountability, and decision making across the Chronicle OS ecosystem. These principles ensure the sustainable operation of Chronicle OS irrespective of organisational scale, geographic distribution, or the number of participating institutions.

All documents contained within this Volume form an integral part of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied in conjunction with **Volume I (Institutional Codex)** and **Volume II (Institutional Relations Package).**

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GOV-001 — Chronicle OS Governance Framework

Framework for the overall governance architecture of Chronicle OS

Document ID: GOV-001 **Document Type:** Governance Framework **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance Package **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This Framework establishes the governance architecture of Chronicle OS as an international institutional system supporting scholarly communication. It defines the principles governing institutional authority, responsibility, and decision making throughout the Chronicle OS ecosystem. These principles are intended to ensure the long term stability, consistency, and sustainability of the system regardless of its institutional scale or the number of participating entities.

Chapter 2. Governance Objectives

The Chronicle OS governance system is designed to ensure:

- institutional resilience;
- coherent coordination among all participating entities;
- preservation of the autonomy of University Chronicle Nodes;
- compliance with the institutional regulatory framework;
- continuous evolution of the international Chronicle OS ecosystem;
- protection of the long term interests of the global scholarly community.

Chapter 3. Fundamental Governance Principles

Chronicle OS governance is founded upon the following principles.

3.1 Institutional Primacy

The interests of the institution shall prevail over the interests of individual office holders, organisational units, or participating institutions.

3.2 Distributed Institutional Agency

Each University Chronicle Node retains full institutional autonomy. Chronicle OS coordinates institutional interaction without replacing or interfering with the internal governance of participating universities.

3.3 Delegated Responsibility

Authority shall be delegated to the organisational level at which decisions may be made with the highest degree of professional competence and operational efficiency.

3.4 Rule Based Governance

All governance decisions shall be based upon the approved regulatory framework of Chronicle OS. Personal preferences, local traditions, or temporary circumstances shall not replace established institutional procedures.

3.5 Architectural Consistency

The evolution of individual Chronicle OS components shall not compromise the integrity of the institutional architecture as a whole. All proposed modifications shall be evaluated with regard to their systemic impact.

3.6 Accountability and Transparency

Every governance function shall have an explicitly designated level of institutional responsibility. No operational process shall exist without clearly assigned accountability.

3.7 Evolutionary Development

Chronicle OS is recognised as a continuously evolving institutional system. Institutional procedures shall be improved through the progressive refinement of the regulatory framework while preserving the continuity of the established institutional architecture.

Chapter 4. Governance Architecture

Chronicle OS operates through a distributed multi level governance architecture. Each governance layer possesses clearly defined institutional competencies and shall not substitute the functions assigned to another governance level. Governance is based upon the principle of distributed responsibility while maintaining a unified regulatory environment.

The Chronicle OS governance architecture consists of:

- International Governance Layer;
- Institutional Governance Layer;
- Local Governance Layer;
- Operational Governance Layer.

All governance layers interact through formally established governance protocols.

Chapter 5. International Governance Layer

The International Governance Layer provides strategic direction for the long term development of Chronicle OS. Its responsibilities include:

- development of the institutional architecture;
- approval of regulatory documentation;
- formulation of international governance policy;
- development of international partnerships;
- coordination of strategic programmes;
- preservation of regulatory coherence;
- governance of Chronicle Registry;
- maintenance of the integrity of the Chronicle OS Documentation System.

The International Governance Layer shall not perform operational management of individual universities. Its primary function is to preserve the institutional stability of the international Chronicle OS ecosystem.

Chapter 6. Institutional Governance Layer

The Institutional Governance Layer is represented by each University Chronicle Node. Each University Chronicle Node independently manages:

- editorial activities;
- internal governance procedures;
- author relations;
- expert relations;
- publication workflows;
- local digital infrastructure;
- institutional scholarly communication.

Institutional decisions shall be taken independently, provided they remain fully consistent with the Chronicle OS regulatory framework. Chronicle OS shall not interfere with the academic autonomy

of participating universities where University Chronicle Nodes operate in compliance with the governing documentation. Each University Chronicle Node remains responsible for the quality of its own institutional governance while simultaneously contributing to the integrity of the international environment of scholarly trust.

Chapter 7. Operational Governance Layer

The Operational Governance Layer performs the day to day execution of Chronicle OS activities. Operational roles include:

- Editor in Chief;
- Managing Editor;
- Editorial Secretary;
- Expert Network Coordinator;
- Chronicle Registry Operator;
- Technical Editor;
- University Chronicle Node System Administrator;
- additional operational roles established by the participating institution.

Operational governance implements approved institutional procedures and shall not modify the regulatory architecture of Chronicle OS.

Chapter 8. Distribution of Authority

Authority shall be allocated according to functional competence.

- Strategic matters shall be governed at the International Governance Layer.
- Institutional matters shall be governed by the University Chronicle Node.
- Operational matters shall be governed by designated operational officers.

Delegation of authority shall occur only within the limits established by the Chronicle OS regulatory framework. Incompatible governance functions shall not be concentrated within a single role where such concentration may compromise institutional objectivity.

Chapter 9. Decision Making

Governance decisions within Chronicle OS are classified as:

- Strategic Decisions;
- Institutional Decisions;
- Operational Decisions;
- Architectural Decisions.

Architectural decisions concern modifications to the Chronicle OS regulatory framework, Documentation System, Chronicle Registry, and other foundational institutional components. All architectural decisions shall be evaluated with regard to their impact upon the integrity of the Chronicle OS institutional architecture. Every governance decision shall be documented, traceable, reproducible, and compliant with the Chronicle OS regulatory framework.

Chapter 10. Architectural Oversight

Architectural Oversight safeguards the integrity of Chronicle OS as an international institutional system. Oversight applies to:

- regulatory documentation;
- organisational structures;
- digital infrastructure;
- institutional procedures;
- interaction mechanisms;
- development of the Documentation System.

Architectural Oversight shall not replace operational governance. Its purpose is to ensure that institutional evolution remains consistent with the approved Chronicle OS architecture.

Chapter 11. Change Governance

Chronicle OS recognises institutional change as an inherent component of sustainable organisational evolution. Every institutional modification shall:

- be supported by documented justification;
- be evaluated against the existing regulatory framework;
- preserve compatibility with previously adopted institutional decisions;
- ensure complete traceability of changes;
- maintain institutional resilience.

All regulatory amendments shall be implemented through the official versioning procedures of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. Each approved edition shall become part of the institutional memory of Chronicle OS.

Chapter 12. Final Provisions

This Framework shall be applied in conjunction with:

- Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- Chronicle OS Documentation System;
- Institutional Relations Package (Volume II);
- Operational Procedures;
- Chronicle Registry Standards (Volume I);
- Institutional Certification Framework (INS-007).

This Framework establishes the foundational governance model of Chronicle OS and serves as the basis for the development of operational procedures, administrative regulations, and digital governance workflows supporting the international Chronicle OS institutional ecosystem. This document forms an integral part of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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GOV-002 — International Governance Structure

International institutional governance architecture

Document ID: GOV-002 **Document Type:** International Governance Structure **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance Package **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master English Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This document establishes the international governance structure of Chronicle OS. It defines the distribution of institutional functions among the international governing bodies of Chronicle OS and specifies their respective areas of competence.

Chapter 2. Principle of Distributed Governance

Chronicle OS does not operate under a centralised administrative model. International governance is exercised through the coordinated interaction of specialised governing bodies, each operating within its own defined sphere of institutional competence. No governing body possesses unlimited authority. The governance architecture is founded upon the principle of institutional balance and mutual accountability.

Chapter 3. International Institutional Governance Layer

The International Governance Layer is responsible for:

- preserving the institutional architecture of Chronicle OS;
- developing the regulatory framework;
- coordinating international activities;
- safeguarding the long term interests of the global Chronicle OS ecosystem.

This governance layer shall neither perform operational management of participating universities nor interfere with their academic autonomy.

Chapter 4. International Architecture Council

The International Architecture Council shall be responsible for:

- development of the **Institutional Codex** (Volume I);
- development of the Documentation System;
- approval of new regulatory documents;
- evaluation of architectural modifications;
- ensuring compatibility between proposed developments and the existing institutional architecture.

The Council shall adopt its decisions exclusively in accordance with the approved regulatory framework of Chronicle OS.

Chapter 5. International Editorial Council

The International Editorial Council shall be responsible for:

- development of international editorial policy;
- coordination of Editorial Boards;
- continuous development of the **Publication Ethics Framework** (Volume I, DOC-004);
- supervision of international scholarly publishing programmes;
- enhancement of the quality of scholarly communication.

The Council shall not intervene in the independent peer review of individual manuscripts.

Chapter 6. International Expert Council

The International Expert Council shall be responsible for:

- development of the Chronicle OS International Expert Network;
- establishment of standards governing expert activities;
- development of reviewer education programmes;
- evaluation of professional standards within the expert community.

Chapter 7. International Digital Infrastructure Council

The International Digital Infrastructure Council shall oversee the development of the technological environment supporting Chronicle OS. Its responsibilities include:

- development of the Chronicle Registry;
- development of Chronicle Nodes;
- digital identity management;
- integration of international digital services;
- interoperability of digital components;
- maintenance of the Documentation System within the digital environment;
- development of automation tools supporting scholarly communication.

The Council shall ensure the technological resilience of the international Chronicle OS ecosystem.

Chapter 8. International Certification Council

The International Certification Council shall be responsible for:

- development of institutional assessment criteria;
- development of Chronicle Certification Standards;
- supervision of institutional audit procedures;
- certification of University Chronicle Nodes against Chronicle OS requirements;
- continuous refinement of institutional maturity models.

The Certification Council shall operate independently of editorial governance bodies.

Chapter 9. Coordination of Governance Councils

International Councils shall cooperate on the basis of the approved Chronicle OS regulatory framework. Each Council shall adopt decisions solely within its designated institutional competence. Where matters extend across multiple areas of responsibility, temporary joint working groups may be established. No Council shall modify or assume the competence assigned to another Council.

Chapter 10. Principle of Collegial Governance

Strategic governance decisions shall be adopted collectively. Decision making shall consider scholarly implications, institutional implications, architectural implications, technological implications, and international implications. Collegial governance is regarded as a fundamental mechanism ensuring institutional stability and balanced decision making.

Chapter 11. Principle of Institutional Independence

Each international governing body shall perform its functions independently of commercial, political, or other external interests. Governance decisions shall be guided exclusively by scholarly integrity, institutional sustainability, compliance with the Documentation System, and compliance with the **Institutional Codex** (Volume I).

Chapter 12. Final Provisions

This document shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- Chronicle OS Documentation System;
- Governance Framework (GOV-001);
- Institutional Relations Package (Volume II);
- Chronicle Registry Standards (Volume I).

The international governance structure of Chronicle OS may evolve in response to the expansion of the global Chronicle OS network. Such evolution shall preserve the principles of the distributed institutional architecture established by the Chronicle OS Documentation System. This document forms an integral part of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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GOV-003 — Institutional Roles and Responsibilities

Definition of operational roles and institutional accountability

Document ID: GOV-003 **Document Type:** Institutional Roles and Responsibilities **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This document defines the principal institutional roles within Chronicle OS and establishes the scope of authority, responsibilities, and accountability associated with each role. It provides the normative foundation for the development of operational procedures, institutional regulations, and administrative workflows throughout the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

Chapter 2. Principle of Functional Responsibility

Within Chronicle OS, responsibility is assigned according to institutional function rather than organizational position or employment status. A single individual may perform multiple roles, provided that such assignments do not compromise independence, impartiality, or the principle of separation of responsibilities. Conversely, the same institutional role may be fulfilled by different individuals across different University Chronicle Nodes.

Chapter 3. System Architect

The System Architect is responsible for the long term institutional architecture and strategic development of Chronicle OS. The responsibilities of the System Architect include:

- development of the Chronicle OS institutional architecture;
- maintenance and evolution of the Documentation System;
- coordination of the normative framework;
- assessment of architectural compatibility of new components;
- evaluation of systemic changes and their long term institutional impact.

The System Architect does not participate in operational editorial management or day to day institutional administration.

Chapter 4. Institutional Coordinator

The Institutional Coordinator serves as the primary liaison between a University Chronicle Node and the international Chronicle OS ecosystem. Responsibilities include:

- coordination of institutional onboarding;
- facilitation of institutional communication;
- support of inter institutional cooperation;
- guidance regarding Chronicle OS regulatory documentation;
- assistance in the development and operation of the University Chronicle Node.

Chapter 5. Editor in Chief of the University Chronicle Node

The Editor in Chief provides scientific and editorial leadership for the University Chronicle Node. The Editor in Chief is responsible for:

- defining editorial policy;
- ensuring scientific quality and editorial integrity;
- supervising the Editorial Board;
- making final editorial decisions;
- representing the University Chronicle Node within the international Chronicle OS community.

The Editor in Chief is accountable for compliance with the Publication Ethics Policy (see Volume I, DOC-004) and for maintaining the scientific integrity of editorial activities.

Chapter 6. Managing Editor

The Managing Editor administers the editorial workflow of the University Chronicle Node. Responsibilities include:

- coordination of editorial operations;
- assignment and tracking of manuscripts;
- supervision of procedural compliance;
- communication with reviewers;
- preparation of manuscripts for publication.

Unless otherwise provided by the internal regulations of the University Chronicle Node, the Managing Editor does not make final publication decisions.

Chapter 7. Chronicle Registry Operator

The Chronicle Registry Operator administers the institutional registry of Chronicle OS. Responsibilities include:

- registration of institutional entities;
- maintenance of publication records;
- management of registry entries;
- verification of metadata integrity;
- preservation of institutional traceability;
- long term archival maintenance of registry information.

The Registry Operator neither modifies scientific content nor participates in editorial decision making.

Chapter 8. Technical Editor

The Technical Editor is responsible for preparing publication materials for production and digital dissemination. Responsibilities include:

- verification of manuscript formatting;
- validation of metadata completeness;
- compliance with Documentation System requirements;
- preparation of publication ready digital files;
- coordination with Chronicle OS digital infrastructure.

The Technical Editor does not perform scientific peer review or editorial evaluation.

Chapter 9. System Administrator of the University Chronicle Node

The System Administrator ensures the reliable operation of the local digital infrastructure of the University Chronicle Node. Responsibilities include:

- administration of digital services;
- management of access permissions;
- maintenance of local Chronicle Node components;
- information security;
- technical support for institutional users.

Chapter 10. Principle of Separation of Responsibilities

Chronicle OS operates under the mandatory principle of functional separation. No individual shall simultaneously perform roles whose combination could compromise the objectivity, transparency, or integrity of scientific evaluation. Editorial management, peer review, registry administration, and technical operations constitute independent functional domains within the institutional architecture.

Chapter 11. Individual Accountability

Every participant in Chronicle OS bears personal responsibility for the proper execution of the institutional functions assigned to their role. The scope of accountability is determined by the authority associated with the role, the nature of the assigned responsibilities, the applicable Chronicle OS normative documentation, and the institutional commitments accepted by the participant.

Chapter 12. Final Provisions

This document shall be applied in conjunction with:

- **GOV-001** Chronicle OS Governance Framework;
- **GOV-002** International Governance Structure;
- **Volume II** Institutional Relations Package;
- Operational Procedures;
- Chronicle Registry Standards (Volume I).

The catalogue of institutional roles may be expanded as Chronicle OS evolves. Such expansion shall not alter the fundamental principles governing the allocation of authority, accountability, and institutional responsibility. This document forms an integral part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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GOV-004 — Decision Making Framework

Institutional decision making architecture

Document ID: GOV-004 **Document Type:** Decision Making Framework **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This Framework establishes the principles governing the preparation, review, adoption, recording, and implementation of managerial decisions within the international institutional ecosystem of Chronicle OS. It defines a unified decision making model designed to ensure transparency, consistency, accountability, and institutional continuity across all levels of the Chronicle OS governance architecture.

Chapter 2. Principle of Normative Decision Making

Within Chronicle OS, no managerial decision shall be based solely on individual discretion. Every decision shall be grounded in the applicable normative documentation forming part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. Where no appropriate normative basis exists, the matter shall first be

addressed through development of a new normative document or amendment of the existing documentation. Institutional practice shall never replace formally established governance standards.

Chapter 3. Classification of Decisions

Managerial decisions within Chronicle OS are classified into the following categories:

Architectural Decisions — Decisions affecting the institutional architecture, structural model, or long term development of Chronicle OS.

Normative Decisions — Decisions establishing, amending, interpreting, or retiring documents within the Chronicle OS Documentation System.

Institutional Decisions — Decisions concerning the governance and operation of University Chronicle Nodes or other institutional participants.

Operational Decisions — Decisions supporting routine administrative, editorial, and organizational activities.

Technical Decisions — Decisions relating to the operation, maintenance, development, or security of the Chronicle OS digital infrastructure.

Chapter 4. Decision Preparation Process

Every managerial decision shall follow a documented decision lifecycle consisting of the following stages: initiation; review of the applicable normative framework; assessment of institutional implications; consultation and coordination; formal approval; registration; implementation; archival recording. No stage may be omitted unless expressly authorized by the governing normative framework.

Chapter 5. Principle of Traceability

Every decision adopted within Chronicle OS shall remain fully traceable throughout its institutional lifecycle. The following information shall be recorded for each decision: initiating party; date of adoption; normative basis; governing authority; designated responsible parties; implementation status; relationships to preceding or subsequent decisions. Decision traceability forms an integral element of Chronicle Registry and the institutional memory of Chronicle OS.

Chapter 6. Decision Registration

All strategic, architectural, and normative decisions shall be registered within Chronicle Registry. Registration serves to ensure preservation of institutional memory, legal and procedural traceability, historical accountability, analysis of institutional development, and continuity of governance. The Registry constitutes the authoritative record of institutional decision history.

Chapter 7. Final Provisions

This Framework shall be interpreted and applied in conjunction with:

- Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- Governance Framework (GOV-001);
- International Governance Structure (GOV-002);
- Institutional Relations Package (Volume II);
- Chronicle Registry Standards (Volume I);
- Operational Governance Documentation.

This document forms an integral component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and shall be applied together with all other normative documents of the system.

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GOV-005 — Principles of Institutional Operation

Fundamental principles governing institutional operations

Document ID: GOV-005 **Document Type:** Principles of Institutional Operation **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This document establishes the fundamental principles governing the operation of Chronicle OS as an international institutional infrastructure for scholarly communication. The principles set forth herein are binding upon all participants in Chronicle OS, irrespective of their institutional affiliation, governance level, or scope of authority.

Chapter 2. Principle of Institutional Trust

Institutional trust constitutes the primary strategic asset of Chronicle OS. Every component of the system shall contribute to strengthening international trust through compliance with the established regulatory framework, transparency of institutional activities, consistency of governance, reproducibility of operational processes, and accountability for institutional decisions. Institutional trust is regarded as a cumulative outcome of the consistent application of Chronicle OS governance standards.

Chapter 3. Principle of Academic Autonomy

Each University Chronicle Node independently determines its own scholarly priorities, research agenda, and academic activities. Chronicle OS provides a unified institutional framework for scholarly communication but does not intervene in the intellectual content, scientific direction, or academic independence of participating institutions.

Chapter 4. Principle of Normative Continuity

Every institutional process within Chronicle OS shall be governed by documented normative provisions. Critical institutional activities shall not rely upon informal arrangements, undocumented practices, personal traditions, individual experience, or institutional custom unsupported by the Documentation System. Every reproducible institutional activity shall be formally documented within the Chronicle OS normative framework.

Chapter 5. Principle of Digital Traceability

Every institutional process shall be capable of digital traceability throughout its lifecycle. Digital traceability supports accountability of institutional decisions, preservation of institutional memory, subsequent institutional analysis, reproducibility of operational procedures, and protection against the loss of critical institutional information. Where applicable, institutional records shall be maintained through Chronicle Registry.

Chapter 6. Principle of Minimal Administrative Burden

Chronicle OS seeks to minimise administrative procedures that do not contribute directly to the quality, integrity, or reliability of scholarly communication. Automation is recognised as the primary mechanism for reducing operational workload within University Chronicle Nodes. Normative documentation shall therefore be designed so that the greatest possible proportion of institutional processes may be implemented through the Chronicle OS digital infrastructure. Administrative complexity shall never become an objective in itself.

Chapter 7. Final Provisions

This document shall be interpreted and applied in conjunction with:

- Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- Governance Framework (GOV-001);
- Decision Making Framework (GOV-004);
- Institutional Relations Package (Volume II);
- Chronicle Registry Standards (Volume I);
- Operational Governance Documentation.

This document forms an integral component of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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GOV-006 — Institutional Continuity Framework

Institutional continuity architecture

Document ID: GOV-006 **Document Type:** Institutional Continuity Framework **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This Framework establishes the principles and mechanisms that ensure the continuous operation of Chronicle OS regardless of changes in personnel, institutional structure, technological infrastructure, or external circumstances. Institutional continuity constitutes one of the fundamental governance principles upon which Chronicle OS is built. The long term stability of the System derives from its institutional architecture rather than from any particular organization, technology, or individual.

Chapter 2. Principle of Independence from Individuals

Chronicle OS operates independently of any specific individual. Changes in personnel shall not alter the institutional architecture, operational procedures, normative documentation, governance principles, or the continuity of the international ecosystem. No institutional function shall depend exclusively upon the knowledge, authority, or participation of a single individual. Institutional resilience shall always prevail over personal dependency.

Chapter 3. Principle of Institutional Memory

All significant institutional assets shall be permanently preserved within Chronicle Registry, including governance decisions, normative documents, document revisions, registration records, architectural modifications, and institutional history. Institutional memory is recognized as an independent strategic asset of Chronicle OS. Its preservation ensures continuity, accountability, and the cumulative development of the System across successive generations of participants.

Chapter 4. Principle of Reproducibility

Every institutional process defined within the Chronicle OS Documentation System shall be reproducible regardless of the individual performing it. The transfer of institutional responsibilities shall not modify the logic, integrity, or expected outcome of any governed process. Operational reproducibility is achieved through the coordinated application of the Chronicle OS Documentation System, Operational Procedures, standardized digital workflows, and Chronicle Registry. Institutional knowledge shall remain embedded within the System rather than within individual participants.

Chapter 5. Principle of Scalability

The architecture of Chronicle OS is designed for progressive international expansion without requiring modification of its foundational governance model. New University Chronicle Nodes shall be integrated exclusively through established institutional procedures and normative standards. Growth of the international ecosystem shall strengthen, rather than compromise, the coherence of the Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I). Scalability is therefore understood as architectural extensibility without institutional fragmentation.

Chapter 6. Principle of Sustainable Institutional Development

Every modification to Chronicle OS shall be evaluated according to its long term impact upon the institutional ecosystem. Priority shall be given to decisions that strengthen institutional resilience, architectural compatibility, normative consistency, the advancement of scholarly communication, and the confidence of the international academic community. Short term operational convenience shall never take precedence over the long term integrity of the institutional architecture.

Chapter 7. Final Provisions

This Framework shall be interpreted and applied in conjunction with:

- Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- Governance Framework (GOV-001);
- Decision Making Framework (GOV-004);

- Institutional Relations Package (Volume II);
- Chronicle Registry Standards (Volume I);
- Operational Governance Documentation.

This document forms an integral component of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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GOV-007 — Context Governance Framework

Framework for institutional context governance

Document ID: GOV-007 **Document Type:** Context Governance Framework **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This Framework establishes the principles governing the institutional context of Chronicle OS. Within Chronicle OS, the institutional context is understood as the integrated system of normative, organizational, technological, and scholarly relationships that collectively define the operational state of the international scientific communication ecosystem. Rather than treating context as background information, Chronicle OS recognizes it as a governed institutional asset requiring continuous stewardship.

Chapter 2. Context as the Primary Object of Governance

Within Chronicle OS, governance is not directed toward individual publications, isolated participants, or separate organizational units. The primary object of governance is the institutional context within which scholarly communication takes place. Every publication, editorial process, institutional interaction, and technological operation exists as part of a continuously evolving contextual environment. Accordingly, any modification of the institutional context represents a modification of the operational state of the System itself.

Chapter 3. Formation of the Institutional Context

The institutional context emerges through the coordinated interaction of the following components: the Documentation System; Chronicle Registry; University Chronicle Nodes; the International Expert Network; the Editorial Network; the digital infrastructure; the normative framework; institutional memory. No individual component independently creates the institutional context. Institutional context is an emergent property arising from the coordinated operation of the entire Chronicle OS ecosystem.

Chapter 4. Maintenance of the Institutional Context

The integrity of the institutional context is maintained through continuous adherence to the Documentation System, systematic maintenance of the normative framework, preservation of institutional memory, registration of institutional changes, maintenance of the digital infrastructure, and continuous development of international cooperation. Context governance is therefore understood as an ongoing institutional process rather than a sequence of isolated administrative actions.

Chapter 5. Context Evolution

Any modification affecting the institutional context shall be normatively justified, formally documented, registered within Chronicle Registry, and evaluated with regard to its impact upon the international institutional ecosystem. Modifications within an individual University Chronicle Node shall not compromise the integrity or consistency of the global institutional context of Chronicle OS. Local evolution shall remain compatible with the coherence of the international architecture.

Chapter 6. Contextual Resilience

Chronicle OS recognizes contextual resilience as one of the principal indicators of institutional maturity. An institutional context is considered resilient when changes affecting individual components do not compromise the integrity, continuity, or coherence of the overall architecture of scholarly

communication. The resilience of the System depends not upon the stability of its individual elements, but upon the stability of the relationships connecting them.

Chapter 7. Final Provisions

This Framework shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- Governance Framework (GOV-001);
- Institutional Continuity Framework (GOV-006);
- Chronicle Registry Standards (Volume I);
- Operational Governance Documentation.

This document forms an integral component of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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GOV-008 — Institutional Evolution Framework

Framework governing institutional evolution

Document ID: GOV-008 **Document Type:** Institutional Evolution Framework **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This Framework establishes the principles governing the institutional evolution of Chronicle OS as an international system for scholarly communication. Its purpose is to ensure the continuous advancement of Chronicle OS while preserving the integrity, coherence, and stability of its normative architecture. Institutional evolution shall strengthen the System without compromising its foundational principles.

Chapter 2. Principle of Continuous Evolution

Chronicle OS is recognized as an open institutional system. Continuous evolution constitutes its natural operational state. Institutional stagnation is regarded as a strategic governance risk, as it diminishes the System's capacity to respond to scientific, technological, and organizational change. Sustainable development therefore represents a permanent institutional obligation rather than an optional activity.

Chapter 3. Sources of Institutional Evolution

Institutional evolution may be initiated by developments within the international research environment, advances in digital technologies, operational experience gained by University Chronicle Nodes, recommendations submitted by the international expert community, findings arising from institutional audits, new scholarly research, and changes in international publishing practices. Every proposed modification shall undergo normative evaluation before becoming part of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. Institutional evolution shall always proceed through governed adaptation rather than spontaneous change.

Chapter 4. Principle of Institutional Feedback

Every University Chronicle Node serves as a source of institutional feedback. Operational experience is regarded as one of the principal mechanisms driving the long term evolution of Chronicle OS. Information collected through practical implementation shall be analyzed, documented, and incorporated into subsequent revisions of the normative framework where appropriate. Institutional knowledge is therefore accumulated through continuous operational learning.

Chapter 5. Institutional Experimentation

Chronicle OS permits carefully controlled institutional experimentation. An institutional experiment may be conducted only when the following conditions are satisfied: a clearly documented objective; predefined evaluation criteria; a limited implementation scope; full compatibility with the existing institutional architecture; mandatory registration of all outcomes. Experimental activities shall not

modify the normative framework until their results have been formally evaluated and validated. Innovation shall always remain subordinate to institutional integrity.

Chapter 6. Implementation of Institutional Change

Following formal evaluation, proposed changes may be rejected, returned for further refinement, incorporated into a revised edition of the Documentation System, or adopted as newly established normative documents. Every approved modification shall be reflected through formal version control, ensuring complete traceability of the institutional evolution of Chronicle OS. Normative evolution shall always preserve compatibility with the historical continuity of the System.

Chapter 7. Final Provisions

This Framework shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- Governance Framework (GOV-001);
- Institutional Continuity Framework (GOV-006);
- Documentation System Standards;
- Operational Governance Documentation.

This document forms an integral component of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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GOV-009 — Institutional Committee Framework

Framework governing institutional committees

Document ID: GOV-009 **Document Type:** Institutional Committee Framework **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This Framework establishes the principles governing the establishment, composition, authority, and operation of the institutional committees of Chronicle OS. Institutional committees are specialized collegiate bodies established to examine matters requiring multidisciplinary expertise, collective professional judgment, or normative evaluation. They serve as governance mechanisms supporting informed institutional decision making throughout the Chronicle OS ecosystem.

Chapter 2. Principle of the Committee Model

Chronicle OS adopts a committee based governance model as a mechanism for collective professional expertise. Institutional committees do not replace the authority or responsibilities of individual office holders. Instead, they provide structured deliberation for matters whose complexity extends beyond the competence of any single institutional role. The committee model promotes balanced judgment, interdisciplinary cooperation, and institutional accountability.

Chapter 3. Standing Committees

The following standing committees may operate within Chronicle OS: Architectural Committee; Publication Ethics Committee; Digital Infrastructure Committee; Certification Committee; Institutional Development Committee; International Cooperation Committee. Additional standing committees may be established whenever institutional development requires expanded governance capacity.

Chapter 4. Ad Hoc Committees

Temporary committees may be established to address specific institutional matters. Such committees may be convened for purposes including implementation of international projects, institutional audits, development of new normative documentation, resolution of complex institutional issues, and supervision of institutional pilot initiatives or experimental programmes. An ad hoc committee shall cease to exist upon completion of its assigned mandate.

Chapter 5. Committee Authority

Within the scope of its competence, a committee may examine institutional matters, prepare recommendations, initiate proposals for normative development, submit recommendations to the appropriate international governance bodies, conduct expert deliberations, and establish temporary working groups. Institutional committees shall not independently amend, approve, or repeal the normative documentation of Chronicle OS. Normative authority remains vested in the governance bodies designated by the Chronicle OS Documentation System.

Chapter 6. Principle of Committee Independence

Institutional committees shall perform their functions independently of administrative pressure, commercial interests, political influence, or external institutional interference. Committee deliberations shall be conducted exclusively on the basis of the Chronicle OS Documentation System, the Institutional Codex (Volume I), the applicable Governance Frameworks, officially registered institutional records, and the principles of scientific integrity and professional ethics. Committee independence is essential to preserving the institutional credibility and objectivity of Chronicle OS.

Chapter 7. Final Provisions

This Framework shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- Governance Framework (GOV-001);
- International Governance Structure (GOV-002);
- Decision Making Framework (GOV-004);
- Operational Governance Documentation.

This document forms an integral component of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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GOV-010 — Institutional Conflict Resolution Framework

Framework governing institutional dispute resolution

Document ID: GOV-010 **Document Type:** Institutional Conflict Resolution Framework **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This Framework establishes the procedures governing the identification, review, and resolution of institutional conflicts arising within Chronicle OS. For the purposes of this Framework, an institutional conflict shall mean any disagreement or dispute involving participants, governance bodies, or University Chronicle Nodes that may affect the stability, integrity, or effective functioning of the international scholarly communication ecosystem maintained by Chronicle OS.

Chapter 2. Fundamental Principles of Conflict Resolution

Institutional conflicts shall be resolved in accordance with the following principles: institutional impartiality; normative consistency; equality of all participants; procedural transparency and documentation; preservation of international institutional trust. Personal relationships, individual preferences, or informal considerations shall not constitute valid grounds for institutional decision making.

Chapter 3. Categories of Institutional Conflicts

Institutional conflicts may include, but are not limited to: editorial conflicts; expert review conflicts; institutional conflicts; normative conflicts; technical conflicts; ethical conflicts. Each category shall be examined in accordance with the procedures applicable to its respective institutional context.

Chapter 4. Conflict Resolution Procedure

Institutional conflicts shall be reviewed through the following stages: registration of the complaint or request; preliminary assessment; determination of the competent authority; collection of rele-

vant materials; expert review; adoption of a formal decision; registration of the outcome; monitoring of implementation. Every stage of the procedure shall be properly documented to ensure institutional traceability and accountability.

Chapter 5. Principle of Conflict Minimization

The primary objective of Chronicle OS is not to identify a responsible party but to restore the stability and effectiveness of institutional cooperation. Whenever a conflict may be resolved through clarification of the normative framework or improvement of institutional procedures, the preparation of such improvements shall accompany the review of the specific case. Institutional learning shall therefore constitute an integral component of every conflict resolution process.

Chapter 6. Appeals

Every participant of Chronicle OS shall have the right to request an independent review of an institutional decision. Appeals shall be considered by a competent body that has not participated in the original review of the matter. The outcome of every appeal shall be formally recorded in the Chronicle Registry to ensure procedural transparency and institutional continuity.

Chapter 7. Final Provisions

This Framework shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- Governance Framework (GOV-001);
- Decision Making Framework (GOV-004);
- Publication Ethics (Volume I, DOC-004);
- Chronicle Registry Standards.

This document forms an integral component of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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GOV-011 — Institutional Audit Framework

Framework governing institutional audit

Document ID: GOV-011 **Document Type:** Institutional Audit Framework **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This Framework establishes the principles and procedures governing institutional audits within Chronicle OS. An institutional audit is a structured evaluation of the extent to which a University Chronicle Node complies with the requirements established by the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and the **Institutional Codex**. The primary purpose of an institutional audit is to support continuous institutional improvement. An audit is developmental in nature and shall not be regarded as a disciplinary or punitive procedure.

Chapter 2. Principles of Institutional Audit

Institutional audits shall be conducted in accordance with the following principles: independence; objectivity; reproducibility; normative consistency; comprehensive documentation; continuous institutional quality improvement. Institutional audits are not intended to evaluate the performance of individual persons. The primary subject of evaluation shall be institutional processes, governance mechanisms, operational procedures, and organizational effectiveness.

Chapter 3. Scope of Audit

Institutional audits may evaluate, among other components: University Chronicle Nodes; editorial procedures; peer review processes; digital infrastructure; registration workflows; the Documentation System; compliance with normative requirements; the quality of institutional cooperation and governance.

Chapter 4. Types of Audit

Chronicle OS recognizes the following categories of institutional audit:

Scheduled Audit — Conducted according to an approved institutional audit schedule.

Extraordinary Audit — Initiated where documented circumstances justify additional institutional review.

Thematic Audit — Focused on a specific operational process or functional area.

Architectural Audit — Evaluates the conformity of an institutional model with the architectural principles and governance standards of Chronicle OS.

Chapter 5. Audit Outcomes

Upon completion of an institutional audit, one or more of the following may be issued: recommendations for improvement; institutional development plans; proposals for enhancement of the normative framework; proposals concerning digital infrastructure; proposals for procedural optimization. An institutional audit shall not constitute a disciplinary investigation or a mechanism for imposing sanctions.

Chapter 6. Institutional Development

Audit results shall serve as a strategic resource for the continuous development of Chronicle OS. Each completed audit contributes to the accumulation of institutional knowledge and organizational maturity. Where appropriate, audit findings may inform future revisions of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System**, governance frameworks, operational procedures, and institutional standards.

Chapter 7. Final Provisions

This Framework shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- Governance Framework (GOV-001);
- Institutional Continuity Framework (GOV-006);
- Institutional Certification Standard (Volume II, INS-007);
- Chronicle Registry Standards.

This document forms an integral component of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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GOV-012 — Institutional Risk Management Framework

Framework governing institutional risk management

Document ID: GOV-012 **Document Type:** Institutional Risk Management Framework **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This Framework establishes the institutional system for the identification, assessment, mitigation, monitoring, and governance of risks within Chronicle OS. For the purposes of this Framework, an institutional risk shall mean any event, condition, or combination of circumstances capable of adversely affecting the stability, integrity, continuity, or effective operation of Chronicle OS, a University Chronicle Node, or the broader international scholarly communication ecosystem.

Chapter 2. Principles of Risk Management

Institutional risk management shall be governed by the following principles: prevention shall take precedence over remediation; risks shall be assessed before institutional decisions are implemented; every identified risk shall have a designated owner responsible for its management; all institutional risks shall be formally documented; risk shall be treated as a continuous object of governance rather than as an exceptional event. Risk management constitutes an integral component of institutional governance rather than a separate emergency function.

Chapter 3. Categories of Institutional Risk

Chronicle OS recognizes the following principal categories of institutional risk:

Architectural Risks — Risks affecting the integrity, consistency, or coherence of the Documentation System and institutional architecture.

Academic Risks — Risks associated with violations of research integrity, publication ethics, or scholarly standards.

Organizational Risks — Risks arising from deficiencies in governance structures, operational procedures, or institutional coordination.

Digital Risks — Risks affecting the reliability, security, availability, or interoperability of the digital infrastructure.

Reputational Risks — Risks capable of reducing international confidence in Chronicle OS or its University Chronicle Nodes.

Legal and Regulatory Risks — Risks arising from noncompliance with applicable legislation or the normative framework governing Chronicle OS.

Chapter 4. Risk Lifecycle

Every institutional risk shall progress through the following lifecycle: identification; registration; analysis; likelihood assessment; impact assessment; development of mitigation measures; implementation monitoring; formal closure. Each stage of the risk lifecycle shall be recorded within the Chronicle Registry to ensure institutional traceability.

Chapter 5. Institutional Risk Register

Chronicle OS shall maintain a centralized Institutional Risk Register. For every registered risk, the following information shall be recorded: unique identifier; risk description; risk category; source or origin; likelihood assessment; potential institutional impact; designated risk owner; current status; mitigation measures implemented. The Institutional Risk Register serves as a strategic governance instrument supporting informed institutional decision making and long term organizational resilience.

Chapter 6. Institutional Resilience Management

The principal objective of institutional risk management is to strengthen the resilience of Chronicle OS. Every identified risk shall be regarded as an opportunity to improve the normative framework, the digital infrastructure, the institutional governance model, operational procedures, and the Documentation System. Accordingly, institutional risk management is not understood as a reactive response to crises. It constitutes a permanent governance process supporting the sustainable evolution, adaptability, and long term resilience of the international institutional ecosystem.

Chapter 7. Final Provisions

This Framework shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- Governance Framework (GOV-001);
- Institutional Audit Framework (GOV-011);
- Institutional Continuity Framework (GOV-006);
- Chronicle Registry Standards.

This document forms an integral component of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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GOV-013 — Institutional Performance Framework

Framework governing institutional performance evaluation

Document ID: GOV-013 **Document Type:** Institutional Performance Framework **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This Framework establishes the principles governing the assessment of institutional performance within Chronicle OS and its University Chronicle Nodes. Institutional performance assessment is conducted exclusively for the purpose of organizational development, continuous improvement, and long term institutional sustainability. Performance assessment shall not be interpreted or applied as a mechanism of administrative control or disciplinary oversight.

Chapter 2. Principle of Institutional Performance

The performance of Chronicle OS shall not be measured solely by publication volume or other quantitative indicators. Its principal measure of effectiveness is the quality, resilience, and sustainability of the international scholarly communication environment supported by the institutional architecture of Chronicle OS. Institutional performance therefore reflects the capability of the system to maintain reliable, ethical, transparent, and reproducible scientific communication over time.

Chapter 3. Areas of Assessment

Institutional performance may be evaluated across the following dimensions: normative maturity; editorial resilience; quality of expert review activities; development of international cooperation; digital maturity; quality of institutional governance; development of the scholarly community; reproducibility of institutional processes. These dimensions together provide a comprehensive representation of institutional effectiveness.

Chapter 4. Institutional Performance Indicators

Performance assessments may incorporate several categories of indicators.

Organizational Indicators — Measure the stability, consistency, and effectiveness of governance and operational processes.

Academic Indicators — Measure the quality and integrity of scholarly communication.

Technological Indicators — Evaluate the maturity, reliability, and sustainability of the digital infrastructure.

International Indicators — Measure the degree of integration of a University Chronicle Node within the international Chronicle OS ecosystem.

Institutional Indicators — Assess conformity with the Chronicle OS Documentation System and the Institutional Codex.

Indicators shall support institutional analysis rather than serve as isolated performance metrics.

Chapter 5. Use of Assessment Results

Institutional assessment results may be used for: preparation of institutional development programmes; improvement of the normative framework; formulation of institutional recommendations; enhancement of digital infrastructure; development of certification mechanisms; preparation of future editions of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. Institutional performance assessments shall not constitute grounds for limiting the academic autonomy of any University Chronicle Node.

Chapter 6. Principle of Institutional Maturity

Chronicle OS regards institutional maturity as a continuous evolutionary process rather than a fixed achievement. Institutional maturity is strengthened through accumulated operational experience, continuous improvement of the Documentation System, advancement of digital infrastructure, expansion of international cooperation, refinement of institutional procedures, professional capacity building, and continuous institutional learning. Institutional maturity represents a strategic characteristic of the Chronicle OS ecosystem and supports its long term resilience and adaptability.

Chapter 7. Final Provisions

This Framework shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- Governance Framework (GOV-001);
- Institutional Audit Framework (GOV-011);
- Institutional Evolution Framework (GOV-008);
- Chronicle Registry Standards.

This document forms an integral component of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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GOV-014 — Institutional Lifecycle Framework

Framework governing the lifecycle of an institutional node

Document ID: GOV-014 **Document Type:** Institutional Lifecycle Framework **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance **Status:** MASTER TEMPLATE **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This Framework defines the institutional lifecycle of a **University Chronicle Node** operating within the international Chronicle OS ecosystem. The institutional lifecycle describes the sequence of organizational states through which an institutional node progresses, beginning with its initial engagement and continuing through operational maturity, institutional transformation, and, where applicable, archival status.

Chapter 2. Lifecycle Stages

Each University Chronicle Node progresses through the following institutional lifecycle stages: initiation; institutional integration; operational deployment; institutional development; institutional transformation; archival status. Transitions between lifecycle stages shall be governed by the Chronicle OS Documentation System and the applicable institutional procedures.

Chapter 3. Initiation

The initiation stage includes: establishment of institutional contact; preliminary eligibility assessment; preparation of the foundational documentation package; coordination of the proposed cooperation model; formal decision to commence institutional integration. During this stage, the University Chronicle Node has not yet acquired the status of an operational component of Chronicle OS.

Chapter 4. Institutional Integration

During the integration stage, the following activities are completed: connection to the Chronicle Registry; registration of institutional identifiers; deployment of the Chronicle Node infrastructure; establishment of the editorial governance structure; integration of the expert network; activation of the digital operational environment. Upon successful completion of institutional integration, the University Chronicle Node acquires the status of an active institutional participant within Chronicle OS.

Chapter 5. Operational Deployment and Institutional Development

During the operational stage, the University Chronicle Node performs its regular institutional functions, including: editorial operations; peer review management; international scholarly cooperation; institutional auditing; continuous process improvement; implementation of updated editions of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. Institutional development is regarded as an inherent and continuous component of normal operational activity rather than as a separate lifecycle stage.

Chapter 6. Institutional Transformation and Archival Status

Where significant organizational changes occur, a University Chronicle Node may enter a stage of institutional transformation. Should institutional operations formally cease, the Node shall transition

to **Archived Institutional Node** status. Archival status provides for the permanent preservation of institutional registration records, normative history, publication metadata, and institutional memory. Archiving shall not be interpreted as the elimination of institutional knowledge. Rather, it ensures the long term preservation of the University's documented contribution to the Chronicle OS ecosystem and to the international scholarly record.

Chapter 7. Final Provisions

This Framework shall be interpreted and applied together with:

- Chronicle OS Institutional Codex (Volume I);
- Governance Framework (GOV-001);
- Institutional Continuity Framework (GOV-006);
- University Onboarding Protocol (Volume II, INS-006);
- Chronicle Registry Standards.

This document forms an integral component of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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GOV-015 — Operational Governance Summary

Executive summary of the Operational Governance Package

Document ID: GOV-015 **Document Type:** Operational Governance Summary **Hierarchy:** Operational Governance **Status:** MASTER EDITION **Edition:** Master Edition **Version:** 1.0

Chapter 1. Purpose

This document concludes **Volume III** of the Chronicle OS Documentation System and defines the integrated operational governance model of the Chronicle OS international institutional ecosystem for scholarly communication. It consolidates the principles, governance structures, operational mechanisms, and institutional responsibilities established throughout the Operational Governance package into a coherent and unified governance architecture.

Chapter 2. Operational Governance Architecture

The operational governance model of Chronicle OS is composed of the following interconnected frameworks: Governance Framework (GOV-001); International Governance Structure (GOV-002); Institutional Roles and Responsibilities (GOV-003); Decision Making Framework (GOV-004); Principles of Institutional Operation (GOV-005); Institutional Continuity Framework (GOV-006); Context Governance Framework (GOV-007); Institutional Evolution Framework (GOV-008); Institutional Committee Framework (GOV-009); Institutional Conflict Resolution Framework (GOV-010); Institutional Audit Framework (GOV-011); Institutional Risk Management Framework (GOV-012); Institutional Performance Framework (GOV-013); Institutional Lifecycle Framework (GOV-014). Collectively, these Frameworks constitute the unified **Operational Governance Architecture** of Chronicle OS.

Chapter 3. Purpose of Operational Governance

Operational Governance provides the institutional mechanisms necessary to ensure the resilience of the international institutional architecture, consistency of operational processes, reproducibility of institutional activities, continuity of organizational development, preservation of institutional memory, and sustainable advancement of international scholarly communication. Operational Governance does not replace the academic autonomy of participating universities. Its purpose is to provide a common institutional governance framework that enables autonomous organizations to cooperate within a unified international scholarly ecosystem.

Chapter 4. Principle of Institutional Integrity

All Operational Governance documents shall be interpreted as mutually dependent components of a single normative architecture. Any modification to an individual document shall be assessed with regard to its impact upon the integrity, consistency, and interoperability of the Chronicle OS

Documentation System. Changes that compromise the coherence of the institutional architecture shall not be introduced.

Chapter 5. Principle of Normative Evolution

Operational Governance evolves through the controlled publication of successive editions of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. Each new edition shall preserve compatibility with the established institutional architecture, be supported by documented normative justification, include formally registered revision records, and maintain institutional continuity and backward compatibility wherever reasonably practicable. The complete revision history forms part of the institutional memory of Chronicle OS.

Chapter 6. Final Provisions

Operational Governance constitutes an essential component of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. All future operational procedures, implementation manuals, digital workflows, Chronicle Registry standards, user guidance, and specialized regulatory instruments shall be developed in accordance with the governance principles established in this Volume. This document completes the foundational operational governance architecture of Chronicle OS. This Framework forms an integral component of the **Chronicle OS Documentation System** and shall be interpreted and applied together with all other governing documents of the System.

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ARCHITECT'S CONCLUSION

Volume I answers the question: **What is Chronicle OS?**

Volume II answers the question: **How is Chronicle OS deployed within a university?**

Volume III answers the question: **How does Chronicle OS operate after deployment?**

Together, these Volumes address the three fundamental dimensions of every mature institutional system: identity; implementation; operation. All subsequent documents no longer establish the foundation. They extend it.

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UNIFIED GLOSSARY OF TERMS

Chronicle OS — An international institutional system for scholarly communication.

Chronicle OS Documentation System — The integrated body of normative documents governing the architecture, governance, operation, and evolution of Chronicle OS.

Institutional Codex — The constitutional document of Chronicle OS establishing its identity, institutional principles, and foundational architecture.

Deployment Framework — The normative framework governing the deployment of Chronicle OS within universities and research institutions.

Operational Governance — The governance framework defining institutional authority, responsibilities, operational processes, and decision-making mechanisms throughout Chronicle OS.

University Chronicle Node — A locally deployed institutional component of Chronicle OS operating within a university or research organization.

Chronicle Registry — The institutional registry responsible for identification, registration, traceability, and preservation of institutional memory throughout Chronicle OS.

Documentation System — The complete normative documentation corpus comprising all Volumes, Frameworks, Standards, Protocols, Agreements, and supporting documents of Chronicle OS.

International Editorial Office — The international governing body responsible for editorial policy, publication standards, and coordination of editorial activities throughout Chronicle OS.

International Expert Network — The international community of scientific experts responsible for independent peer review and the advancement of international scholarly communication.

International Architecture Council — The governing body responsible for maintaining and developing the institutional architecture and normative framework of Chronicle OS.

International Certification Council — The governing body responsible for institutional certification, compliance assessment, and the development of certification standards.

International Digital Infrastructure Council — The governing body responsible for the development, interoperability, and long-term sustainability of the Chronicle OS digital ecosystem.

Institutional Audit — A structured evaluation of the extent to which a University Chronicle Node complies with the Chronicle OS Documentation System and Institutional Codex.

Institutional Risk — Any event or circumstance capable of adversely affecting the stability, integrity, or resilience of Chronicle OS or one of its institutional participants.

Institutional Context — The integrated set of normative, organizational, technological, and scholarly relationships that collectively define the operational state of the Chronicle OS international ecosystem.

Operational Governance Summary — The integrative document that consolidates all Operational Governance Frameworks into a unified institutional governance architecture.

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END OF VOLUME III

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FUNCTIONAL DEPLOYMENT PACKAGE

UNIVERSITY CHRONICLE NODE DEPLOYMENT KIT

Complete Institutional Deployment Documentation for Chronicle OS

Version 1.0 · Master Draft · English Translation (Oxford Legal Style)

FDP-001 — FUNCTIONAL DEPLOYMENT PACKAGE UNIVERSITY CHRONICLE NODE DEPLOYMENT KIT Complete Institutional Deployment Documentation for Chronicle OS

Document ID: FDP-001 **Status:** Master Draft **Edition:** English Translation (Oxford Legal Style) **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

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1. Purpose

This document defines the composition of the operational documentation required for the deployment and commissioning of the University Chronicle Node as an institutional publishing node of the Chronicle OS Documentation System.

This document forms an integral part of the Functional Deployment Package and shall be applied following the adoption of the Documentation System Master Edition.

2. Scope

This Package applies to: universities, academic institutes, research centres, learned societies, state scientific organisations, and partner institutional publishing structures.

3. Objective

The objective of this Package is to enable the full-cycle launch of an institutional publishing node without altering the fundamental documentation of Chronicle OS.

4. Functional Composition

The University Chronicle Node Deployment Kit comprises the following groups of documents.

Group A — Institution Entry Documents Documents establishing institutional interaction.

Group B — Institution Governance Documents Documents for the formation of governing bodies.

Group C — Editorial Operations Documents organising the editorial process.

Group D — Scientific Review Operations Documents organising expert peer review.

Group E — Publishing Operations Documents for the publication cycle.

Group F — Metadata Operations Documents for scientific metadata management.

Group G — Infrastructure Operations Documents for technical deployment.

Group H — Quality Assurance Documents for quality control.

Group I — Acceptance Documentation Documents for acceptance.

5. Deployment Principle

The deployment of the University Chronicle Node is carried out sequentially.

1. Establishment of institutional interaction.
2. Formation of governing bodies.
3. Appointment of editorial staff.
4. Deployment of technical infrastructure.
5. Configuration of the publication process.
6. Conduct of a test publishing cycle.
7. Signing of the Readiness Certificate.
8. Publication of the first issue.

6. Relationship with Documentation System

The Functional Deployment Package does not amend the provisions of the Chronicle OS Documentation System. The documents of this Package constitute the operational implementation of the provisions of the Documentation System. In the event of any conflict, the Documentation System shall prevail.

7. Result

Upon completion of the procedures prescribed by this Package, the University Chronicle Node shall be deemed commissioned and shall be entitled to operate within Chronicle OS as an independent institutional publishing node.

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FDP-001.1 — OFFICIAL LETTER OF INVITATION TO INSTITUTIONAL COOPERATION

Document ID: FDP-001.1 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

OFFICIAL INVITATION

To the Rector (President, Director)

Dear Colleague,

The international institutional operator IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom) invites your university to consider the possibility of joining the international publishing ecosystem Chronicle OS through the establishment of its own institutional publishing node — the University Chronicle Node.

Chronicle OS constitutes an institutional system for the organisation of scholarly communication, designed to support universities, research institutes, learned societies, and academic organisations in creating their own autonomous publishing units integrated into a unified international scholarly space.

The proposed model of cooperation is based on the following principles: preservation of the university's institutional sovereignty; preservation of editorial independence; observance of academic integrity; transparency of editorial procedures; uniform international standards for scientific metadata; long-term preservation of scholarly publications; enhancement of the international visibility of scholarly output.

The establishment of a University Chronicle Node does not entail the transfer by the university of rights to its own scholarly publications, any change in institutional identity, or the transfer of editorial authority to external organisations.

Chronicle OS provides the university with: normative documentation; methodology for the deployment of the publishing node; an organisational governance model; technical recommendations for the creation of publishing infrastructure; implementation support.

Procedure of Interaction

1. Conduct of a preliminary consultation.
2. Exchange of basic information on the university's scholarly and publishing activities.
3. Signing of a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU).
4. Formation of the institutional editorial structure.
5. Deployment of the University Chronicle Node.
6. Conduct of a pilot publishing cycle.
7. Signing of the Readiness Certificate.
8. Publication of the first official issue of the scholarly journal.

Result of Cooperation

Upon completion of the deployment procedure, the university shall have a functioning institutional publishing node operating within the international Chronicle OS ecosystem, with full retention of its own academic autonomy and organisational independence.

Accompanying Documents

Upon request, the university shall be provided with: Chronicle OS Documentation System (Master Russian Edition); University Chronicle Node Deployment Kit; Memorandum of Understanding (MoU); Draft Cooperation Agreement; University Chronicle Node Implementation Roadmap.

Yours sincerely, **IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)** International Institutional Operator Chronicle OS Documentation System

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FDP-001.2 — PROTOCOL OF INTENT

Document ID: FDP-001.2 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

This Protocol of Intent records the mutual interest of the parties in considering the possibility of establishing an institutional publishing node — the University Chronicle Node — within the international publishing ecosystem Chronicle OS. The signing of this Protocol does not create financial obligations and does not constitute an agreement to commence economic activity. This document confirms solely the intention of the parties to proceed to the next stage of preparatory cooperation.

Purpose of the Document

- confirmation of the parties' interest;
- commencement of official consultations;
- exchange of necessary organisational information;
- preparation of the draft Memorandum of Understanding (MoU).

Subject of Consultations

- the feasibility of establishing a University Chronicle Node;
- the organisational model of the editorial structure;
- the composition of the editorial board;
- the proposed scholarly specialisations;
- the technical deployment model;
- the procedure for integration into Chronicle OS.

Principles of Interaction

- voluntary participation;
- academic independence;
- institutional equality;
- confidentiality of information received;
- absence of obligations pending the signing of the MoU.

Actions of the Parties

IMARCH LTD undertakes to: provide the necessary documentation; conduct consultations; present the University Chronicle Node deployment model; respond to the university's questions.

The University undertakes to: designate a contact person; provide general information on its scholarly infrastructure; consider the materials presented; decide on proceeding to the MoU preparation stage.

Term of Validity

This Protocol shall remain in effect until the signing of the Memorandum of Understanding OR written notification by either party of the termination of negotiations.

Legal Status

This document does not constitute a contract, does not create property obligations, and is used solely for the purpose of preparing possible institutional cooperation.

Result

Upon completion of the stage provided for by this Protocol, the parties shall take one of the following decisions: proceed to the signing of the Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) OR terminate negotiations without incurring mutual obligations.

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FDP-001.3 — MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING

(Memorandum of Understanding, MoU)

Document ID: FDP-001.3 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. General Provisions

This Memorandum of Understanding defines the intention of the parties to develop long-term institutional cooperation in the fields of scholarly communication, academic publishing, and the development of university scholarly infrastructure through the establishment of a University Chronicle Node within the international publishing ecosystem Chronicle OS. This Memorandum does not constitute a commercial contract and does not govern the financial obligations of the parties.

2. Parties to the Memorandum

First Party IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom) — international institutional operator of the Chronicle OS Documentation System.

Second Party (full official name of the university)

3. Subject of Cooperation

- development of scholarly publishing infrastructure;
- establishment of the University Chronicle Node;
- development of academic publications;
- organisation of editorial activities;
- development of expert peer review;
- enhancement of the international visibility of scholarly output;
- development of open scholarly communication.

4. Fundamental Principles of Cooperation

- academic independence;
- institutional equality;
- voluntary participation;
- respect for intellectual property;
- observance of scholarly ethics;
- transparency of procedures;
- non-interference in the university's internal scholarly policy.

5. Authority of the Parties

IMARCH LTD shall provide: methodological support; normative documentation; consultancy; support for the University Chronicle Node deployment process; development of international integration.

The University shall independently exercise: editorial policy; appointment of editors; formation of the editorial board; determination of scholarly specialisation; decision-making on the publication of materials.

6. Independence of the Parties

This Memorandum does not create a relationship of subordination. Neither party acquires the right to interfere in the activities of the other party. Each party retains full organisational, academic, and legal autonomy.

7. Intellectual Property

Rights to scholarly publications shall belong to their respective rights holders in accordance with applicable law and the university's internal regulations. This Memorandum does not provide for the transfer of proprietary rights to IMARCH LTD.

8. Confidentiality

The parties undertake not to disclose information obtained during the preparation of joint projects, unless otherwise agreed in writing.

9. Development of Cooperation

Following the signing of this Memorandum, the parties may enter into separate agreements governing joint scholarly projects, publishing activities, technical support, expert exchange, educational programmes, conference organisation, and other areas of cooperation.

10. Term of Validity

This Memorandum shall enter into force upon signature by the parties and shall remain in force indefinitely until terminated by written notice from either party.

11. Legal Status

This Memorandum records the intention of the parties to engage in institutional cooperation. The creation of property, financial, or other legally binding obligations shall be governed by separate agreements.

12. Final Provisions

This Memorandum constitutes the foundational document for institutional interaction between IMARCH LTD and the university within Chronicle OS. On the basis of this document, the parties may proceed to the practical implementation of the University Chronicle Node project.

Signatures of the Parties

IMARCH LTD Name: [Insert Name] Title: [Insert Title] Date: [Insert Date] Signature: ___

University Name: [Insert Name] Title: [Insert Title] Date: [Insert Date] Signature: ___

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FDP-001.3-B — STRATEGIC INSTITUTIONAL PARTNERSHIP MEMORANDUM

(Strategic Institutional Partnership Memorandum)

Document ID: FDP-001.3-B **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

Preamble

Recognising the growing importance of open scholarly communication, international academic cooperation, and the institutional independence of universities, guided by the principles of academic freedom, scholarly integrity, long-term development of scholarly infrastructure, and mutual respect for institutional sovereignty, the parties enter into this Strategic Partnership Memorandum. This document defines the general principles for the formation of a long-term institutional alliance between the university and the international Chronicle OS system.

1. Subject of Strategic Partnership

The parties confirm their intention to jointly participate in the development of the international scholarly communication infrastructure Chronicle OS through the formation of the University Chronicle Node, the joint development of academic publishing practices, participation in the development of international standards for scholarly communication, the development of expert communities, and the creation of a sustainable institutional scholarly ecosystem.

2. Strategic Objectives

- development of international academic integration;
- enhancement of the institutional agency of universities;
- development of independent scholarly publishing platforms;
- formation of a sustainable expert infrastructure;
- development of an open system of scholarly knowledge;
- ensuring long-term preservation and institutional continuity of scholarly output.

3. Status of the Parties

This Memorandum does not establish a relationship of subordination. Each party retains legal, organisational, financial, editorial, and academic autonomy. Cooperation shall be conducted exclusively on the basis of institutional partnership.

4. Role of IMARCH LTD

IMARCH LTD acts as the international institutional operator of Chronicle OS and provides development of the normative framework, support for institutional implementation, development of the international Chronicle OS network, coordination of joint initiatives, and support for international interaction among network participants.

5. Role of the University

The University independently determines its own scholarly policy, editorial policy, staffing, research directions, publication strategy, and the internal structure of the University Chronicle Node.

6. Joint Activities

Within the framework of this Partnership, the parties may jointly undertake scholarly research, publishing projects, international conferences, educational programmes, expert programmes, development of sectoral recommendations, and development of international scholarly networks.

7. Joint Development of Chronicle OS

The University has the right to submit proposals for the development of the Documentation System, participate in expert discussions, take part in working groups, initiate the development of new academic modules, and participate in the development of international Chronicle OS standards. All amendments to the Documentation System shall be adopted exclusively in accordance with the internal procedures of Chronicle OS.

8. International Expert Participation

By mutual agreement, representatives of the University may be invited to participate in the International Expert Council of Chronicle OS, thematic editorial boards, working expert groups, and international scholarly commissions. Such participation shall be conducted exclusively on a voluntary basis and shall not alter the institutional autonomy of the University.

9. Intellectual Property

Each party retains exclusive rights to its own intellectual property. Joint results shall be governed by separate agreements. This Memorandum does not provide for the transfer of proprietary rights.

10. Confidentiality

Information obtained by the parties during the preparation of joint projects shall be used solely for the purpose of implementing this Partnership.

11. Term of Partnership

This Memorandum shall enter into force upon signature. The Partnership is considered by the parties to be long-term and shall remain in force until terminated by either party.

12. Final Provisions

This Memorandum constitutes a declaration of strategic institutional partnership. All projects arising under this document shall be implemented through separate agreements, regulations, and operational documentation of the Functional Deployment Package.

IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom) Name: [Insert Name] Title: [Insert Title] Date: [Insert Date] Signature: ___

University Name: [Insert Name] Title: [Insert Title] Date: [Insert Date] Signature: ___

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FDP-001.4 — INSTITUTIONAL PARTNERSHIP AGREEMENT FRAMEWORK

(Institutional Partnership Agreement Framework)

Document ID: FDP-001.4 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose of the Document

This Framework Agreement defines the legal and organisational principles of long-term cooperation between IMARCH LTD and the University in the establishment and operation of the University Chronicle Node. This document serves as the basis for the subsequent conclusion of specialised agreements in individual areas of cooperation.

2. Subject of the Agreement

The Parties jointly undertake activities for the establishment of the University Chronicle Node, the development of scholarly publishing infrastructure, the organisation of editorial activities, the development of international scholarly communication, and the implementation of Chronicle OS standards.

3. Delineation of Authority

IMARCH LTD shall provide: support for the Documentation System; development of methodology; support for the international infrastructure; development of the normative framework; coordination of international interaction.

The University shall independently exercise: scholarly activities; editorial activities; management of the University Chronicle Node; staffing appointments; publication of scholarly materials; development of its own scholarly policy.

4. Financial Independence

Each party shall bear its own costs associated with the conduct of its own activities. Any joint financial projects shall be governed by separate agreements.

5. Academic Independence

IMARCH LTD shall not interfere with the scholarly policy of the University, the decisions of the Editorial Board, the review procedures, or the decision-making on publication. The University shall independently take all editorial decisions.

6. Joint Use of Brands

The use of Chronicle OS, University Chronicle Node, IMARCH, and associated branding shall be conducted exclusively in accordance with separate regulations.

7. Liability of the Parties

Each party shall be liable solely for its own activities. IMARCH LTD shall not be liable for the content of the University's scholarly publications. The University shall not be liable for the activities of other Chronicle OS participants.

8. Dispute Resolution

The parties shall seek to resolve all issues through negotiation. In the event that agreement cannot be reached, the parties may terminate cooperation without prejudice to previously published scholarly materials.

9. Termination of Cooperation

Termination of this Agreement shall not affect previously published materials, the rights of authors', the University's rights to its own scholarly output, or archival data of the University Chronicle Node.

10. Final Provisions

This Agreement defines the institutional model for interaction between the parties. All specialised projects shall be governed by separate appendices or independent contracts.

Appendices

This Agreement may include: Technical Appendix, Financial Appendix, Implementation Plan, Support Plan, List of Responsible Persons, Project Roadmap.

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FDP-002.1 — EDITORIAL BOARD CHARTER OF THE UNIVERSITY CHRONICLE NODE

Document ID: FDP-002.1 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. General Provisions

This Charter defines the legal status, authority, formation procedure, and organisation of the activities of the Editorial Board of the University Chronicle Node. The Editorial Board is a permanent collegial body responsible for the governance of the editorial policy of the institutional publishing node.

2. Purpose of the Editorial Board

The Editorial Board ensures the formulation of editorial policy, the development of the scholarly journal, compliance with editorial standards, the strategic development of publishing activities, adherence to the principles of scholarly ethics, and interaction with Chronicle OS on matters of publishing infrastructure development.

3. Core Tasks

The Editorial Board approves editorial policy, determines the scholarly specialisation of the journal, approves thematic issues, considers matters concerning the development of the journal, decides on the establishment of new editorial subdivisions, and approves internal editorial documents.

4. Competence

The exclusive competence of the Editorial Board includes approval of the composition of the Editorial Collegium, appointment of the Editor-in-Chief, approval of the Code of Ethics, approval of the Review Regulation, approval of the Publication Policy, and decision-making on the strategic development of the University Chronicle Node.

5. Composition

The Editorial Board shall comprise the Chairperson, the Editor-in-Chief, Deputy Editors-in-Chief, the Managing Editor, Heads of scholarly sections, and invited members of the Board (where necessary). The number of Board members shall be determined by the University.

6. Formation of the Board

Members of the Board shall be appointed by the University in accordance with its internal normative documents. Chronicle OS shall not interfere with the University’s personnel decisions.

7. Authority of the Chairperson

The Chairperson of the Board organises the work of the Board, approves the agenda of meetings, signs the decisions of the Board, and represents the Board in relations with the University and IMARCH LTD.

8. Meetings

The Editorial Board shall hold scheduled and extraordinary meetings in in-person, remote, or hybrid formats.

9. Decision-Making

Decisions shall be taken by a majority vote of the Board members present. In the event of a tie, the Chairperson’s vote shall be decisive.

10. Conflict of Interest

A Board member shall notify the Chairperson of any conflict of interest prior to the consideration of the relevant matter. In the event of a conflict of interest, the Board member shall not participate in the vote.

11. Interaction with Chronicle OS

The Editorial Board shall interact with IMARCH LTD exclusively on matters of development of the Documentation System, improvement of editorial standards, participation in international scholarly initiatives, exchange of experience, and international integration. Editorial decisions remain the exclusive competence of the University.

12. Liability

The Editorial Board shall be liable for adherence to editorial policy, adherence to scholarly ethics, the quality of editorial procedures, and the strategic development of the University Chronicle Node. Liability for the content of scholarly publications shall be determined by the University's internal normative documents and applicable law.

13. Final Provisions

This Charter shall enter into force upon approval by the University. Amendments to the Charter shall be adopted in accordance with the University's procedures. This document is recommended for use as the basic regulation governing the activities of the Editorial Board of the University Chronicle Node within Chronicle OS.

Appendices

This Charter may be accompanied by Meeting Regulation, Code of Scholarly Ethics, Review Regulation, Editorial Collegium Charter, Editor-in-Chief Charter, and Document Flow Regulation.

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FDP-002.3 — EDITOR-IN-CHIEF CHARTER OF THE UNIVERSITY CHRONICLE NODE

Document ID: FDP-002.3 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. General Provisions

The Editor-in-Chief is the senior officer of the editorial office of the University Chronicle Node and exercises day-to-day management of editorial activities. The Editor-in-Chief acts within the authority conferred by the University and this Charter.

2. Core Task

The Editor-in-Chief ensures the functioning of the University Chronicle Node as a continuously operating scholarly publishing unit of the University.

3. Core Functions

The Editor-in-Chief organises the editorial process, ensures compliance with the Publication Policy, organises expert peer review, decides on the movement of manuscripts, monitors compliance with editorial deadlines, organises the preparation of issues, and represents the editorial office in external relations.

4. Authority

The Editor-in-Chief has the right to appoint Issue Editors, allocate manuscripts, initiate additional review, reject manuscripts on formal grounds, return materials to authors' for revision, and form working groups within the editorial office.

5. Limitations of Authority

The Editor-in-Chief shall not alter decisions of the Editorial Board, interfere with independent expert reports, modify authorial materials without author consent, or take decisions inconsistent with the Code of Ethics.

6. Liability

The Editor-in-Chief is liable for adherence to editorial procedures, adherence to the Publication Policy, organisation of peer review, timeliness of issue preparation, and correctness of editorial document flow.

7. Interaction

The Editor-in-Chief interacts with the Editorial Board, the Editorial Collegium, the Expert Council, authors', reviewers, the technical editorial office, and IMARCH LTD exclusively on matters of Chronicle OS development.

8. Appointment

The Editor-in-Chief shall be appointed by the University. The appointment procedure shall be determined by the University's internal documents. IMARCH LTD shall not participate in the University's personnel decisions.

9. Dismissal

The Editor-in-Chief shall be relieved of duties upon own application, by decision of the University, or on grounds provided for by internal normative documents.

10. Final Provisions

The Editor-in-Chief shall exercise activities in the interests of the University, the scholarly community, and the development of Chronicle OS. This Charter shall be applied in conjunction with the Editorial Board Charter, the Editorial Collegium Charter, the Code of Ethics, the Publication Policy, and the Peer Review Policy.

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FDP-002.4 — MANAGING EDITOR CHARTER

Document ID: FDP-002.4 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. General Provisions

The Managing Editor is an officer of the University Chronicle Node responsible for the organisation of the day-to-day activities of the editorial office, editorial document flow, and coordination of interaction among all participants in the publication process. The Managing Editor acts within the authority defined by this Charter and the University's internal normative documents.

2. Purpose of the Position

The primary task of the Managing Editor is to ensure the uninterrupted functioning of the editorial process at all stages of the scholarly publication lifecycle.

3. Core Functions

The Managing Editor receives incoming manuscripts, performs initial registration of materials, verifies the completeness of submitted documents, organises editorial document flow, tracks the movement of manuscripts, facilitates interaction among authors', editors, and reviewers, monitors compliance with deadlines, prepares materials for meetings of editorial bodies, ensures the archiving of editorial documentation, and maintains the publication registry.

4. Authority

The Managing Editor has the right to request missing materials from authors', return materials for technical revision, forward materials to Issue Editors, monitor the execution of editorial procedures, generate working reports, and initiate notifications to editorial process participants.

5. Limitations of Authority

The Managing Editor shall not decide on the scholarly merit of materials, the publication of manuscripts, the results of peer review, editorial policy, or personnel matters of the editorial office. Such decisions fall within the competence of the Editor-in-Chief, the Editorial Collegium, or the Editorial Board.

6. Liability

The Managing Editor is liable for correctness of document flow, timeliness of material processing, preservation of editorial documentation, adherence to editorial deadlines, accuracy of editorial registries, and correctness of official correspondence.

7. Interaction

The Managing Editor interacts with the Editor-in-Chief, the Editorial Collegium, the Editorial Board, authors', reviewers, technical editors, scientific metadata specialists, and the University administration.

8. Appointment

The Managing Editor shall be appointed by the University in accordance with established procedures. The appointment procedure shall be determined by the University's internal normative documents.

9. Dismissal

The Managing Editor shall be relieved of duties upon own application, by decision of the University, or on grounds provided for by applicable law and the University's internal normative documents.

10. Final Provisions

The Managing Editor is the central coordinator of editorial document flow for the University Chronicle Node and ensures the organisational sustainability of the publication process. This Charter shall be applied in conjunction with the Editor-in-Chief Charter, the Editorial Collegium Charter, the Publication Policy, the Peer Review Policy, and the Editorial Document Flow Regulation.

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FDP-002.5 — ISSUE EDITOR CHARTER

Document ID: FDP-002.5 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. General Provisions

The Issue Editor is an officer of the University Chronicle Node responsible for organising the preparation of a specific issue of the scholarly journal. The Issue Editor acts within the authority conferred by the Editor-in-Chief and this Charter.

2. Appointment

The primary task of the Issue Editor is to ensure the preparation of an individual issue of the journal from the formulation of the thematic plan to the transfer of materials to production.

3. Core Functions

The Issue Editor formulates the thematic plan of the issue, organises interaction with authors', coordinates the work of reviewers, liaises with the Managing Editor, monitors the progress of editorial procedures, determines the final composition of the issue, and presents the issue to the Editor-in-Chief for approval.

4. Authority

The Issue Editor has the right to propose authors' for publication, initiate additional review, return materials for scholarly revision, formulate proposals on the composition of the issue, and hold working meetings with authors' and reviewers.

5. Limitations of Authority

The Issue Editor shall not independently approve the publication of materials, alter decisions of the Editor-in-Chief, alter the reports of independent reviewers, violate the approved Publication Policy, or change the editorial policy of the journal.

6. Liability

The Issue Editor is liable for the scholarly integrity of the issue, adherence to the thematic concept, the completeness of editorial preparation of materials, compliance with approved deadlines, and the quality of interaction with authors' and reviewers.

7. Interaction

The Issue Editor interacts with the Editor-in-Chief, the Managing Editor, the Editorial Collegium, authors', reviewers, technical editors, and scientific metadata specialists.

8. Appointment

The Issue Editor shall be appointed by the Editor-in-Chief or the Editorial Collegium in accordance with the University's internal normative documents. A separate Issue Editor may be appointed for each issue.

9. Relief from Duties

The Issue Editor's authority shall cease upon completion of the preparation of the issue, by decision of the Editor-in-Chief, upon own application, or in other cases provided for by the University's internal documents.

10. Final Provisions

The Issue Editor ensures the organisational and scholarly preparation of a specific issue of the journal and acts in the interests of the University, the scholarly community, and the editorial standards of Chronicle OS. This Charter shall be applied in conjunction with the Editor-in-Chief Charter, the Managing Editor Charter, the Publication Policy, the Peer Review Policy, and the Editorial Document Flow Regulation.

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FDP-002.6 — TECHNICAL EDITOR CHARTER

Document ID: FDP-002.6 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. General Provisions

The Technical Editor is an officer of the University Chronicle Node responsible for the technical preparation of scholarly publications for official release. The Technical Editor performs activities following the completion of scholarly and editorial preparation of materials.

2. Appointment

The primary task of the Technical Editor is to ensure uniform formatting, correctness of publication data, and the preparation of materials for official publication.

3. Core Functions

The Technical Editor verifies the formatting of manuscripts, aligns materials with established editorial standards, prepares the final layout, checks the correctness of figures, tables, and appendices, verifies the completeness of scholarly metadata, prepares publication files, and ensures the technical readiness of the issue.

4. Authority

The Technical Editor has the right to return materials for technical revision, request missing formatting elements, propose corrections of a technical nature, and interact with authors' on matters of publication formatting.

5. Limitations of Authority

The Technical Editor shall not alter the scholarly content of the article, alter the author's position, decide on publication, interfere with the peer review procedure, or change editorial policy. All substantive changes shall be made exclusively in consultation with the author and the Editor-in-Chief.

6. Liability

The Technical Editor is liable for compliance of publications with editorial style, the quality of technical preparation of materials, correctness of publication files, compliance with the requirements of the Publication Policy, and readiness of the issue for publication.

7. Interaction

The Technical Editor interacts with the Editor-in-Chief, the Issue Editor, the Managing Editor, authors', and the publishing platform administrator.

8. Appointment

The Technical Editor shall be appointed by the University or the Editor-in-Chief in accordance with internal normative documents.

9. Final Provisions

The Technical Editor completes the editorial preparation cycle and transfers the issue to the stage of official publication in accordance with the approved Publication Workflow.

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FDP-003.1 — PUBLICATION WORKFLOW

Regulation of the Full Lifecycle of a Scholarly Publication

Document ID: FDP-003.1 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose of the Document

This Regulation defines the full lifecycle of a scholarly publication within the University Chronicle Node, from the moment of receipt of the manuscript by the editorial office to its publication, archiving, and subsequent support. This document shall be applied by all participants in the editorial process, irrespective of their official position.

2. General Principles

The editorial process is founded on scholarly integrity, independence of expert assessment, transparency of procedures, traceability of all editorial actions, preservation of editorial history, and immutability of the published version.

3. Participants in the Publication Process

The editorial process involves: Author, Managing Editor, Editor-in-Chief, Issue Editor, Reviewers, Technical Editor, Scientific Metadata Specialist, and Publishing Platform Administrator.

4. Core Stages of the Publication Lifecycle

Stage 1 — Receipt of Manuscript. **Stage 2** — Initial Technical Check. **Stage 3** — Preliminary Editorial Assessment. **Stage 4** — Appointment of Issue Editor. **Stage 5** — Expert Peer Review. **Stage 6** — Author Revision. **Stage 7** — Editorial Approval. **Stage 8** — Technical Preparation. **Stage 9** — Formation of Scientific Metadata. **Stage 10** — Assignment of Publication Identifiers. **Stage 11** — Official Publication. **Stage 12** — Archiving. **Stage 13** — Post-Publication Support.

5. Publication State Management

The current state of each publication shall be recorded. Each change of state shall be accompanied by time of change, responsible participant, basis for the change, and entry in the editorial event log.

6. Traceability

No editorial action shall be performed without registration. All changes to the editorial state shall be preserved in the publication process log.

7. Completion of the Lifecycle

Following official publication, the article shall be deemed to have completed the editorial cycle and shall enter the archival support phase. Subsequent amendments shall be permitted exclusively in accordance with the separate regulations of Chronicle OS.

8. Final Provisions

This Regulation defines solely the sequence of stages of the publication process. Detailed procedures for the execution of each stage shall be established by the specialised operational protocols of the Functional Deployment Package.

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FDP-003.2 — MANUSCRIPT INTAKE PROTOCOL
(Manuscript Intake Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-003.2 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for the receipt of scholarly manuscripts by the editorial office of the University Chronicle Node. The Protocol shall apply to all materials, irrespective of their scholarly field, type of publication, or method of submission.

2. Objective

To ensure uniform registration of each received manuscript, to prevent loss of materials, and to guarantee the traceability of the subsequent editorial process.

3. Responsible Person

Execution of this Protocol is the responsibility of the Managing Editor.

4. Basis for Commencement

The procedure commences upon receipt of the manuscript through one of the editorial office's official channels. Permissible channels: editorial information system, official website, official email address, other approved means of receiving materials.

5. Registration

Upon receipt of the material, the Managing Editor shall register the date of receipt, assign an internal registration number, create an editorial publication card, and open a publication dossier.

6. Completeness Check

The following shall be verified: text of the manuscript, author details, contact information, required accompanying documents, and declarations required by the Publication Policy.

7. Results of the Check

Material accepted for consideration: The manuscript shall receive the status **Received** and be transferred to the preliminary editorial assessment stage.

Material requires supplementation: The author shall be notified of the missing documents. Until the deficiencies are rectified, the publication shall receive the status **Incomplete Submission**.

Material does not meet formal requirements: The manuscript shall be returned to the author without initiating the editorial process. Status — **Returned Without Review**.

8. Documentation

Each action shall be recorded: date, time, executor, basis, decision taken. All records shall be preserved in the publication log.

9. Transfer to Next Stage

Upon completion of registration, the publication shall be transferred to the Editor-in-Chief for preliminary assessment. The publication status shall be changed to **Editorial Screening**.

10. Completion of Procedure

This Protocol shall be deemed executed upon transfer of the publication to the next stage of the editorial process.

Result

The output of this Protocol is an officially registered manuscript with a complete publication dossier, ready for preliminary editorial assessment.

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FDP-003.3 — EDITORIAL SCREENING PROTOCOL

(Editorial Screening Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-003.3 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for conducting preliminary editorial assessment of a manuscript prior to its transfer to independent expert peer review.

2. Objective

Preliminary editorial assessment is intended to determine whether the submitted manuscript meets the basic requirements of the scholarly journal. This stage does not constitute scholarly review and does not involve assessment of the scientific novelty of the research.

3. Responsible Person

Preliminary editorial assessment shall be conducted by the Editor-in-Chief or an Issue Editor duly authorised by the Editor-in-Chief.

4. Subject of Assessment

The assessment shall verify exclusively compliance with thematic relevance to the journal, editorial policy, scholarly profile of the issue, Publication Policy, Publication Ethics, absence of obvious violations of academic integrity, and completeness of submitted materials. No scholarly assessment of the research results shall be performed at this stage.

5. Possible Decisions

Decision A — Transfer to Expert Peer Review: Publication status: **Peer Review Assigned**

Decision B — Return to Author for Preliminary Revision: Status: **Revision Before Review**. The author shall be provided with a list of comments to be addressed prior to the commencement of the review procedure.

Decision C — Reject Without Transfer to Review: Status: **Desk Rejected**. Grounds may include thematic mismatch, gross violation of editorial policy, lack of scholarly character of the material, obvious violations of Publication Ethics, or incompleteness of submitted materials after repeated request.

6. Prohibitions

During preliminary assessment, it is prohibited to assess the scientific novelty of the research, assess the validity of scientific results, substitute for the independent peer review procedure, or take the author's identity into account in decision-making.

7. Documentation

Each decision shall be accompanied by date, time, responsible editor, basis for the decision, and change of publication status.

8. Transfer of Publication

In the event of a positive decision, the publication shall be transferred to the Managing Editor for the assignment of independent reviewers.

9. Completion of Procedure

This Protocol shall be deemed executed upon the change of publication status and transfer of materials to the next stage of the publication cycle.

Result

The output of this Protocol is one of three decisions: referral to peer review, return for preliminary revision, or rejection without conducting expert peer review. The decision shall be recorded in the Chronicle OS publication log and shall form part of the editorial history of the manuscript.

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FDP-003.4 — PEER REVIEW ASSIGNMENT PROTOCOL

(Peer Review Assignment Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-003.4 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for assigning independent scholarly peer review of submitted manuscripts following the completion of preliminary editorial assessment.

2. Objective

To ensure objective, independent, and professional scholarly assessment of each manuscript prior to the decision on publication.

3. Responsible Persons

Execution of this Protocol shall be carried out by the Editor-in-Chief, the Issue Editor, and the Managing Editor.

4. Basis for Commencement

The procedure shall commence upon the assignment to the publication of the status **Peer Review Assigned**.

5. Selection of Reviewers

In the selection of reviewers, the following shall be considered: scholarly specialisation, professional competence, absence of conflict of interest, independence of expert position, and absence of professional dependence on the author.

6. Reviewer Requirements

A reviewer must possess proven qualifications, adhere to the norms of scholarly ethics, ensure the confidentiality of materials, and decline participation in the event of a conflict of interest.

7. Number of Reviewers

The standard procedure requires the appointment of no fewer than two independent reviewers. In exceptional cases, the Editor-in-Chief may appoint additional expert assessment.

8. Invitation

The Managing Editor shall send to the reviewer an invitation, information on deadlines, editorial instructions, a declaration on the absence of conflict of interest, and the text of the manuscript (in accordance with the adopted review model).

9. Reviewer Response

The reviewer may accept the invitation, decline, report a conflict of interest, or propose an extension of deadlines.

10. Replacement of Reviewer

In the event of a refusal or impossibility of conducting the assessment, a new independent reviewer shall be appointed. All actions shall be recorded in the publication log.

11. Confidentiality

Until the completion of the publication process, information concerning the identity of reviewers, the composition of the expert group, and the content of expert materials shall be used exclusively within the editorial process in accordance with the adopted review model.

12. Documentation

The following shall be recorded: date of appointment, date of acceptance of the invitation, selected review model, deadlines for the preparation of the report, and details of the appointing editor.

13. Transfer to Next Stage

Following confirmation of reviewer participation, the publication shall receive the status **Under Peer Review**. Materials shall be transferred to the experts for scholarly assessment.

14. Completion of Procedure

This Protocol shall be deemed executed upon confirmation of the composition of the expert group and the transfer of the manuscript to scholarly peer review.

Result

The output of this Protocol is a constituted independent expert group that has commenced scholarly assessment of the manuscript in accordance with the Publication Policy and Publication Ethics of Chronicle OS.

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FDP-003.5 — PEER REVIEW MODELS REGULATION

(Peer Review Models Regulation)

Document ID: FDP-003.5 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Regulation defines the models of expert peer review supported by Chronicle OS, as well as the principles for their selection and application within the University Chronicle Node.

2. General Principles

Irrespective of the selected model, peer review shall be conducted on the principles of independence of the expert, objectivity, scholarly integrity, absence of conflict of interest, confidentiality, and professional competence.

3. Selection of Model

The specific model shall be determined by the University or by the editorial policy of the individual scholarly journal. Chronicle OS does not impose a mandatory model of expert assessment.

4. Supported Models

Single Blind Peer Review — The reviewer knows the author. The author does not know the reviewer.

Double Blind Peer Review — Neither the author nor the reviewer knows the identity of the other. Recommended model.

Open Peer Review — The identities of both author and reviewer are disclosed. The review may be published alongside the article.

Collaborative Review — Multiple experts jointly discuss the manuscript and formulate a single report.

Registered Review — The research programme is subjected to expert assessment prior to the acquisition of research results.

Post Publication Review — Scholarly discussion continues after publication of the article.

5. Change of Model

The editorial office may change the review model for a specific manuscript only in agreement with the Editor-in-Chief, where objective grounds exist, and with mandatory registration of the change.

6. Conflict of Interest

In the event of the identification of a conflict of interest, the expert shall immediately notify the editorial office, the participation of that expert shall be terminated, and a new reviewer shall be appointed.

7. Documentation

For each publication, Chronicle OS records the selected model, the number of experts, deadlines, the stages of the assessment process, and the final decision.

8. Final Provisions

This Regulation defines the models of expert assessment supported by Chronicle OS. Specific editorial procedures shall be established by the Publication Policy of the relevant scholarly journal.

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FDP-003.6 — PEER REVIEW EXECUTION PROTOCOL

(Peer Review Execution Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-003.6 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for conducting independent scholarly peer review of a manuscript following the formation of the expert group.

2. Objective

To ensure objective scholarly assessment of the research through an independent expert procedure.

3. Basis for Commencement

The procedure shall commence upon the change of the publication status to **Under Peer Review**.

4. Receipt of Materials

Each appointed reviewer shall receive the text of the manuscript, editorial instructions, assessment criteria, deadlines for the preparation of the report, and the expert report form.

5. Conduct of Expert Assessment

The expert shall independently analyse scientific novelty, methodological correctness, logical coherence of the research, reproducibility of results, quality of argumentation, compliance with scholarly ethics, correctness of references, and completeness of the scholarly apparatus.

6. Prohibitions

The reviewer shall not contact the author directly, transfer materials to third parties, use the research results prior to publication, disclose the content of the manuscript, or use official information for personal purposes.

7. Final Report

Upon completion of the assessment, the reviewer shall select one of the following decisions: A — Accept without changes; B — Accept after minor revision; C — Refer for substantial revision; D — Reject. Each decision shall be accompanied by a detailed expert report.

8. Independence of Experts

Each reviewer shall formulate their report independently. Until the completion of the procedure, communication between reviewers shall not be permitted, unless otherwise provided for by the selected review model.

9. Conflicting Reports

Where fundamentally contradictory expert conclusions are present, the Editor-in-Chief may appoint an additional reviewer, initiate a collective review, or refer the materials to the Expert Council.

10. Documentation

Chronicle OS records the date of receipt of the report, compliance with deadlines, the final decision, the editorial response, and subsequent actions.

11. Transfer of Results

Following receipt of all expert reports, the publication shall be transferred to the Editor-in-Chief. The status shall be changed to **Editorial Decision Pending**.

12. Completion of Procedure

This Protocol shall be deemed executed upon registration of all expert reports and transfer of materials to the Editor-in-Chief.

Result

The output of this Protocol is a complete set of independent expert reports, which shall serve as the basis for the editorial decision.

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FDP-003.7 — EDITORIAL DECISION PROTOCOL

(Editorial Decision Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-003.7 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for reaching the final editorial decision based on the results of independent scholarly peer review.

2. Objective

To ensure objective, documented, and reproducible decision-making regarding the future of a scholarly publication.

3. Basis for Commencement

The procedure shall commence upon the change of the publication status to **Editorial Decision Pending**.

4. Responsible Persons

The editorial decision shall be taken by the Editor-in-Chief or the Editorial Collegium, where provided for by the journal's editorial policy.

5. Grounds for Decision

In taking the decision, the following shall be considered: expert reports, compliance with the Publication Policy, compliance with Publication Ethics, the author's responses to comments, and the results of any additional expert assessments (if any). The editorial decision shall not contravene the established procedures of Chronicle OS.

6. Possible Decisions

Accept — The manuscript is accepted without further changes. Status: **Accepted**.

Minor Revision — Minor author revision is required. Status: **Minor Revision Requested**.

Major Revision — Substantial revision of the research is necessary. Following resubmission, the manuscript shall undergo a further editorial assessment. Status: **Major Revision Requested**.

Reject — The publication is rejected. Status: **Rejected**.

The editorial office shall send the author a reasoned decision, attaching the expert reports to the extent provided for by the adopted review model.

7. Additional Expert Assessment

In the event of conflicting expert reports, the editorial office may appoint an additional reviewer, refer the publication to the Expert Council, or organise a collective review. Until the completion of the additional procedure, the final decision shall not be taken.

8. Documentation

The Chronicle OS publication log shall record the date of the decision, the responsible person, the decision taken, the grounds, the change of publication status, and the dispatch of notification to the author.

9. Notification of the Author

The author shall receive the official editorial decision, including the publication status, the list of required actions, the deadlines for compliance (where applicable), and the procedure for subsequent interaction.

10. Transfer to Next Stage

Following the decision, the publication shall be transferred for technical preparation if the article is accepted, to the author if revision is required, or to the rejected materials archive if the decision is to reject.

11. Completion of Procedure

This Protocol shall be deemed executed upon registration of the editorial decision and the change of publication status in Chronicle OS.

Result

The output of this Protocol is an official institutional editorial decision, which shall be binding for the further progression of the publication.

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FDP-003.8 — PUBLICATION PRODUCTION PROTOCOL
(Publication Production Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-003.8 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for the preparation of an accepted scholarly publication for official release by the University Chronicle Node.

2. Basis for Commencement

The procedure shall commence upon the assignment to the publication of the status **Accepted**.

3. Responsible Persons

The following shall participate in the preparation of the publication: the Technical Editor, the Managing Editor, the Editor-in-Chief, scientific metadata specialists, and the publishing platform administrator.

4. Production Cycle

Stage 1 — Final author approval of the text. **Stage 2** — Copy-editing and technical editing. **Stage 3** — Verification of the bibliographic apparatus. **Stage 4** — Formation of scientific metadata. **Stage 5** — Assignment of internal identifiers. **Stage 6** — Preparation of publication files. **Stage 7** — Quality control. **Stage 8** — Approval of the final version by the Editor-in-Chief.

5. Quality Control

Prior to publication, the following shall be verified: completeness of the text, correctness of references, formatting of figures, tables, DOI, ORCID, author details, publication licence, scientific metadata, and digital signatures of files (where used).

6. Prohibition of Changes

Following the approval of the final version, modification of the publication text shall not be permitted. Any subsequent changes shall be effected exclusively through Erratum, Corrigendum, Retraction, or Editorial Notice.

7. Documentation

Chronicle OS shall record the date of completion of preparation, the responsible executors, quality control checks, approval of the final version, and transfer of the publication to the issue.

8. Transfer of Publication

Upon completion of preparation, the publication shall receive the status **Ready for Publication**. The materials shall be transferred to the official release procedure.

9. Completion of Procedure

This Protocol shall be deemed executed upon the formation of the final publication package.

Result

The output of this Protocol is a scholarly publication fully prepared for official release, compliant with all requirements of Chronicle OS and the editorial policy of the University Chronicle Node.

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FDP-003.9 — OFFICIAL PUBLICATION PROTOCOL

(Official Publication Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-003.9 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for the official publication of a scholarly work within the University Chronicle Node. From the moment of completion of this Protocol, the publication shall acquire the status of an official scholarly document.

2. Basis for Commencement

The procedure shall commence upon the assignment to the publication of the status **Ready for Publication**.

3. Responsible Persons

The procedure shall be carried out by the Editor-in-Chief, the Managing Editor, the Technical Editor, and the Publishing Platform Administrator.

4. Readiness Check

Prior to publication, the presence of the following shall be confirmed: approved final version, complete set of scientific metadata, publication identifier, publication licence, and confirmation of issue readiness.

5. Official Publication

During publication, the following shall be carried out: placement of the article on the publishing platform, registration of the publication in the editorial archive, opening of the public publication record, publication of scientific metadata, publication of bibliographic description, and opening of the permanent publication link.

6. Moment of Publication

The official moment of publication shall be the date and time of registration of the publication in the University Chronicle Node. From that moment, the publication shall be deemed to have entered scholarly circulation.

7. Immutability

Following official publication, the text of the article shall be deemed the archival version. Any subsequent changes shall be permitted exclusively through Erratum, Corrigendum, Editorial Note, or Retraction. The original version of the publication shall be preserved indefinitely.

8. Registration

Chronicle OS shall record: date of publication, time of publication, publication identifier, issue, journal, editorial history, archival identifier, and publication version.

9. Transfer to Archive

Following publication, the materials shall automatically enter the long-term preservation regime. The publication shall be assigned the status **Published**.

10. Commencement of Post-Publication Support

Following publication, the following procedures shall be opened: scholarly citation, indexing, archiving, post-publication discussion, issuance of corrections, and statistical support.

11. Completion of Procedure

This Protocol shall be deemed executed upon registration of the publication within the University Chronicle Node.

Result

The output of this Protocol is an officially published scholarly document, included in the scholarly repository of the University Chronicle Node and Chronicle OS, possessing an immutable archival version and a complete editorial history.

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FDP-004.1 — POST PUBLICATION LIFECYCLE PROTOCOL

(Post Publication Lifecycle Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-004.1 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for the support of a scholarly publication following its official publication within the University Chronicle Node. The publication is considered an active scholarly object, continuing its existence after the moment of publication.

2. Objective

To ensure continuous support of a scholarly publication throughout the entire period of its existence in the scholarly information space.

3. Commencement of Lifecycle

The post-publication cycle shall commence automatically upon the change of the publication status to **Published**.

4. Areas of Support

Chronicle OS ensures the support of the publication in the following areas: scholarly citation, indexing, registration of corrections, registration of supplements, scholarly discussions, editorial notices, monitoring of publication data currency, and archival support.

5. Continuity of Publication

Following official publication, the publication shall retain an immutable archival version, publication identifier, editorial history, correction history, and history of scholarly linkages.

6. Permissible Changes

Following publication, only the following procedures shall be permitted: Erratum, Corrigendum, Editorial Notice, Expression of Concern, and Retraction. Modification of the archival version of the publication is prohibited.

7. Scientific Linkages

Chronicle OS maintains a registry of citations, related publications, editorial comments, subsequent research, and publications developing the results of the work.

8. Monitoring

The editorial office may conduct monitoring of citation rates, identified errors, communications from the scholarly community, and reports of violations of Publication Ethics.

9. Archiving

All editorial actions taken after publication shall form part of the permanent publication history. Deletion of publication history shall not be permitted.

10. Completion of the Lifecycle

The publication shall be considered active indefinitely, unless otherwise provided for by Chronicle OS procedures.

11. Result

The output of this Protocol is continuous support of the scholarly publication as an independent object of scholarly knowledge throughout the entire period of its existence.

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FDP-004.2 — SCIENTIFIC LINKAGE PROTOCOL

(Scientific Linkage Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-004.2 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the rules for the registration, support, and documentation of scientific linkages of a publication within Chronicle OS.

2. Objective

To ensure continuous registration of the evolution of scholarly knowledge through the documentation of interconnections among scholarly publications.

3. Core Principle

Each published work is considered not as an isolated document, but as an element of a continuously developing network of scholarly knowledge.

4. Types of Scientific Linkages

Citation — Standard scholarly citation. **Continuation** — Continuation of previously published research. **Development** — Development of the results of a previous publication. **Correction** — Correction of a previously published work. **Refutation** — Scholarly refutation. **Confirmation** — Independent confirmation of research results. **Method Application** — Application of previously published methodology. **Dataset Usage** — Use of published scholarly data. **Concept Inheritance** — Use of previously published scholarly concept.

5. Registration of Linkages

Each registered linkage shall include: source publication, target publication, type of linkage, date of registration, basis for the linkage, and level of certainty.

6. Modification of Linkages

Following registration, a scientific linkage shall not be deleted. If the scientific picture changes, a new record may be created, recording the change in the nature of the relationship. The history of changes shall be preserved in full.

7. Verification of Linkages

The editorial office may confirm linkages, reject erroneous linkages, create new linkages, and clarify previously registered relationships. All actions shall be documented.

8. Visualisation

Chronicle OS may represent scientific linkages in the form of knowledge graphs, thematic maps, research trees, chains of scientific development, or semantic networks. The form of representation shall be determined by the information system in use.

9. Archiving

The history of scientific linkages shall be preserved indefinitely. Deletion of registered linkages shall not be permitted.

10. Completion of Procedure

This Protocol shall operate continuously throughout the entire lifecycle of the publication.

Result

The output of this Protocol is a continuously developing network of scientific interconnections, forming part of the Chronicle OS Knowledge Graph.

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FDP-004.3 — KNOWLEDGE EVOLUTION PROTOCOL

(Knowledge Evolution Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-004.3 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for registering changes in scholarly knowledge following the official publication of a scholarly work.

2. Core Principle

Chronicle OS proceeds from the understanding that scholarly knowledge is a dynamic system. A published work is not considered as a final truth. It represents the scholarly state of knowledge at the time of publication.

3. Grounds for Updating

Grounds for updating may include: new research, independent confirmations, new experimental data, identified errors, changes in scholarly interpretation, development of scholarly theory, changes in the normative framework, and emergence of new research methods.

4. Forms of Updating

Confirmation — Results fully confirmed by independent research. **Extension** — New data supplementing the original publication. **Refinement** — Original conclusions require partial refinement. **Limitation of Applicability** — Limits of correct use of the results are defined. **Refutation** — Convincing scholarly grounds contradicting the original conclusions are obtained. **Historicisation** — The work retains scholarly value as a historical stage in the development of knowledge, irrespective of its contemporary relevance.

5. Principle of Immutability

The original publication shall not be altered. Only the scholarly context around it is changed. All new information shall be recorded as independent editorial events.

6. Registration of Events

Each event shall include: publication, type of updating, grounds, date, source of information, responsible person, and level of confirmation.

7. Traceability

Chronicle OS shall enable the reconstruction of the complete history of the development of a scholarly idea from its first publication to its contemporary state.

8. Archiving

All states of knowledge shall be preserved. Deletion of previously registered scholarly states shall not be permitted.

9. Completion of Procedure

This Protocol shall operate continuously throughout the entire period of existence of the publication.

Result

The output of this Protocol is a continuously updated history of the evolution of scholarly knowledge associated with a specific publication.

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FDP-004.4 — CORRECTION AND RETRACTION PROTOCOL

(Correction and Retraction Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-004.4 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for making corrections, publishing editorial notices, and retracting scholarly publications following their official publication.

2. Core Principle

Chronicle OS ensures the preservation of scholarly history. Errors are corrected. History is not rewritten.

3. Grounds for Application

The procedure applies where technical errors are identified, authorial errors are identified, violations of Publication Ethics are identified, unreliability of results is established, copyright violations are identified, a formal request is made by the author, or an official decision is taken by the editorial office.

4. Forms of Editorial Intervention

Erratum — Correction of editorial technical errors. **Corrigendum** — Correction of authorial errors. **Editorial Notice** — Editorial information notice. **Expression of Concern** — Official notice of serious doubts regarding the publication pending the completion of investigation. **Retraction** — Official retraction of the publication.

5. Principle of Archival Preservation

Even following retraction, the publication shall not be deleted. Chronicle OS shall alter exclusively its scholarly status. The archival version shall remain accessible in accordance with editorial policy.

6. Documentation

Each procedure shall be accompanied by date, basis, responsible person, official decision, and reference to the original publication.

7. Notification

Upon change of publication status, Chronicle OS shall update the publication record, the editorial history, the archival record, scientific linkages, and indexing information.

8. Scholarly Continuity

All publications associated with a corrected or retracted work shall retain their scholarly linkages. Chronicle OS shall record the change of status of the original publication without destroying the structure of the Knowledge Graph.

9. Completion of Procedure

The procedure shall be deemed completed upon official registration of the editorial decision and updating of the publication status.

Result

The output of this Protocol is an officially registered editorial change of publication status with full preservation of the scholarly and archival history of the publication.

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FDP-004.5 — LONG TERM ARCHIVAL PRESERVATION PROTOCOL

(Long Term Archival Preservation Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-004.5 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for the long-term preservation of scholarly publications, editorial documentation, and associated information objects within Chronicle OS.

2. Objective

To ensure the preservation of the scholarly heritage irrespective of changes in technology, organisational structure, or software platforms.

3. Objects of Archiving

The following shall be subject to long-term preservation: published articles, archival versions, editorial history, expert reports, publication metadata, digital identifiers, editorial decisions, documents accompanying the publication process, and scientific linkages of the publication.

4. Principle of Immutability

The archival version of a publication is considered an immutable historical document. Following placement in the archive, modification of the content shall not be permitted.

5. Archival Levels

Chronicle OS supports: Operational Archive (materials in current scholarly circulation), Institutional Archive (complete archive of the University), and Long-Term Archive (archive of indefinite preservation).

6. Integrity Verification

The archival system shall ensure file integrity control, control of publication identifiers, control of editorial history, and control of coherence of scholarly objects.

7. Migration

Upon change of the information platform, Chronicle OS shall ensure the transfer of archival materials without loss of content, structure, publication linkages, identifiers, or version history.

8. Access

Archival materials shall be made available in accordance with editorial policy, legislation, licence terms, and the University's internal regulations.

9. Retention Period

Archival publications shall be subject to indefinite preservation. Deletion shall be permitted exclusively in cases expressly provided for by legislation, with mandatory preservation of the registration record of the publication's existence.

10. Documentation

Chronicle OS shall record placement of the object in the archive, change of preservation level, transfer between archives, integrity verification, and restoration of archival copy.

11. Completion of Procedure

This Protocol shall operate continuously throughout the entire period of existence of the scholarly publication.

Result

The output of this Protocol is the long-term preservation of the scholarly heritage of the University Chronicle Node, with complete traceability of origin, publication history, and evolution of each scholarly object.

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FDP-005.1 — UNIVERSITY CHRONICLE NODE GOVERNANCE PROTOCOL

(University Chronicle Node Governance Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-005.1 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for the governance of the University Chronicle Node as an independent institutional unit of Chronicle OS.

2. Objective

To ensure the continuous functioning of the university publishing node irrespective of changes in personnel, editorial composition, or organisational changes.

3. Object of Governance

The University Chronicle Node is considered as an independent publishing circuit, comprising editorial office, editorial board, expert network, archive, publication repository, normative documentation, digital infrastructure, and scholarly communication system.

4. Core Functions

The publishing node ensures receipt of manuscripts, conduct of expert peer review, editorial preparation, release of scholarly publications, archival support, development of the scholarly repository, and interaction with international scholarly infrastructure.

5. Governance Cycle

The operation of the publishing node shall be carried out continuously according to the cycle: planning, receipt of publications, editorial process, release, archiving, analysis of results, improvement of procedures. Upon completion of the cycle, the next editorial cycle shall commence.

6. Institutional Sustainability

The functioning of the publishing node shall not depend on any specific office holder. Each function shall have a documented procedure for execution and transfer of authority.

7. Status Monitoring

No less than once per calendar year, an internal analysis of the activities of the University Chronicle Node shall be conducted. The following shall be assessed: compliance with the Publication Policy, compliance with Publication Ethics, effectiveness of editorial procedures, completeness of archiving, currency of normative documentation, and development of the scholarly repository.

8. Improvement

Based on the results of the analysis, the following may be approved: new editions of regulations, changes to the organisational structure, new technological procedures, and updates to Chronicle OS. All changes shall be recorded by separate normative acts.

9. Transfer of Authority

Upon change of responsible persons, the following shall be transferred: normative documentation, editorial logs, publication repository, archive, digital infrastructure, and ongoing editorial processes. The transfer shall be recorded by an official act.

10. Continuity

The University Chronicle Node shall ensure the continuity of its activities irrespective of personnel, organisational, and technological changes.

11. Completion of Procedure

This Protocol shall operate continuously throughout the entire period of existence of the publishing node.

Result

The output of this Protocol is the sustainable, reproducible, and institutionally independent functioning of the University Chronicle Node as an element of Chronicle OS.

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FDP-005.2 — ISSUE ASSEMBLY AND RELEASE PROTOCOL

(Issue Assembly and Release Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-005.2 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for the assembly, approval, and official release of an issue of the University Chronicle Node.

2. Objective

To ensure a uniform procedure for the compilation of the scholarly issue and to guarantee its editorial integrity.

3. Basis for Commencement

The procedure shall commence upon the accumulation of a sufficient number of publications with the status **Ready for Publication**.

4. Assembly of the Issue

The Editor-in-Chief, in conjunction with the Managing Editor, shall determine the issue number, the thematic structure, the sequence of publications, the editorial foreword (where applicable), and the table of contents.

5. Readiness Check

Prior to approval of the issue, confirmation shall be obtained of readiness of all publications, correctness of publication data, completeness of metadata, editorial approval, and absence of unresolved publication procedures.

6. Approval

The final decision on the release of the issue shall be taken by the Editor-in-Chief. Where necessary, the decision may be approved by the Editorial Collegium.

7. Official Release

Following approval, the following shall be carried out: publication of the issue, registration of the issue, updating of archives, opening of public access, and registration of the issue contents.

8. Issue Structure

Each issue shall receive a unique number, date of publication, list of publications, editorial information, editorial history, and archival identifier.

9. Immutability

Following official release, the structure of the issue shall be considered the archival version. Modification of the composition of a published issue shall not be permitted.

10. Archiving

Each issue shall be preserved as an independent archival object alongside individual publications.

11. Completion of Procedure

The procedure shall be deemed completed upon registration of the issue within the University Chronicle Node.

Result

The output of this Protocol is an officially published scholarly issue, constituting a complete unit of the publishing activity of the University Chronicle Node.

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FDP-005.3 — ANNUAL EDITORIAL AUDIT PROTOCOL

(Annual Editorial Audit Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-005.3 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the procedure for the annual internal assessment of the activities of the University Chronicle Node.

2. Objective

To ensure continuous improvement of editorial processes, maintenance of high standards of publication culture, and timely updating of the normative framework.

3. Frequency

The editorial audit shall be conducted no less than once per calendar year. An extraordinary audit may be conducted where necessary.

4. Subject of Audit

The following shall be subject to review: compliance with the Publication Policy, compliance with Publication Ethics, execution of editorial regulations, quality of expert peer review, compliance with editorial cycle deadlines, correctness of archiving, completeness of publication metadata, operability of Chronicle OS, and currency of normative documentation.

5. Responsible Persons

The audit shall be organised by the Editor-in-Chief. The following may be involved in its conduct: the Editorial Collegium, the Expert Council, independent specialists, and representatives of the University.

6. Final Report

Upon completion of the audit, an official report shall be prepared, containing identified strengths, identified shortcomings, risk assessment, proposals for improvement, and list of required changes.

7. Corrective Measures

Based on the results of the audit, the following may be approved: new editorial procedures, amendments to regulations, updating of job descriptions, modernisation of Chronicle OS, and changes to the organisational structure.

8. Documentation

Chronicle OS shall record the date of the audit, the composition of the commission, the results of the review, the approved report, and the list of decisions taken.

9. Principle of Continuous Improvement

The editorial audit is considered as a tool for development, not for fault-finding. The primary task is the improvement of the functioning of the University Chronicle Node.

10. Completion of Procedure

This Protocol shall be deemed executed upon approval of the final report and registration of the decisions taken.

Result

The output of this Protocol is an official annual report on the state of the University Chronicle Node and an approved programme for its further development.

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FDP-005.4 — NORMATIVE DOCUMENTATION GOVERNANCE PROTOCOL

(Normative Documentation Governance Protocol)

Document ID: FDP-005.4 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

1. Purpose

This Protocol defines the uniform procedure for the creation, amendment, approval, registration, and repeal of normative documentation of Chronicle OS.

2. Objective

To ensure the integrity of the normative framework, its internal consistency, the traceability of its development, and institutional continuity.

3. Scope

This Protocol extends to regulations, editorial policies, procedures, instructions, standards, architectural documents, methodological documents, and internal normative acts of the University Chronicle Node.

4. Principles

Normative documentation of Chronicle OS is founded on the principles of unity, consistency, traceability of changes, documented continuity, and preservation of archival versions.

5. Creation of a Document

The proponent of development shall submit the purpose of the document, the scope of application, the draft version, and justification of the need. Following review, the document shall receive the status of working draft.

6. Review

The draft shall be reviewed by the Editor-in-Chief, where necessary the Editorial Collegium, the Expert Council, and the administration of the publishing node.

7. Approval

Following decision, the document shall receive a registration number, a date of approval, a version number, and official status.

8. Amendment of a Document

Each new version shall be recorded as an independent edition. The previous version shall be preserved in the Chronicle OS archive. Deletion of archival versions shall not be permitted.

9. Repeal of a Document

A document may be declared invalid exclusively by official decision of the competent authority. The following shall be preserved: the archival version, the registration record, and the history of the document's operation.

10. Normative Documentation Registry

Chronicle OS shall maintain a unified Registry of Normative Documents, containing registration number, title, date of approval, current version, history of amendments, status of the document, and links to other normative acts.

11. Principle of Continuity

No amendment to the normative framework shall disrupt the integrity of previously adopted procedures without a documented basis.

12. Completion of Procedure

This Protocol shall be deemed executed upon registration of the relevant change in the Normative Documentation Registry of Chronicle OS.

Result

The output of this Protocol is a unified, governed, and historically traceable normative system of Chronicle OS, ensuring the stability of the functioning of the University Chronicle Node irrespective of organisational and personnel changes.

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FDP-005.5 — UNIVERSITY CHRONICLE NODE OPERATIONAL CHARTER

(University Chronicle Node Operational Charter)

Document ID: FDP-005.5 **Status:** Working Draft **Version:** 1.0 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD (United Kingdom)

Preamble

The University Chronicle Node is an autonomous university publishing node operating within Chronicle OS and implementing the full lifecycle of a scholarly publication. This Charter defines the principles of existence, objectives, functions, authority, and procedure for the operation of the University Chronicle Node as an independent scholarly publishing institution.

1. Mission

The primary mission of the University Chronicle Node is to ensure a sustainable, reproducible, ethically sound, and scientifically rigorous process of creation, expert assessment, publication, support, and long-term preservation of the results of scholarly activity.

2. Core Principles

The University Chronicle Node shall conduct its activities on the basis of scholarly independence, editorial autonomy, academic integrity, transparency of procedures, traceability of decisions, institutional continuity, openness to scholarly development, and preservation of the historical memory of science.

3. Core Functions

The University Chronicle Node shall ensure receipt of scholarly manuscripts, editorial assessment, organisation of expert peer review, taking of editorial decisions, preparation of publications, release of scholarly materials, support of publications, archiving, registration of scientific interconnections, and support of the lifecycle of scholarly knowledge.

4. Structure

The University Chronicle Node shall comprise the Editor-in-Chief, the Editorial Collegium, the Managing Editor, the Technical Editorial Office, the Expert Network, the Chronicle OS Archive, the Normative Documentation Registry, and the Publication Repository. The structure may be developed without contravening this Charter.

5. Normative Framework

The activities of the University Chronicle Node shall be conducted on the basis of the Publication Policy, Publication Ethics, Chronicle OS regulations, internal normative documents, and decisions of editorial bodies. All procedures shall be in accordance with the approved normative system of Chronicle OS.

6. Publication Lifecycle

Each scholarly publication shall pass through the full lifecycle: Submission, Editorial Assessment, Peer Review, Editorial Decision, Production, Publication, Post Publication Lifecycle, Long Term Preservation, and Scientific Knowledge Evolution.

7. Governance

The governance of the University Chronicle Node shall be conducted through documented procedures. No function shall depend exclusively on a specific office holder. All processes shall be reproducible.

8. Institutional Memory

The University Chronicle Node shall ensure the preservation of publications, editorial history, expert decisions, normative documentation, scientific interconnections, and the history of the development of scholarly knowledge.

9. Development

The University Chronicle Node is considered as a self-developing scholarly system. Improvement of procedures shall be conducted through the official amendment of the normative documentation of Chronicle OS.

10. Continuity

Even in the event of changes to the editorial staff, the leadership, the University, the digital platform, or the technological infrastructure, the University Chronicle Node shall retain its identity, its archive, its normative system, its scholarly memory, and its publication repository.

11. Final Provision

This Charter constitutes the foundational organisational document of the University Chronicle Node. All subsequent normative acts, procedures, and regulations shall apply exclusively to the extent that they do not conflict with this Charter.

Result

This document defines the University Chronicle Node as an independent scholarly publishing institution operating within Chronicle OS and ensuring the full lifecycle of scholarly knowledge, from the emergence of a manuscript to its indefinite existence in the scholarly memory of humanity.

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Approved / Signed: Oleksandr Purpurov Director and Chief Systems Architect IMARCH LTD, London, United Kingdom 18 July 2026

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INSTITUTIONAL PROTOCOL — RN-0031

IMARCH Chronicle OS International Expert Reviewer Network

Official Document · IMARCH LTD · RN-0031

Document Type: Institutional Protocol **Series:** RN-0031 **Status:** Adopted **Ecosystem:** IMARCH Chronicle OS **Date:** 10 July 2026 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD **Constitutional Reference:** ED-FRM-2026-001 (Editorial Framework) **Jurisdiction:** England and Wales

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Introduction

IMARCH Chronicle OS is an international publishing ecosystem designed to support the creation, expert evaluation, publication, and long-term preservation of scientific and professional knowledge.

The International Expert Reviewer Network constitutes one of the core institutional components of this ecosystem. Its purpose is to unite qualified independent experts who contribute to maintaining high standards of academic quality, research integrity, and editorial excellence.

This Protocol establishes the principles governing participation in the Reviewer Network, defines the institutional responsibilities of all parties, and specifies the procedures regulating cooperation between IMARCH LTD and external reviewers.

Participation begins with professional registration, verification of academic qualifications, and execution of a Digital Conflict of Interest Declaration.

A fundamental principle of the IMARCH platform is the reduction of administrative burden placed upon reviewers. Initial technical screening, document completeness verification, and preliminary manuscript preparation are performed automatically by the platform prior to expert assessment.

As a result, reviewers receive structured submissions that are fully prepared for professional evaluation. For manuscripts that comply with the platform's standardised submission format, the average net expert review time is expected to be up to fifteen minutes, allowing reviewers to focus exclusively on scientific quality rather than administrative processing.

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Chapter 1. Fundamental Principles of the Reviewer Network

The International Expert Reviewer Network operates in accordance with five institutional principles.

Independence

All reviewers provide independent professional opinions based exclusively on academic merit, scientific methodology, and established principles of scholarly integrity.

Confidentiality

All manuscripts, editorial communications, and review materials remain confidential unless their disclosure is explicitly authorised by the Editorial Office.

Objectivity

Expert evaluations shall be impartial, evidence based, and free from personal, institutional, commercial, or political bias.

Professional Responsibility

Reviewers undertake to complete accepted assignments within the agreed timeframe while maintaining high standards of analytical quality and professional ethics.

Institutional Trust

Every completed review contributes not only to the evaluation of an individual manuscript but also to the development of a trusted international knowledge infrastructure based upon transparency, accountability, and institutional continuity.

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Chapter 2. Professional Rating System and the IMARCH Top 10 Charter

The International Expert Reviewer Network recognises that high-quality peer review is a measurable professional contribution deserving transparent institutional recognition.

For this purpose, Chronicle OS maintains a continuously updated professional rating system that records every completed review, evaluates the quality of expert performance, and supports the long-term development of each reviewer's institutional profile.

The system has not been designed as a competitive game. Rather, it serves as a transparent mechanism for recognising sustained professional excellence, editorial reliability, and scholarly responsibility.

Experience Points (XP)

Each successfully completed review generates professional experience points (XP), which contribute to the reviewer's institutional standing within the platform.

The standard allocation is as follows:

- 100 XP for every review formally accepted by the Editorial Office;
- up to 20 additional XP for early completion;
- up to 30 additional XP for exceptional analytical quality, as assessed by the Editorial Board.

Where a review fails to satisfy editorial quality standards or is submitted after the agreed deadline without prior approval, XP may be reduced or withheld following editorial assessment.

This evaluation process ensures that the rating reflects not only productivity but also professional consistency and academic integrity.

Monthly Institutional Rankings

Reviewer rankings are updated continuously throughout the month.

At the conclusion of each calendar month, Chronicle OS automatically generates the IMARCH Top 10 Reviewer Charter, recognising experts who have demonstrated outstanding commitment and professional performance.

The ranking is generated exclusively on the basis of recorded institutional activity and verified editorial data.

Editorial discretion may be exercised only in exceptional circumstances requiring procedural correction.

Distinguished Reviewer League

The three highest ranked reviewers receive additional institutional recognition during the following evaluation period.

This recognition may include:

- an enhanced professional remuneration coefficient;
- priority access to selected publishing opportunities;
- invitations to strategic editorial consultations;
- participation in pilot institutional initiatives;
- eligibility for additional long-term collaboration programmes within the IMARCH ecosystem.

Where appropriate, distinguished reviewers may also be invited to participate in advisory discussions concerning major institutional research initiatives.

Professional Excellence League

Reviewers ranked between fourth and tenth place are recognised for their sustained contribution to editorial quality and institutional reliability.

Depending upon current programmes, recognition may include:

- additional publication opportunities;
- institutional publication vouchers;
- support for affiliated research groups and academic departments;
- commemorative certificates and limited edition institutional materials.

The precise composition of recognition programmes may evolve as the platform expands internationally.

Rapid Review Initiative

In exceptional circumstances, the Editorial Office may activate a Rapid Review Initiative for manuscripts requiring accelerated editorial processing.

Under this procedure:

- review assignments remain available for acceptance for a limited period;
- the target completion time is within two hours following acceptance;
- the first reviewer to complete a high-quality assessment in accordance with editorial standards receives triple XP credit (×3).

Activation of the Rapid Review Initiative remains exclusively at the discretion of the Editorial Office and is reserved for exceptional editorial circumstances.

Institutional Reputation

The IMARCH rating system is intended to support long-term professional development rather than short-term competition.

A reviewer's profile represents a continuously evolving record of scholarly contribution, editorial reliability, and institutional trust.

As the reviewer accumulates verified experience within the network, this institutional record may become an important component of future editorial appointments, collaborative research initiatives, and international academic partnerships.

For this reason, Chronicle OS treats every completed review not merely as an editorial task, but as a lasting contribution to the integrity and sustainability of the scholarly communication process.

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Chapter 3. Eligibility, Verification and Professional Standards

The credibility of any scholarly publishing ecosystem depends fundamentally upon the quality, integrity, and independence of its reviewers.

For this reason, admission to the International Expert Reviewer Network is conducted through a structured verification process designed to ensure that every participating reviewer possesses the professional qualifications, ethical standards, and institutional responsibility required for independent scholarly evaluation.

Membership within the Network is therefore regarded not as an automatic entitlement but as a professional appointment based upon demonstrated academic competence.

Academic Qualifications

Applicants are expected to hold an internationally recognised academic qualification appropriate to their field of expertise.

Normally, eligible candidates will possess one of the following:

- Doctor of Philosophy (PhD);

- Doctoral Degree;
- Candidate of Sciences or an equivalent research qualification recognised within the applicant's national academic system.

Equivalent professional qualifications may also be considered where supported by substantial scholarly or institutional experience.

Particular interest is given to specialists working in fields including:
- Preventive and Lifestyle Medicine;
- Rehabilitation Sciences;
- Gerontology and Healthy Ageing;
- Biomedical Technologies;
- Systems Analysis;
- Cybernetics;
- Institutional Governance;
- Risk Management;
- Artificial Intelligence;
- Other interdisciplinary research domains consistent with the Editorial Scope of IMARCH.

Professional Reputation

Academic qualifications alone do not define professional excellence.

The International Expert Reviewer Network therefore evaluates each candidate through a broader institutional perspective, recognising that meaningful scholarly contribution extends beyond academic degrees and publication metrics.

Applicants are encouraged to demonstrate sustained engagement with the international research community through recognised academic identifiers and evidence of professional activity.

Such evidence may include, where applicable:
- ORCID iD;
- Scopus Author ID;
- Web of Science Researcher Profile;
- Google Scholar profile;
- Publons or equivalent peer review records;
- membership of editorial boards;
- participation in funded research projects;
- institutional appointments;
- evidence of previous reviewing experience for reputable scientific journals.

The absence of a particular identifier shall not automatically preclude consideration. The Editorial Office evaluates the overall academic profile rather than any single metric.

Institutional Verification

Following submission of an application, every candidate proceeds through a structured institutional verification process.

The objective of this procedure is not to create administrative complexity but to ensure the credibility, transparency, and long-term reliability of the Reviewer Network.

Verification normally consists of three stages.

Stage One: Identity and Academic Verification The Editorial Office confirms the applicant's identity together with the authenticity of the declared academic qualifications and institutional affiliations. Where necessary, additional supporting documentation may be requested.

Stage Two: Professional Assessment The Editorial Office evaluates the applicant's research background, areas of expertise, publication history, and previous editorial experience. This assessment is intended to identify the most appropriate disciplinary profile for future review assignments rather than to rank academic prestige.

Stage Three: Institutional Compliance Successful applicants are invited to execute the Digital Reviewer Agreement together with the Declaration of Absence of Conflict of Interest. Completion of these documents establishes the formal institutional relationship between the reviewer and IMARCH LTD. Only after completion of this stage does the applicant become an active member of the International Expert Reviewer Network.

Conflict of Interest

Maintaining editorial independence is a fundamental principle of the IMARCH publishing ecosystem.

Reviewers are therefore expected to disclose any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest that could reasonably affect the impartiality of their assessment.

Examples include, but are not limited to:

- personal relationships with the authors';
- institutional affiliation with the submitting organisation;
- direct financial interests;
- collaborative research conducted within the recent past;
- any circumstance that may reasonably compromise independent judgement.

Where a conflict of interest exists, reviewers are expected to decline the assignment promptly so that an alternative reviewer may be appointed without unnecessary delay.

Transparency is regarded not as a weakness but as an essential component of professional integrity.

Confidentiality

Every manuscript submitted for review remains confidential throughout the editorial process.

Reviewers undertake not to disclose, reproduce, distribute, or otherwise use unpublished materials for personal, institutional, or commercial purposes.

Confidentiality obligations continue to apply after completion of the review process unless explicit written authorisation has been granted by the Editorial Office.

This commitment protects authors', reviewers, and the integrity of scholarly communication alike.

Ethical Standards

Members of the International Expert Reviewer Network are expected to uphold the highest standards of academic ethics.

Peer review should always be conducted with professionalism, intellectual honesty, and respect for scientific dialogue.

Constructive criticism is encouraged.

Personal criticism is not.

Editorial recommendations should be based exclusively upon scientific merit, methodological soundness, clarity of presentation, and relevance to the journal's scope.

Reviewers are not expected to agree with every scientific position presented by an author.

They are expected to evaluate whether the work satisfies accepted standards of scholarly quality and contributes meaningfully to academic discussion.

Equal Opportunity

The Editorial Office evaluates manuscripts without discrimination based upon nationality, ethnicity, gender, religion, political opinion, institutional prestige, or geographic location.

Similarly, reviewer appointments are made solely on the basis of professional competence, disciplinary expertise, and demonstrated commitment to scholarly integrity.

IMARCH supports an international academic community founded upon openness, mutual respect, and intellectual diversity.

—

Chapter 4. Editorial Workflow and Peer Review Lifecycle

The IMARCH publishing ecosystem has been designed to provide a transparent, consistent, and accountable editorial workflow from manuscript submission to long-term institutional preservation.

Every manuscript progresses through a structured sequence of editorial stages. Each stage serves a distinct purpose and contributes to the overall integrity of the publication process.

The workflow is designed to minimise unnecessary administrative burden while ensuring that every editorial decision is fully documented and institutionally accountable.

Stage 1. Manuscript Submission Authors submit manuscripts through the official IMARCH publishing platform using the prescribed submission format. At the point of submission, every manuscript receives an internal institutional identifier and enters the editorial processing queue. No scientific evaluation begins before the technical verification process has been completed.

Stage 2. Technical Screening Before a manuscript reaches an editor or reviewer, it undergoes an initial technical assessment. This screening verifies: completeness of submission; compliance with author guidelines; document integrity; required declarations; metadata consistency; supporting documentation. Where appropriate, automated tools may assist editorial staff in identifying formatting deficiencies or missing documentation. This stage is administrative rather than scientific. Its purpose is to ensure that reviewers receive professionally prepared submissions.

Stage 3. Editorial Assessment Following technical screening, the Editorial Office evaluates whether the manuscript falls within the journal's scope and satisfies the minimum standards required for external peer review. At this stage, editors assess: thematic relevance; scientific maturity; methodological suitability; compliance with editorial policy. Manuscripts failing to satisfy these preliminary requirements may be returned to the authors' for revision prior to peer review.

Stage 4. Reviewer Assignment Suitable reviewers are selected according to their disciplinary expertise, research background, publication history, and declared areas of competence. The Editorial Office seeks to avoid conflicts of interest while maintaining an appropriate balance of scientific perspectives. Reviewer selection is conducted independently and remains confidential throughout the editorial process.

Stage 5. Independent Peer Review Accepted reviewers conduct an independent scientific assessment of the manuscript. The purpose of peer review is not to approve or reject ideas based upon personal opinion. Its purpose is to evaluate whether the manuscript satisfies accepted standards of scientific quality, methodological rigour, intellectual originality, and scholarly relevance. Reviewers are encouraged to provide constructive recommendations that assist authors' in strengthening their work.

Stage 6. Author Revision Where revisions are required, the Editorial Office forwards reviewers' recommendations to the authors'. Authors are invited to respond to each substantive comment and submit a revised manuscript together with an explanation of the modifications undertaken. Where appropriate, revised manuscripts may be returned to the original reviewers for further evaluation.

Stage 7. Editorial Decision Following completion of peer review and any necessary revisions, the Editorial Office reaches one of several editorial decisions. These may include: Acceptance; Minor Revision; Major Revision; Resubmission Required; Rejection. Final publication decisions remain the responsibility of the Editorial Board. Reviewer recommendations constitute an essential component of editorial decision making but are advisory rather than determinative.

Stage 8. Production and Publication Accepted manuscripts enter the production workflow. This stage includes: copy editing; language review where applicable; layout preparation; DOI

registration; preparation of publication metadata; final author approval. Following completion of production, the article is formally published within the IMARCH publishing ecosystem.

Stage 9. Institutional Preservation Publication represents the beginning rather than the conclusion of the manuscript's institutional lifecycle. Following publication, the article becomes part of the permanent institutional record maintained by IMARCH Chronicle OS. Where applicable, the publication record includes: DOI registration; cryptographic integrity verification; institutional archival record; editorial version history; associated review metadata in accordance with editorial confidentiality requirements. The objective of institutional preservation is to maintain the long-term authenticity, traceability, and reliability of the scholarly record.

Principles Governing the Editorial Workflow

Throughout every stage of the publication process, IMARCH adheres to five operational principles.

- **Transparency:** Editorial decisions are documented, traceable, and institutionally accountable.
- **Consistency:** Comparable manuscripts are processed according to equivalent editorial standards.
- **Efficiency:** Administrative procedures are streamlined to maximise the time devoted to scholarly evaluation.
- **Integrity:** Every editorial action is guided by recognised principles of research ethics and academic publishing.
- **Institutional Continuity:** Editorial records are preserved as part of the long-term institutional memory of the IMARCH publishing ecosystem.

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Chapter 5. Rights and Responsibilities

Participation in the International Expert Reviewer Network is governed by a balanced framework of rights and responsibilities applying to reviewers, the Editorial Office, and authors'.

This framework ensures the professional independence, editorial quality, and institutional accountability of the publishing process.

Rights of Reviewers

Reviewers within the Network are entitled to:

- decline review invitations where a conflict of interest exists or where the subject falls outside their expertise;
- receive appropriate recognition for completed reviews in accordance with the applicable participation framework;
- expect fair editorial communication and transparent procedural standards;
- maintain the confidentiality of their personal information in accordance with applicable legal requirements and institutional policies.

Reviewers may also propose recommendations intended to improve editorial procedures, review methodology, or publication quality.

Constructive professional feedback is regarded as an important contribution to the continued development of the IMARCH publishing ecosystem.

Responsibilities of Reviewers

Members of the Network undertake to:

- perform reviews objectively, impartially, and independently;
- evaluate manuscripts solely on the basis of scientific merit;
- maintain strict confidentiality throughout the review process;
- declare any actual or potential conflict of interest without delay;
- complete accepted assignments within the agreed review period whenever reasonably possible;
- provide constructive, respectful, and evidence based recommendations.

Reviewers are expected to distinguish clearly between scientific criticism and personal opinion.

Professional disagreement is recognised as an essential component of scholarly discourse.

Personal criticism has no place within the peer review process.

Responsibilities of the Editorial Office

The Editorial Office undertakes to:

- conduct reviewer selection fairly and objectively;
- provide reviewers with complete editorial documentation;
- protect reviewer independence throughout the evaluation process;
- respect reviewer confidentiality;
- communicate editorial decisions in a timely and professional manner;
- recognise reviewer contributions through the institutional systems described in this Protocol.

Where editorial circumstances require changes to review assignments or timelines, reviewers will be informed as early as reasonably practicable.

Responsibilities of Authors

Authors submitting manuscripts to IMARCH undertake to:

- submit original scholarly work;
- disclose relevant funding sources and potential conflicts of interest;
- respond professionally to reviewer comments;
- revise manuscripts in good faith where revisions are requested;
- respect the independence of the peer review process.

Authors are expected to regard peer review as a collaborative process intended to strengthen the quality and clarity of scholarly communication.

Editorial Independence

Editorial decisions remain exclusively within the authority of the Editorial Board.

Neither reviewers, authors', institutional partners, nor commercial stakeholders may exert improper influence over editorial judgement.

The Editorial Office is committed to preserving the independence, impartiality, and scientific credibility of every publication decision.

Editorial independence is regarded as one of the fundamental principles governing the IMARCH publishing ecosystem.

Mutual Respect

Effective scholarly communication depends upon professional respect among all participants.

Accordingly, IMARCH expects authors', reviewers, editors, and institutional partners to conduct all interactions with courtesy, integrity, and respect for differing scientific perspectives.

Academic disagreement should promote dialogue rather than conflict.

The objective of peer review is not to determine who is correct, but to strengthen the quality of scientific knowledge through rigorous and constructive evaluation.

Continuous Improvement

The IMARCH publishing ecosystem is designed as an evolving institutional environment.

Editorial procedures, reviewer guidance, technological infrastructure, and publication standards may be refined over time in response to developments in scholarly publishing, international best practice, and constructive feedback from the academic community.

Such improvements shall not affect the fundamental principles established by this Institutional Protocol.

—

Chapter 6. Professional Recognition and Long-Term Collaboration

The International Expert Reviewer Network has been established not merely as a repository of independent reviewers, but as a sustainable professional community supporting the long-term development of scholarly publishing.

Participation within the Network represents an ongoing institutional relationship founded upon academic excellence, editorial integrity, and continuous professional contribution.

Reviewers are therefore recognised not only for individual assessments, but also for their sustained contribution to the growth of the IMARCH publishing ecosystem.

Institutional Recognition

Every completed review contributes to the development of a reviewer's institutional profile.

Over time, this profile reflects not only scholarly expertise but also professional reliability, editorial judgement, and commitment to the principles of responsible academic publishing.

Institutional recognition is based upon long-term consistency rather than isolated achievements.

Accordingly, reviewers who demonstrate sustained excellence may be considered for expanded responsibilities within the Editorial Network.

Editorial Development Pathway

The IMARCH ecosystem supports a progressive model of professional development.

Depending upon editorial needs and demonstrated experience, reviewers may be invited to participate in additional institutional roles, including:

- Senior Reviewer;
- Guest Reviewer for Special Issues;
- Subject Area Coordinator;
- Guest Editor;
- Member of an Editorial Board;
- Scientific Adviser for institutional programmes;
- Participant in international research initiatives coordinated by IMARCH.

Appointments are made solely on the basis of professional merit, editorial experience, and institutional trust.

Institutional Partnerships

The Editorial Office recognises that reviewers often represent universities, research institutes, professional societies, and interdisciplinary research groups.

Accordingly, collaboration with IMARCH may also support broader institutional partnerships.

Such cooperation may include:

- thematic special issues;
- collaborative publication initiatives;
- reviewer training programmes;
- methodological workshops;
- international academic networking;
- institutional publishing agreements.

These activities are intended to strengthen scholarly communication while respecting the independence of all participating institutions.

Continuing Professional Development

The landscape of scholarly publishing continues to evolve rapidly.

To support reviewers in maintaining the highest professional standards, IMARCH intends to develop educational resources covering topics such as:

- developments in peer review methodology;
- publication ethics;
- research integrity;
- emerging editorial technologies;
- responsible applications of artificial intelligence in scholarly publishing;
- international publishing standards.

Participation in these activities is voluntary and designed to support professional growth rather than formal certification.

Institutional Contribution

Peer review represents one of the least visible yet most essential forms of academic service.

Every carefully prepared review strengthens not only an individual manuscript but also the broader integrity of scholarly communication.

The IMARCH publishing ecosystem therefore regards each reviewer as an active contributor to the preservation, verification, and transmission of scientific knowledge.

Institutional memory is built gradually through thousands of individual acts of professional responsibility.

Every review becomes part of that continuing process.

Future Opportunities

As the IMARCH ecosystem expands, additional opportunities for collaboration may emerge across its various editorial, educational, and research initiatives.

These opportunities may include participation in interdisciplinary projects, advisory groups, editorial innovation programmes, and international institutional partnerships.

Such initiatives will be announced through official IMARCH communication channels as they become available.

Participation in future programmes remains entirely voluntary and is based upon mutual professional interest.

A Community of Scholars

The International Expert Reviewer Network aspires to become more than an operational review service.

Its long-term objective is to cultivate an international community of scholars united by shared standards of academic integrity, professional independence, and constructive scientific dialogue.

The strength of such a community is measured not by its size but by the quality of its members and the trust they place in one another.

IMARCH seeks to contribute to that tradition through openness, responsibility, and a sustained commitment to scholarly excellence.

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Chapter 7. Registration and Onboarding Procedure

Joining the International Expert Reviewer Network is designed to be straightforward, transparent, and respectful of each applicant's professional time.

The registration procedure has been developed to minimise administrative complexity while ensuring appropriate academic verification and institutional compliance.

Step 1. Submission of an Application Prospective reviewers complete the official online application form available through the IMARCH website. Applicants are invited to provide: academic qualifications; institutional affiliation; areas of scientific expertise; publication profiles; contact in-

formation; preferred participation framework. Submission of an application does not automatically constitute admission to the Network.

Step 2. Editorial Verification Following submission, the Editorial Office conducts an institutional assessment of the application. This process may include verification of: academic credentials; publication history; editorial experience; professional identifiers; declared areas of expertise. Where clarification is required, applicants may be contacted directly by the Editorial Office.

Step 3. Institutional Compliance Applicants who successfully complete the editorial assessment receive the institutional documentation required for formal participation. This normally includes: the Digital Reviewer Agreement; the Declaration of Absence of Conflict of Interest; guidance materials relating to editorial procedures; access instructions for the reviewer portal. Participation becomes effective upon completion of the required documentation.

Step 4. Reviewer Profile Activation Following approval, the reviewer receives access to their institutional profile within the IMARCH publishing ecosystem. The reviewer profile serves as the primary communication interface between the Editorial Office and the reviewer throughout their participation in the Network. Depending upon editorial developments, additional digital services may be integrated into the reviewer environment over time.

Step 5. First Review Assignment Review invitations are issued according to: subject expertise; reviewer availability; absence of conflicts of interest; editorial priorities. Reviewers remain free to accept or decline invitations according to their professional availability. Acceptance of an assignment represents confirmation that the reviewer is able to complete the review objectively and within the agreed timeframe.

Communication

Official communication between IMARCH and reviewers is conducted through the contact details provided during registration.

Reviewers are encouraged to keep their professional information up to date to ensure efficient editorial coordination.

The Editorial Office remains available to assist reviewers with procedural questions, technical matters, and editorial guidance throughout their participation in the Network.

Professional communication is regarded as an integral part of maintaining an effective international reviewer community.

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Chapter 8. Legal Status and Institutional Governance

The International Expert Reviewer Network operates within the institutional framework of IMARCH LTD, a company incorporated in the United Kingdom.

The Network functions as an independent professional infrastructure supporting scholarly publishing through internationally recognised editorial standards, transparent governance, and documented institutional procedures.

This Institutional Protocol establishes the general principles governing participation in the Reviewer Network.

Specific contractual relationships are formalised through individual digital agreements executed between IMARCH LTD and participating reviewers.

Applicable Policies

Participation in the Network is governed by the following institutional documents, where applicable:

- Editorial Doctrine of IMARCH;
- Publishing Ethics Policy;

- Conflict of Interest Policy;
- Data Protection Policy;
- Confidentiality Agreement;
- Reviewer Agreement;
- applicable legislation of the United Kingdom.

Where discrepancies arise between institutional documents, the individual Reviewer Agreement shall prevail with respect to contractual matters.

Intellectual Property

Editorial procedures, documentation, reviewer methodology, institutional architecture, and associated organisational materials constitute intellectual assets of IMARCH LTD.

Nothing contained within this Protocol restricts reviewers from applying their own academic expertise or professional knowledge independently.

However, reproduction or commercial use of proprietary institutional materials without written authorisation may constitute infringement of applicable intellectual property rights.

Amendments

This Institutional Protocol may be updated periodically in response to:

- developments in scholarly publishing;
- changes in applicable legislation;
- advances in editorial technology;
- institutional experience;
- recommendations from the academic community.

Revised editions shall become effective upon official publication by IMARCH LTD.

Governing Principle

This Protocol is intended to provide a stable institutional framework while allowing the flexibility necessary for continuous improvement.

Its purpose is not to regulate academic thought, but to support an editorial environment in which scientific quality, professional independence, and institutional trust may flourish.

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Closing Statement

Scientific progress depends upon more than discovery.

It depends upon the willingness of scholars to examine one another's work with fairness, intellectual honesty, and professional responsibility.

Peer review remains one of the most valuable forms of academic service precisely because it is founded upon trust.

The International Expert Reviewer Network has been established to preserve and strengthen that tradition within a contemporary digital publishing environment.

By joining the Network, reviewers contribute not only to the evaluation of individual manuscripts but also to the development of a durable institutional memory capable of supporting future generations of researchers.

We welcome colleagues who share these principles and who wish to participate in an international scholarly community founded upon integrity, independence, and excellence.

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Final Declaration International Expert Reviewer Network Institutional Protocol Version 1.0 Approved by IMARCH LTD London, United Kingdom

Adopted by: Oleksandr Purpurov Director & Chief Systems Architect IMARCH LTD, London, United Kingdom 10 July 2026

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INSTITUTIONAL PROTOCOL FOR AUTHORS — RN-0032

IMARCH CHRONICLE OS INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL

Official Document of IMARCH LTD

RN-0032 · Adopted · Oxford Legal Style

Document Type: Institutional Protocol **Series:** RN-0032 **Status:** Adopted **Ecosystem:** IMARCH Chronicle OS **Date:** 02.08.26 **Owner:** IMARCH LTD **Constitutional Basis:** ED-FRM-2026-001 (Publishing Doctrine) **Jurisdiction:** England and Wales

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1. PRELIMINARY

1.1. Preamble

IMARCH Chronicle OS constitutes an international publishing ecosystem established to support the creation, expert evaluation, publication, and long-term preservation of scientific and professional knowledge.

The contemporary academic system is subject to a profound structural crisis: classical scientometrics remains exclusively oriented towards citation indices — metrics that frequently reflect the level of media visibility surrounding a publication rather than the practical value of the underlying research.

The IMARCH CitHronical Platform introduces a fundamentally distinct discipline — Scientometrics 2.0. The objective is not the accumulation of citations, but the transformation of scientific knowledge into real, protected, and operational capital.

This Protocol proceeds from a rigorous pragmatic principle: the value of a technology is determined by its applicability and effectiveness, not by its representation in institutional reports. Publication in

this Journal constitutes not the conclusion of research, but the necessary legal prelude to the scaling and commercialisation of the Author's intellectual contribution.

1.2. Scope and Application

This Protocol governs the relationship between IMARCH LTD and Authors submitting manuscripts for consideration to the IMARCH Chronicle OS International Journal. It establishes the procedural framework for submission, cryptographic fixation, peer review, publication, and post-publication institutional recognition.

1.3. Jurisdiction

This Protocol and all matters arising therefrom shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of England and Wales. The courts of London, United Kingdom, shall have exclusive jurisdiction over any dispute arising out of or in connection with this Protocol, subject always to the provisions of Clause 15 (Dispute Resolution).

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2. INTERPRETATION AND DEFINITIONS

2.1. Definitions

In this Protocol, unless the context otherwise requires:

»APC«» means Article Processing Charge, comprising the Registration Contribution and the Publication Contribution.

»Author«» means any natural or legal person submitting a manuscript for consideration and publication through the IMARCH Chronicle OS Platform.

»Blind Vector«» means the anonymised version of the manuscript from which all identifying information (including Author name, institutional affiliation, and contact details) has been removed.

»Chronicle OS«» means the institutional documentation and registry system operated by IMARCH LTD.

»DOI«» means Digital Object Identifier, a persistent identifier assigned to published works.

»Double-Blind Peer Review«» means the evaluation process in which neither the Author nor the Reviewer are aware of each other's identity.

»Editorial Board«» means the editorial body appointed by IMARCH LTD to oversee the peer review and publication process.

»Institutional Protocol«» means this document, RN-0032, as amended from time to time.

»IMARCH LTD«» means the company registered in England and Wales under registration number 16791765.

»Journal«» means the IMARCH Chronicle OS International Journal.

»Master File«» means the complete version of the manuscript containing all author identification information.

»Platform«» means the IMARCH CitHronical ecosystem and associated services.

»Publication Contribution«» means the final payment of £100 due upon acceptance of the manuscript.

»Registration Contribution«» means the initial payment of £50 due upon submission of the manuscript.

»Reviewer«» means an independent expert engaged by the Editorial Board to evaluate submitted manuscripts.

»SHA-256«» means the cryptographic hash algorithm used for priority fixation and integrity verification.

»Third Party«» means any person or entity other than the Author, IMARCH LTD, or the Editorial Board.

2.2. Interpretation

Headings are for convenience only and do not affect interpretation. Words importing the singular include the plural and vice versa. References to »writing» include electronic communication. References to any statute or regulation include any modification, re-enactment, or extension thereof.

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3. PUBLICATION PROCESS OVERVIEW

3.1. Stage 1: Submission — Security Package

The Author shall submit two files through the official Platform: (a) **Master File:** Complete version containing the Author's name, institutional affiliation, contact details, abstract, and full text. This file is immediately transmitted to the secure encrypted repository. (b) **Blind Vector:** An identical text of the manuscript from which all identifying information (Author name, institutional affiliation, and contact details) has been removed.

3.2. Stage 2: Cryptographic Fixation — Instant Priority

At the moment of file upload, the system shall compute unique digital fingerprints — SHA-256 hashes — for each file.

The Platform shall publish a pre-publication card on the international pre-print showcase at `imarch.sbs`. The Author's identity shall remain concealed, but the English-language abstract and file hashes shall be publicly accessible.

This mechanism provides legally cognisable proof of priority. Search engines index the page immediately. The Author's intellectual contribution is protected against misappropriation during the peer review process through London-based temporal evidence of priority.

3.3. Stage 3: Double-Blind Peer Review — Up to 7 Days

The Blind Vector (anonymised file) shall be transmitted to an independent international expert appointed by the Editorial Board.

The Reviewer shall evaluate the manuscript exclusively on the basis of scholarly quality, methodological rigour, and scientific contribution. The Reviewer shall not have access to the Author's institutional affiliation, geographic origin, or personal identity.

The Registration Contribution of £50 ensures expeditious processing and covers the technical costs of conducting the peer review within the prescribed 7-day period.

Notwithstanding the payment of the Registration Contribution, the Editorial Board retains sole discretion to extend the review period where exceptional circumstances (including but not limited to Reviewer unavailability, force majeure, or technical failure) so require. The Author shall be notified of any such extension without undue delay.

3.4. Stage 4: Editorial Decision and Publication

Upon receipt of the review, the Editorial Board shall issue one of the following decisions: Accepted; Minor Revisions; Major Revisions; Resubmit; Rejected.

Where a favourable decision is issued, the Author shall pay the final Publication Contribution of £100.

The system shall automatically link the Author's identity from the secure vault with the previously published Master File hash, assign an international DOI to the article, and update the publication status to »Officially Published».

Without prejudice to the rights of IMARCH LTD under this Protocol, the Editorial Board's decision on publication shall be final and binding.

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4. CRYPTOGRAPHIC PRIORITY FIXATION

4.1. SHA-256 Technology

The Platform employs the SHA-256 cryptographic algorithm to generate unique digital fingerprints for each uploaded file. The hash value constitutes an irreversible mathematical transformation that:

- uniquely identifies the file contents;
- enables verification of document integrity at any subsequent time;
- serves as legally cognisable evidence of the document's existence at a specific point in time.

4.2. Hash Publication

Following computation, the hashes shall be published on the pre-publication page. This creates:

- a verifiable timestamp of the work's existence;
- legally cognisable evidence of the Author's priority;
- protection against misappropriation during the review process.

4.3. DOI Association

At final publication, the Master File hash shall be associated with the assigned DOI. This establishes a continuous chain of evidence from initial fixation to official publication.

4.4. Integrity of Fixation

Without prejudice to any other rights or remedies available to the Author, the cryptographic fixation provided by the Platform constitutes evidence of the existence and content of the manuscript at the time of submission. The Author acknowledges that the Platform does not guarantee the continued availability of any third-party services or external indexing systems.

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5. DOUBLE-BLIND PEER REVIEW SYSTEM

5.1. Review Principles

Peer review in the IMARCH Chronicle OS Journal shall be conducted in accordance with five institutional principles: (a) **Independence:** Reviewers shall provide independent professional opinions based exclusively on scholarly quality, scientific methodology, and generally recognised principles of academic integrity. (b) **Confidentiality:** All manuscripts, editorial communications, and review materials shall remain confidential unless disclosure is expressly authorised by the Editorial Board. (c) **Objectivity:** Expert assessments shall be impartial, reasoned, and free from personal, institutional, commercial, or political bias. (d) **Professional Responsibility:** Reviewers shall complete accepted assignments within agreed timeframes, adhering to high standards of analytical quality and professional ethics. (e) **Institutional Trust:** Each completed review contributes not only to the evaluation of an individual manuscript but to the development of a trusted international knowledge infrastructure.

5.2. Double-Blind Anonymity

The Author's identity shall be concealed from the Reviewer. The Reviewer's identity shall be concealed from the Author. This excludes:

- bias based on institutional prestige;
- influence of national origin;
- personal sympathies or antipathies;
- academic protectionism.

Reviewers shall evaluate exclusively the quality of the research, methodology, and scholarly significance of the work.

5.3. Reviewer Independence

Reviewers are independent experts engaged by the Editorial Board. IMARCH LTD shall not be responsible for, and disclaims all liability in respect of, the content, quality, or conclusions of any review provided by a Reviewer.

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6. TARGETED FUNDING STRUCTURE

6.1. General Principles

The Platform operates as a non-commercial open science infrastructure. The Platform does not trade in »journal placements». Targeted contributions from Authors are applied to the costs of high-technology independent evaluation, cryptographic fixation, and international registration.

6.2. Registration Contribution — £50

Due upon initial submission. Covers:

- initial AI-based anti-plagiarism audit;
- SHA-256 fixation;
- RN-0030 registry server operations;
- preparation of materials for independent expert evaluation.

6.3. Publication Contribution — £100

Due **only after** the manuscript has successfully completed blind peer review and been approved for publication. Covers:

- generation of British DOI;
- permanent server indexing;
- official release.

6.4. Legal Status of Contributions

The transfer of funds constitutes a voluntary targeted grant/contribution to the development of the ecosystem and support of the IMARCH LTD peer review protocol (UK Trade Secrets Regulations / VERDICTUM). This payment is not a commercial purchase of goods or services.

Contributions cover the costs of organising the review process and do not guarantee a favourable decision from reviewers.

Notwithstanding the payment of any contribution, the Editorial Board retains the absolute and unfettered discretion to reject any manuscript on scholarly grounds. In such event, the Registration Contribution shall not be refundable, as it covers services already rendered (including technical review, hash fixation, and administrative processing).

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7. AUTHOR RIGHTS AND OBLIGATIONS

7.1. Author Rights

Authors shall have the right:

- to cryptographic priority fixation at the time of submission;
- to receive an official deposition protocol;
- to professional, independent, and impartial peer review;
- to receive a DOI for published articles;
- to receive institutional recognition within the IMARCH ecosystem.

7.2. Author Obligations

Authors shall undertake:

- to submit original scholarly works;
- to disclose relevant funding sources and potential conflicts of interest;

- to respond professionally to reviewer comments;
- to revise manuscripts in good faith where revisions are requested;
- to respect the independence of the review process.

7.3. Author Revisions

Where revisions are required, the Editorial Board shall communicate reviewer recommendations to the Author. The Author shall respond to each substantive comment and submit a revised manuscript with an explanation of amendments made.

7.4. Representations and Warranties

The Author represents and warrants that:

- the submitted manuscript is the Author's original work;
- it has not been published previously and is not under consideration elsewhere;
- all necessary permissions for the use of third-party material have been obtained;
- the manuscript does not infringe any intellectual property rights of any Third Party.

7.5. Withdrawal

The Author may withdraw the manuscript at any time prior to formal acceptance by providing written notice to the Editorial Board. The Registration Contribution shall not be refundable in the event of withdrawal.

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8. CONFIDENTIALITY

8.1. Author's Obligation of Confidentiality

The Author shall treat as confidential and shall not disclose to any Third Party:

- the content of any correspondence with the Editorial Board;
- the identity of any Reviewer assigned to the manuscript;
- the content of any review received, except as necessary to respond to reviewer comments in the revision process;
- any information obtained during the review process that is not in the public domain.

8.2. Exceptions

The obligation of confidentiality shall not apply to:

- information already in the public domain at the time of disclosure;
- information required to be disclosed by applicable law or by order of a competent court or regulatory authority.

8.3. Duration

The obligations set out in this Clause 8 shall survive the termination of this Protocol and the completion or discontinuation of the publication process.

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9. REGISTRATION AND DEPOSITION PROCEDURE

9.1. Submission Procedure

Submission shall be made through the official form on the Platform. The Author shall provide:

- full name (in English and native language);
- professional email address;
- institutional affiliation;
- ORCID iD (where available);
- article title;
- abstract.

9.2. File Upload

Two files shall be uploaded:

- Master File (complete version);
- Blind Vector (anonymised version).

9.3. Hash Generation

The system shall automatically compute SHA-256 hashes for both files and display them in the form. Hashes shall be preserved in session storage for subsequent use.

9.4. Deposition Protocol

Following submission, an official Cryptographic Deposition Protocol (RN-0030) shall be generated, containing:

- author details and affiliation;
- publication metadata;
- cryptographic digital fingerprints (SHA-256);
- compliance status and session token.

9.5. Protocol Submission

The Author shall copy the protocol and forward it together with the files to the official email gateway `info@imarch.sbs`.

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10. INSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION

10.1. Series 8888 Loyalty Tokens

Each Author contributing to the development of the project shall be recorded in the crowdfunding token model and shall receive digital participation tokens, **Series 8888**.

10.2. Media Support

Authors' materials shall receive media support through partner channels, enhancing personal citation metrics and international academic recognition.

10.3. Institutional Profile

Following successful publication, the Author shall receive an institutional profile within the IMARCH ecosystem, reflecting:

- publication history;
- editorial experience;
- professional reliability.

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11. DEPARTMENTAL BUNDLES AND REFERRAL NETWORK

11.1. Referral Network

Following first successful publication, the Author shall receive a personal promotional code. By sharing this code with colleagues, the Author assists the colleague in saving 10% on the initial contribution and receives a £5 bonus credited to their subsequent publication account.

11.2. Department Bundle Pack

Where 5 or more articles are submitted concurrently from a single research group or department, a discount of **20%** on the final Publication Contribution shall apply to each article.

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12. ECOSYSTEM INTEGRATION ADVANTAGES

12.1. Equity Distribution Model (10:30:30:30)

For projects demonstrating substantial commercial and engineering potential, IMARCH LTD may open an investment circuit. Revenues derived from commercialisation shall be distributed according to the following formula: (a) **10% — Social and Charitable Circuit:** funding for veteran support programmes, orphan support, and grants for emerging talent. (b) **30% — Author Sovereign Income:** net licensing and commercial income of the intellectual property creator. (c) **30% — Re-investment in Development and Marketing:** budget for project promotion, pitch deck creation, and international market entry. (d) **30% — IMARCH LTD Infrastructure Share:** compensation to the company for legal framework, Chronicle OS operational system, and know-how protection.

12.2. Institutional Protection

The project shall become part of the IMARCH LTD asset portfolio. Legal and patent disputes shall be resolved through the legal circuit.

12.3. Research Focus

The Platform relieves the burden of financing, negotiation, and legal procedures. The Author remains the Architect of the idea; IMARCH becomes its commercial instrument.

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13. LIMITATION OF LIABILITY

13.1. Exclusion of Warranties

To the fullest extent permitted by applicable law, IMARCH LTD disclaims all express and implied warranties, representations, and guarantees with respect to:

- the Platform and the Journal;
- the peer review process and the conclusions of Reviewers;
- the accuracy, completeness, or suitability of any information provided through the Platform;
- the timing or outcome of the review process.

The Platform and Journal are provided on an »as is» and »as available» basis.

13.2. Limitation of Liability

IMARCH LTD shall not be liable to the Author or any Third Party for any direct, indirect, incidental, special, consequential, or exemplary damages, including but not limited to:

- loss of profits, revenue, or business opportunities;
- loss of data or goodwill;
- any claim arising from the content or quality of reviews received;
- any delay or failure to publish;
- any actions taken by Reviewers or Third Parties.

13.3. Aggregate Liability Cap

Notwithstanding any other provision of this Protocol, the aggregate liability of IMARCH LTD to the Author under or in connection with this Protocol, whether in contract, tort (including negligence), or otherwise, shall not exceed the total amount of contributions paid by the Author to IMARCH LTD in connection with the relevant manuscript.

13.4. Independent Reviewers

Reviewers are independent experts engaged by the Editorial Board. IMARCH LTD acts solely as an administrative intermediary and shall not be liable for the content, quality, or consequences of any review.

13.5. Third-Party Services

The Platform may utilise third-party services (including payment processing and indexing systems). IMARCH LTD shall not be liable for any failure, error, or omission of such third-party services.

13.6. Force Majeure

IMARCH LTD shall not be liable for any delay or failure to perform its obligations under this Protocol where such delay or failure arises from circumstances beyond its reasonable control, including but not limited to:

- acts of God, war, terrorism, or civil unrest;
- technical failures, cyber-attacks, or system outages;
- government action or regulatory changes;
- unavailability of third-party services.

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14. TIMEFRAMES AND CONSEQUENCES OF BREACH

14.1. Standard Review Period

The standard review period shall be seven (7) calendar days from the date of assignment to a Reviewer. This period may be extended by the Editorial Board in exceptional circumstances.

14.2. Author's Response Period

The Author shall respond to requests for revisions within thirty (30) calendar days of receipt of the review. Failure to respond within this period may result in the manuscript being considered withdrawn.

14.3. Consequences of Breach by Author

Without prejudice to any other rights or remedies available to IMARCH LTD, the following consequences shall apply in the event of breach by the Author: (a) **Failure to pay:** If the Author fails to pay any contribution when due, the submission shall be suspended and may be rejected. (b) **Misrepresentation:** If the Author is found to have made a false representation or warranty (including plagiarism, duplicate submission, or failure to disclose conflicts of interest), the manuscript shall be rejected and the Author may be excluded from future submissions to the Journal. (c) **Breach of confidentiality:** Any breach of confidentiality by the Author shall constitute a material breach of this Protocol and may result in the rejection of the manuscript and the exclusion of the Author from future submissions.

14.4. Consequences of Breach by IMARCH LTD

In the event of breach by IMARCH LTD, the Author's sole remedy shall be limited to a refund of the contributions paid in respect of the relevant manuscript, subject always to the limitations set out in Clause 13 (Limitation of Liability).

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15. DISPUTE RESOLUTION

15.1. Negotiation

Any dispute arising out of or in connection with this Protocol shall first be referred to the Editorial Board for informal resolution. The Author shall submit a written statement of the dispute to `info@imarch.sbs`. The Editorial Board shall respond within thirty (30) calendar days of receipt.

15.2. Mediation

If the dispute is not resolved through negotiation within thirty (30) calendar days of the initial referral, the parties shall submit the dispute to mediation administered by the Centre for Effective Dispute Resolution (CEDR) or another recognised mediation institution agreed by the parties.

15.3. Mediation Procedure

The mediation shall be conducted in accordance with the CEDR Model Mediation Procedure (or the equivalent procedure of the agreed institution). The mediator shall be appointed by the parties acting jointly, or failing agreement, by the mediation institution.

15.4. Costs of Mediation

Each party shall bear its own costs of mediation, and the costs of the mediator shall be shared equally between the parties unless the mediator determines otherwise.

15.5. Litigation

Failing resolution through negotiation and mediation, the dispute shall be finally determined by the courts of London, United Kingdom, which shall have exclusive jurisdiction in accordance with Clause 1.3.

15.6. Continuation of Services

Pending resolution of any dispute, the parties shall continue to perform their obligations under this Protocol to the extent practicable and not inconsistent with the subject matter of the dispute.

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16. GENERAL PROVISIONS

16.1. Institutional Status

IMARCH LTD (Registration in the United Kingdom, London). Company Registration Number: 16791765 Institutional Infrastructure: Chronicle OS Documentation System

16.2. Amendments

This Institutional Protocol may be amended periodically in response to developments in scholarly publishing, changes in applicable law, and institutional experience. New versions shall take effect upon official publication by IMARCH LTD.

16.3. Language

This Protocol is prepared in English. In the event of any inconsistency between the English version and any translation, the English version shall prevail.

16.4. Entire Agreement

This Protocol constitutes the entire agreement between the parties with respect to its subject matter and supersedes all prior negotiations, representations, or agreements, whether written or oral.

16.5. Severability

If any provision of this Protocol is held to be invalid or unenforceable, the remaining provisions shall continue in full force and effect.

16.6. No Waiver

No failure or delay by either party in exercising any right or remedy under this Protocol shall operate as a waiver of that right or remedy.

16.7. Third-Party Rights

Except as expressly provided herein, nothing in this Protocol shall confer any rights on any Third Party under the Contracts (Rights of Third Parties) Act 1999.

16.8. Contacts

General inquiries and claims: `info@imarch.sbs` Official Address: IMARCH LTD, London, United Kingdom

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FINAL DECLARATION
Institutional Protocol for Authors
IMARCH Chronicle OS International Journal
Version 1.0
Approved by IMARCH LTD
London, United Kingdom

Signature: Oleksandr Purpurov

—
Title: Director and Chief Systems Architect
Date: 18 July 2026 — Basis: IMARCH Publishing Doctrine ED-FRM-2026-001 of 9 July 2026

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